بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

الأَرْبَعُونَ النَّوَوِيَّةُ

The Forty Hadith of Imam an-Nawawi

with the additions of al-Ḥāfiẓ Ibn Rajab — fifty hadith in all



THE ARABIC TEXT · ENGLISH TRANSLATION FROM SUNNAH.COM
AN EXPLANATORY NOTE, LESSONS, PICTURES AND STEP-BY-STEP GUIDES
QUESTIONS AND A TO-DO LIST FOR EVERY WEEK

Compiled by

Feysel Reshid

A Study Edition · 1448 AH / 2026 CE

The Forty Hadith of Imam an-Nawawi
with the additions of al-Ḥāfiẓ Ibn Rajab
A Study Edition

Compiled by **Feysel Reshid**

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First edition · 1448 AH / 2026 CE

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بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

﴿وَمَا آتَاكُمُ الرَّسُولُ فَخُذُوهُ وَمَا نَهَاكُمْ عَنْهُ فَانْتَهُوا﴾

"And whatever the Messenger has given you — take; and what he has forbidden you — refrain from." (*al-Ḥashr* 59:7)

«نَضَّرَ اللَّهُ امْرَأً سَمِعَ مِنَّا حَدِيثًا فَحَفِظَهُ حَتَّى يُبَلِّغَهُ»

"May Allah brighten the face of a person who hears a hadith from us, memorises it and passes it on." (*Abū Dāwūd, at-Tirmidhī*)

Preface
المُقَدِّمَة

All praise belongs to Allah, Lord of the worlds, and may peace and blessings be upon our Prophet Muhammad, upon his family and all of his Companions. Among the gifts Allah gave His Messenger ﷺ was *jawāmiʿ al-kalim*: short sentences that carry a great deal of meaning. A few words from him can hold a whole chapter of the religion, and the scholars of every generation have collected such sayings so that Muslims can learn the most with the least effort.

The most loved of these collections is the **Forty Hadith** of Imam Yaḥyā ibn Sharaf an-Nawawī (d. 676 AH). He chose forty-two hadith, each of which, in his words, is "a great foundation of the foundations of the religion". They cover belief, worship, character, dealings with people and the purification of the heart. Some scholars said that the whole of Islam turns on a handful of them: "Actions are by intentions", "Whoever introduces into this affair of ours…", "The halal is clear and the haram is clear", and "Leave what does not concern you". A century later, al-Ḥāfiẓ Ibn Rajab al-Ḥanbalī (d. 795 AH) wrote his famous commentary *Jāmiʿ al-ʿUlūm wa-l-Ḥikam* on them and added eight more, bringing the total to fifty. This book follows that fifty-hadith text exactly as it is printed in the source edition.

This is a **study edition**. It is meant to be read with a pen in your hand, not only memorised and put on a shelf. Each hadith has its own chapter, and every chapter is built the same way:

> the **Arabic text**, fully voweled, with the Prophet's own words in colour · the **English translation** from sunnah.com, with its reference · a short **biography of the Companion** who narrated it · an **explanatory note** drawn from the classical commentaries of an-Nawawī, Ibn Rajab, Ibn Daqīq al-ʿĪd and later scholars · the **lessons** of the hadith · a **picture** wherever a picture makes the meaning clearer · **step-by-step guides** wherever the hadith asks us to do something · five to seven **questions** with space to write · a **to-do list for the week**, so that the hadith leaves the page and enters your day, and ruled pages for **your own notes**.

Fifty hadith fit neatly into a year: one hadith a week, with two weeks left for revision. A family can read a chapter together at the weekend and tick the to-do list each evening; a teacher can use one chapter per lesson; a student can work alone with the memorisation tracker at the back.

The notes are brief on purpose: a doorway, not the whole house. Whoever wants more should read the commentaries, above all *Jāmiʿ al-ʿUlūm wa-l-Ḥikam*, and study with people of knowledge; where scholars differ on a ruling, ask a trusted scholar about your own situation.

The Companions did not move past ten verses of the Qur'an until they had learned the knowledge and the action in them. Learn the words, understand the meaning, then **act**. Whatever is correct in this book is from Allah alone, and whatever mistake it contains is from its compiler and from Shayṭān. We ask Allah to make it sincerely for His Face, to benefit its readers, and to forgive whoever reads it and makes duʿa for those who worked on it.

Feysel Reshid · 1448 AH / 2026 CE

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How to Use This Book

كَيْفَ تَسْتَفِيدُ مِنْ هَذَا الكِتَاب

Every chapter follows the same eight parts. Work through them in order. A chapter takes about a week.

1. **Read the Arabic**
   Read the hadith aloud in Arabic, slowly. The Prophet's ﷺ own words are in colour. Repeat the coloured part until you can say it without looking.

2. **Read the translation**
   The English is from sunnah.com, with the reference so you can look the hadith up online. The Prophet's ﷺ words are in colour here too. Then read about the Companion who narrated it.

3. **Study the note and the picture**
   The explanatory note gives the meaning and the background. The picture puts the whole hadith in one drawing — try to redraw it from memory.

4. **Learn the lessons**
   Each numbered lesson is one thing the hadith teaches. Choose one lesson and share it with someone this week.

5. **Follow the steps**
   When a hadith asks you to do something, the 'Step by Step' box shows how, in order.

6. **Answer the questions**
   Write your answers in the space given. Some questions test what you understood; the last ones ask you to think about your own life.

7. **Live the to-do list**
   Seven small tasks, one for each day from Saturday to Friday. Tick each box when it is done. At the end of the week, sign the memorisation line.

8. **Write your notes**
   Use the 'My Notes' lines at the end of each chapter for what you learned, questions to ask your teacher, and du'as to remember.

A SUGGESTED WEEKLY RHYTHM

Weekend	Read the chapter together, memorise the coloured Arabic, look at the picture.
Weekdays	One to-do task a day. Answer one or two questions each evening.
Friday	Revise the hadith from memory, check the to-do list, sign the memorisation line.
Every 10 weeks	A revision week: recite the ten hadith of the part and redo the questions you found hardest.

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Visit **diinislaam.com/40hadith** to **listen** to every hadith in Arabic and English, take the five part tests with instant marking, and receive your **certificate of completion** after passing all five tests with 80% or more. Every chapter and test also has its own code: scan it, or type the address printed under it, such as **diinislaam.com/40hadith/4** for Hadith 4.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

For younger children, read the translation aloud, talk about the picture together and choose two or three of the to-do tasks. Older children and adults can do the whole chapter. Praise effort more than perfection, and act on the hadith yourself first: children learn more from what they see than from what they are told.

The Two Imams

الإِمَامَانِ النَّوَوِيُّ وَابْنُ رَجَب

Imam an-Nawawī (631 – 676 AH)

Abū Zakariyyā Yaḥyā ibn Sharaf an-Nawawī was born in Muḥarram 631 AH in Nawā, a village in the Ḥawrān region south of Damascus. As a boy he loved the Qur'an so much that, it is reported, when other children forced him to play he would run away from them crying and reciting. At about nineteen his father brought him to Damascus, where he lived in a small room of the Rawāḥiyyah school and studied with remarkable discipline: twelve lessons a day with his teachers, in fiqh, hadith, Arabic grammar, principles and more.

In a short life of about forty-five years he wrote books that Muslims still read every day: *Riyāḍ aṣ-Ṣāliḥīn*, *al-Adhkār*, his commentary on *Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim*, *al-Majmūʿ*, *Rawḍat aṭ-Ṭālibīn*, *Minhāj aṭ-Ṭālibīn* and the *Forty Hadith*. He lived simply, never married, ate little, and taught at Dār al-Ḥadīth al-Ashrafiyyah without taking its salary. He spoke the truth to the rulers of his time, and wrote to the Sultan advising him to lift unjust taxes from the people. He died in Rajab 676 AH in his home village, may Allah have mercy on him.

In his introduction to the Forty Hadith, an-Nawawī explains that scholars before him had gathered forty hadith on single subjects, while he chose forty that each serve as "a great foundation of the religion", all of them authentic or good, and with their chains removed so that they are easy to memorise. He hoped the reader would be among those who preserve and pass on the Sunnah.

> **An-Nawawī said:** "It is fitting for everyone who desires the Hereafter to know these hadith, because of the important matters they contain and the attention they draw to every kind of obedience. That is clear to anyone who reflects on them."

al-Ḥāfiẓ Ibn Rajab (736 – 795 AH)

Zayn ad-Dīn ʿAbd ar-Raḥmān ibn Aḥmad ibn Rajab al-Ḥanbalī was born in Baghdad and grew up in Damascus. He studied under Ibn al-Qayyim and other great scholars, and became one of the leading masters of hadith and of the knowledge of the heart. His books include a commentary on *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī* (*Fatḥ al-Bārī*), *Laṭāʾif al-Maʿārif* and a commentary on at-Tirmidhī's *al-ʿIlal*.

His best-known work is ***Jāmiʿ al-ʿUlūm wa-l-Ḥikam***, "The Compendium of Knowledge and Wisdom", a commentary on an-Nawawī's forty-two hadith. He added **eight more** concise and comprehensive hadith — on inheritance, fosterage, forbidden trade, intoxicants, moderation in eating, hypocrisy,

reliance on Allah and the remembrance of Allah — to complete fifty. In this book they are hadith 43 to 50.

About the Text and Translation

عَنِ النَّصِّ وَالتَّرْجَمَة

The Arabic text

The Arabic follows the fifty-hadith text as printed in the source edition (*Mutūn Ṭālib al-ʿIlm*): an-Nawawī's forty-two hadith followed by Ibn Rajab's eight additions. The words of the Prophet ﷺ — and, in the *ḥadīth qudsī*, the words he relates from his Lord — are printed in the chapter's accent colour, as in the original. The line under the Arabic gives the compiler's note on where the hadith is recorded and how strong it is.

The English translation

The English translations are taken from **sunnah.com**:

> **Hadith 1–42:** sunnah.com, *Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi* (sunnah.com/nawawi40), reproduced as published, except that the long English blessing "(peace and blessings of Allah be upon him)" is written with the symbol ﷺ to save space.
>
> **Hadith 43–50:** sunnah.com does not list Ibn Rajab's additions as a separate book, so each is given in sunnah.com's translation from its original collection (Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim or Jāmiʿ at-Tirmidhī), with the exact reference. These versions sometimes contain a little more of the story, or put the clauses in a slightly different order, than the wording Ibn Rajab quotes.
>
> **One exception:** the narration of Muʿādh ibn Jabal at the end of hadith 50 (from Ibn Ḥibbān) is not on sunnah.com, so it is given in this book's own translation and is marked as such.

Spellings differ between translators (Hurayrah / Huraira, Ramadan / Ramadhan); they are left as sunnah.com has them.

Honorifics

ﷺ — *ṣallā Allāhu ʿalayhi wa sallam*: may Allah send blessings and peace upon him (said after the Prophet's name). **(ra)** / رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ — may Allah be pleased with him (said after the name of a Companion).

Grades used in this book

Ṣaḥīḥ (authentic): narrated by trustworthy, precise narrators with an unbroken chain, free of hidden defects. **Ḥasan** (good): the same, but with narrators slightly less precise; it is still acted upon. **Gharīb**: narrated through a single chain at some point; this describes the chain, not necessarily weakness. **Mursal**: a Successor narrates directly from the Prophet ﷺ without naming the Companion.



PART ONE

Foundations of the Religion

Hadith 1 – 10

1 Actions Are Judged by Intentions

2 Islam, Iman and Ihsan: The Hadith of Jibril

3 Islam Is Built on Five

4 The Creation of Man and the Writing of Destiny

5 Rejecting Innovations in the Religion

6 The Halal Is Clear and the Haram Is Clear

7 The Religion Is Sincere Advice

8 The Sanctity of a Muslim

9 Do What You Are Able

10 Allah Is Good and Accepts Only Good

HADITH 1 OF 50

1

Actions Are Judged by Intentions

الحَدِيثُ الأَوَّلُ

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/40hadith/1

The scale of every deed is inside the heart.

عَنْ أَمِيرِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ أَبِي حَفْصٍ عُمَرَ بْنِ الخَطَّابِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَقُولُ: «إِنَّمَا الأَعْمَالُ بِالنِّيَّاتِ، وَإِنَّمَا لِكُلِّ امْرِئٍ مَا نَوَى، فَمَنْ كَانَتْ هِجْرَتُهُ إِلَى اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ فَهِجْرَتُهُ إِلَى اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ، وَمَنْ كَانَتْ هِجْرَتُهُ لِدُنْيَا يُصِيبُهَا أَوِ امْرَأَةٍ يَنْكِحُهَا فَهِجْرَتُهُ إِلَى مَا هَاجَرَ إِلَيْهِ».

رَوَاهُ إِمَامَا الْمُحَدِّثِينَ: أَبُو عَبْدِ اللَّهِ مُحَمَّدُ بْنُ إِسْمَاعِيلَ الْبُخَارِيُّ، وَأَبُو الْحُسَيْنِ مُسْلِمُ بْنُ الْحَجَّاجِ الْقُشَيْرِيُّ النَّيْسَابُورِيُّ، فِي صَحِيحَيْهِمَا اللَّذَيْنِ هُمَا أَصَحُّ الْكُتُبِ الْمُصَنَّفَةِ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

It is narrated on the authority of Amirul Mu'minin, Abu Hafs 'Umar bin al-Khattab (ra) who said: I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say: "**Actions are (judged) by motives (niyyah), so each man will have what he intended. Thus, he whose migration (hijrah) was to Allah and His Messenger, his migration is to Allah and His Messenger; but he whose migration was for some worldly thing he might gain, or for a wife he might marry, his migration is to that for which he migrated.**"

[Bukhari & Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 1 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:1*

About the Narrator

ʿUmar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb d. 23 AH عُمَرُ بْنُ الخَطَّابِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Abū Ḥafṣ ʿUmar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb of Quraysh was at first a fierce enemy of Islam, until he heard the opening verses of Sūrah Ṭā-Hā and accepted Islam in Makkah around 6 years after the first revelation. The Prophet ﷺ had prayed for Islam to be strengthened by him, and after he became Muslim the believers prayed openly at the Kaʿbah. He was called **al-Fārūq** because Allah separated truth from falsehood through him. He became the second rightly guided caliph after Abū Bakr, ruled for ten years with famous justice and humility, founded the Hijri calendar, and saw Islam reach Shām, Iraq, Persia and Egypt. He was killed while leading the Fajr prayer in 23 AH and is buried beside the Prophet ﷺ and Abū Bakr.

Background of the Hadith سَبَبُ الوُرُود

Where it was said. In Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, ʿAlqamah ibn Waqqāṣ said: "I heard ʿUmar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb on the pulpit saying: I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say: 'Actions are only by intentions…'"[1] ʿUmar chose to announce it publicly to the people, showing how important it is.

The story of 'the Emigrant of Umm Qays'. ʿAbdullāh ibn Masʿūd said: "There was a man among us who proposed to a woman called Umm Qays. She refused to marry him unless he emigrated, so he emigrated and married her, and we used to call him 'the Emigrant of Umm Qays'." This story is authentic: aṭ-Ṭabarānī recorded it, and Ibn Ḥajar said its chain is authentic by the standards of al-Bukhārī and Muslim.[2]

A caution. Many later books say that this story was the reason the Prophet ﷺ said this hadith. But al-Ḥāfiẓ Ibn Rajab wrote in *Jāmiʿ al-ʿUlūm wa-l-Ḥikam*: "It is widely known that the story of the Emigrant of Umm Qays was the reason… but we have not found any authentic chain for that."[3] Ibn Ḥajar also noted that the narration does not say the hadith was spoken because of it.[4] So we take the story as a true example of what the hadith describes — one journey, two different intentions — without claiming it as the proven cause.

Explanatory Note

Imam an-Nawawī began his collection with this hadith, as al-Bukhārī began his Ṣaḥīḥ with it, to remind the reader to correct his intention before anything else. Imam ash-Shāfiʿī and Aḥmad said it is one third of knowledge[5], because a person acts with his heart, his tongue and his limbs, and the intention is the action of the heart that gives the other two their value.

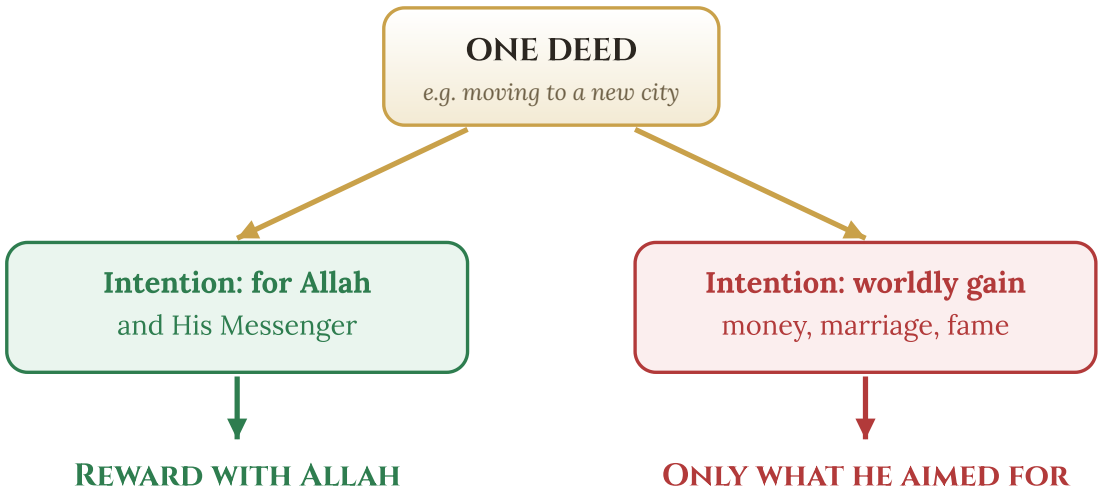
The hadith teaches two things. First, **an action is only valid with an intention**: a bath does not become ghusl, and hunger does not become a fast, unless one intends it. Intention also separates one act of worship from another (Ẓuhr from ʿAṣr) and worship from habit (sleeping to rest, or sleeping to be strong for the night prayer). Second, **the reward of a deed depends on its aim**: two people may do exactly the same thing outwardly, while one is rewarded and the other is not.

The Prophet ﷺ gave the example of hijrah, which outwardly is one journey. Whoever emigrated for Allah and His Messenger gets that reward; whoever emigrated for a business deal or to marry a woman gets only that. The intention is in the heart; it is not said aloud. It must be renewed often, because the heart turns. Ordinary permitted acts — eating, sleeping, working, studying — become worship when they are done with a good intention.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 1.

Picture

see and remember



The same outward deed, two different intentions, two different results.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. No deed is accepted by Allah unless it is done sincerely for Him (ikhlāṣ).
2. The intention is the act of the heart; saying it aloud is not required.
3. Everyday actions — eating, sleeping, working, studying — can earn reward when done with a good intention.
4. Showing off (riyā') destroys the reward of a deed, so the heart must be checked before, during and after it.
5. Allah looks at hearts and deeds, not at appearances and wealth.
6. A person may get the reward of a good deed he sincerely intended but could not do.
7. Teachers should start with this hadith: sincerity is the first lesson of all knowledge.

Step by Step

Checking your intention

1 Before
Ask yourself: 'Why am I doing this? For whom?' Make it for Allah.

2 During
If the thought of people's praise enters your heart, push it away and renew the intention.

3 After
Do not boast about the deed; thank Allah for enabling you.

4 Add more intentions
One deed can hold many good intentions: e.g. visiting a relative for kinship, for joy, and to follow the Sunnah.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 What are the two main things this hadith teaches about actions?

Q2 Where is the intention found, and do we need to say it aloud?

Q3 Why did the Prophet ﷺ use hijrah as the example?

Q4 Give two examples of ordinary actions that become worship with a good intention.

Q5 What is riyā', and why is it dangerous?

Q6 Why do you think scholars begin their books with this hadith?

Q7 **Choose one thing you do every day. What intention will you make for it from now on?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the first sentence: «إِنَّمَا الأَعْمَالُ بِالنِّيَّاتِ».	☐
Sun	Before school or work, intend to seek halal provision and benefit people for Allah's sake.	☐
Mon	Before eating, intend to gain strength to obey Allah — then say Bismillah.	☐
Tue	Do one good deed in secret that nobody will ever know about.	☐
Wed	Before sleeping, intend to wake for Fajr and to rest so you can worship.	☐
Thu	Write down three things you did today and the intention behind each.	☐
Fri	Teach this hadith to a family member and explain the hijrah example.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 2 OF 50

2

Islam, Iman and Ihsan: The Hadith of Jibril

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/40hadith/2

The whole religion explained in one gathering.

عَنْ عُمَرَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ أَيْضًا قَالَ: بَيْنَمَا نَحْنُ جُلُوسٌ عِنْدَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ ذَاتَ يَوْمٍ، إِذْ طَلَعَ عَلَيْنَا رَجُلٌ شَدِيدُ بَيَاضِ الثِّيَابِ، شَدِيدُ سَوَادِ الشَّعْرِ، لَا يُرَى عَلَيْهِ أَثَرُ السَّفَرِ، وَلَا يَعْرِفُهُ مِنَّا أَحَدٌ، حَتَّى جَلَسَ إِلَى النَّبِيِّ ﷺ، فَأَسْنَدَ رُكْبَتَيْهِ إِلَى رُكْبَتَيْهِ، وَوَضَعَ كَفَّيْهِ عَلَى فَخِذَيْهِ، وَقَالَ: يَا مُحَمَّدُ، أَخْبِرْنِي عَنِ الإِسْلَامِ.

فَقَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: **الإِسْلَامُ أَنْ تَشْهَدَ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَأَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ، وَتُقِيمَ الصَّلَاةَ، وَتُؤْتِيَ الزَّكَاةَ، وَتَصُومَ رَمَضَانَ، وَتَحُجَّ الْبَيْتَ إِنِ اسْتَطَعْتَ إِلَيْهِ سَبِيلًا.** قَالَ: صَدَقْتَ. فَعَجِبْنَا لَهُ يَسْأَلُهُ وَيُصَدِّقُهُ!

قَالَ: فَأَخْبِرْنِي عَنِ الإِيمَانِ. قَالَ: **أَنْ تُؤْمِنَ بِاللَّهِ، وَمَلَائِكَتِهِ، وَكُتُبِهِ، وَرُسُلِهِ، وَالْيَوْمِ الآخِرِ، وَتُؤْمِنَ بِالْقَدَرِ خَيْرِهِ وَشَرِّهِ.** قَالَ: صَدَقْتَ.

قَالَ: فَأَخْبِرْنِي عَنِ الإِحْسَانِ. قَالَ: **أَنْ تَعْبُدَ اللَّهَ كَأَنَّكَ تَرَاهُ، فَإِنْ لَمْ تَكُنْ تَرَاهُ فَإِنَّهُ يَرَاكَ.**

قَالَ: فَأَخْبِرْنِي عَنِ السَّاعَةِ. قَالَ: **مَا الْمَسْؤُولُ عَنْهَا بِأَعْلَمَ مِنَ السَّائِلِ.**

قَالَ: فَأَخْبِرْنِي عَنْ أَمَارَاتِهَا. قَالَ: **أَنْ تَلِدَ الأَمَةُ رَبَّتَهَا، وَأَنْ تَرَى الْحُفَاةَ الْعُرَاةَ الْعَالَةَ رِعَاءَ الشَّاءِ يَتَطَاوَلُونَ فِي الْبُنْيَانِ.**

ثُمَّ انْطَلَقَ، فَلَبِثْتُ مَلِيًّا، ثُمَّ قَالَ: **يَا عُمَرُ، أَتَدْرِي مَنِ السَّائِلُ؟** قُلْتُ: اللَّهُ وَرَسُولُهُ أَعْلَمُ. قَالَ: **فَإِنَّهُ جِبْرِيلُ أَتَاكُمْ يُعَلِّمُكُمْ دِينَكُمْ.**

رَوَاهُ مُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

Also on the authority of `Umar (ra) who said: While we were one day sitting with the Messenger of Allah ﷺ there appeared before us a man dressed in extremely white clothes and with very black hair. No traces of journeying were visible on him, and none of us knew him. He sat down close by the Prophet ﷺ rested his knees against the knees of the Prophet ﷺ and placed his palms over his thighs, and said: "O Muhammad! Inform me about Islam."

The Messenger of Allah ﷺ replied: "**Islam is that you should testify that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah and that Muhammad is His Messenger ﷺ, that you should perform salah (ritual prayer), pay the zakah, fast during Ramadan, and perform Hajj (pilgrimage) to the House (the Ka`bah at Makkah), if you can find a way to it (or find the means for making the journey to it)**." He said: "You have spoken the truth."

We were astonished at his thus questioning him ﷺ and then telling him that he was right, but he went on to say, "Inform me about Iman (faith)." He (the Prophet) answered, "**It is that you believe in Allah and His angels and His Books and His Messengers and in the Last Day, and in fate (qadar), both in its good and in its evil aspects.**" He said, "You have spoken the truth."

Then he (the man) said, "Inform me about Ihsan." He (the Prophet) answered, "**It is that you should serve Allah as though you could see Him, for though you cannot see Him yet He sees you.**"

He said, "Inform me about the Hour." He (the Prophet) said, "**About that the one questioned knows no more than the questioner.**" So he said, "Well, inform me about its signs." He said, "**They are that the slave-girl will give birth to her mistress and that you will see the barefooted ones, the naked, the destitute, the herdsmen of the sheep (competing with each other) in raising lofty buildings.**"

Thereupon the man went off. I waited a while, and then he (the Prophet) said, "**O `Umar, do you know who that questioner was?**" I replied, "Allah and His Messenger know better." He said, "**That was Jibril. He came to teach you your religion.**"

[Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 2 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:2*

About the Narrator

ʿUmar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb d. 23 AH

عُمَرُ بْنُ الخَطَّابِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Biography: see Hadith 1.

ʿUmar was present in the gathering and saw the visit of Jibrīl in the form of a man.

Background of the Hadith

سَبَبُ الوُرُود

Why Ibn ʿUmar narrated it. Yaḥyā ibn Yaʿmar said that the first person in Basra to deny qadar (Allah's decree) was Maʿbad al-Juhanī. Yaḥyā and Ḥumayd ibn ʿAbd ar-Raḥmān went for Hajj or ʿUmrah, hoping to meet a Companion to ask about it. They met ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿUmar in the mosque and told him about people who claimed there is no qadar and that matters happen without being known beforehand.

Ibn ʿUmar said: "If you meet them, tell them that I am free of them and they are free of me. By the One by whom ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿUmar swears, if one of them had gold like Mount Uḥud and spent it, Allah would not accept it from him until he believes in qadar." Then he said: "My father ʿUmar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb told me…" and narrated this hadith of Jibrīl, which includes belief in qadar, its good and its bad, as a pillar of faith.[1]

Explanatory Note

This is called the 'Mother of the Sunnah' because it gathers the whole religion. Jibrīl came in the form of an unknown man with very white clothes and very black hair, without any sign of travel — which amazed the Companions — and sat close to the Prophet ﷺ like a student before his teacher. He asked about **Islam, Īmān, Iḥsān, the Hour and its signs**, and at the end the Prophet ﷺ said: "That was Jibrīl; he came to teach you your religion."

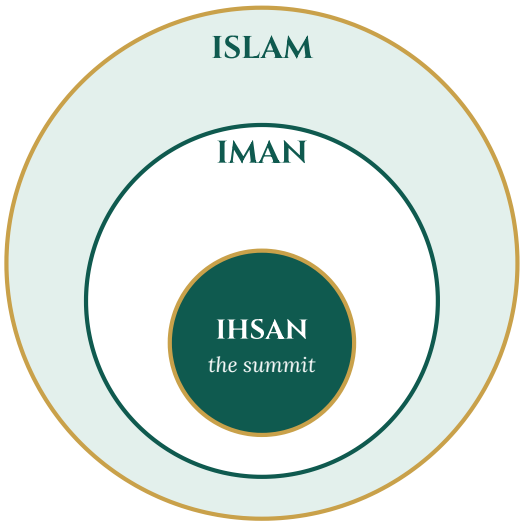
Islam is the outward submission: the five pillars. **Īmān** is the inward belief in six pillars: Allah, His angels, His books, His messengers, the Last Day, and the decree, its good and its bad. When the two words are mentioned together, Islam refers to the outward deeds and Īmān to the inward beliefs; when one is mentioned alone it includes the other. **Iḥsān** is the highest level: to worship Allah as though you see Him, and if you cannot reach that, then to remember that He sees you.

No one knows the time of the Hour except Allah — not even the Prophet ﷺ or Jibrīl. But its signs were mentioned: the slave-woman giving birth to her mistress (understood as children treating their mothers like servants, or the spread of slavery and change of social order), and poor, barefoot shepherds competing in building tall buildings. The hadith also teaches manners of learning: sitting close, asking good questions, and saying 'Allah knows best' about what one does not know.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 2.

Picture

see and remember



Islam — the outward deeds
5 pillars: Shahadah, Salah, Zakah, Sawm, Hajj

Iman — the inward beliefs
6 pillars: Allah, angels, books, messengers, Last Day, qadar

Ihsan — the highest level
Worship Allah as if you see Him; He surely sees you

Three levels of the religion: every muḥsin is a believer, and every believer is a Muslim.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. The religion has three levels: Islam, Īmān and Iḥsān, each higher than the one before.
2. Islam is built on five outward pillars; Īmān on six inward pillars.
3. Belief in qadar — Allah's decree, its good and its bad — is part of faith.
4. Iḥsān means worshipping Allah with full awareness that He sees you.
5. Only Allah knows when the Hour will come; whoever claims to know it is lying.
6. A student should be clean, well-dressed, close to his teacher and polite in asking.
7. It is a virtue to say 'Allah knows best' about what you do not know.
8. Asking good questions is a way of teaching others.

Step by Step

Climbing towards Iḥsān in your prayer

1. **Prepare**
   Make wudu carefully and arrive early, leaving your phone and worries aside.

2. **Remember who you face**
   Before the takbir, remind yourself: Allah sees me now.

3. **Understand**
   Learn the meaning of al-Fātiḥah and the words of rukūʿ and sujūd.

4 Slow down
Be still in every position; do not rush.

5 Review
After salah, ask: 'Was my heart present? What can I improve next time?'

Questions

think, then write

Q1 How did the visitor look, and why were the Companions surprised by him?

Q2 List the five pillars of Islam and the six pillars of Īmān.

Q3 Explain Iḥsān in your own words, with its two levels.

Q4 What did the Prophet ﷺ answer when asked about the Hour, and what does it teach us?

Q5 Name the two signs of the Hour mentioned in the hadith.

Q6 What manners of a student can we learn from how Jibrīl sat and asked?

Q7 Which of the three levels do you most want to improve in, and how?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the definition of Iḥsān: «أَنْ تَعْبُدَ اللَّهَ كَأَنَّكَ تَرَاهُ...».	☐
Sun	Write the 5 pillars of Islam and the 6 pillars of Īmān from memory.	☐
Mon	Pray one salah today as slowly and attentively as you can.	☐
Tue	Learn the meaning of one verse of al-Fātiḥah in detail.	☐
Wed	Say 'Allah knows best' instead of guessing when you do not know something.	☐
Thu	Sit with a teacher or parent and ask them one good question about the religion.	☐
Fri	Before sleeping, think about one moment today when you remembered that Allah sees you.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

3

HADITH 3 OF 50

Islam Is Built on Five

الحَدِيثُ الثَّالِثُ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/3

The pillars that hold up the house of Islam.

عَنْ أَبِي عَبْدِ الرَّحْمَنِ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ عُمَرَ بْنِ الخَطَّابِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا قَالَ: سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَقُولُ: «بُنِيَ الإِسْلَامُ عَلَى خَمْسٍ: شَهَادَةِ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَأَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ، وَإِقَامِ الصَّلَاةِ، وَإِيتَاءِ الزَّكَاةِ، وَحَجِّ البَيْتِ، وَصَوْمِ رَمَضَانَ».

رَوَاهُ البُخَارِيُّ وَمُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abdullah, the son of Umar ibn al-Khattab (ra), who said: I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say, "**Islam has been built on five [pillars]: testifying that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allah and that Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah, establishing the salah (prayer), paying the zakat (obligatory charity), making the hajj (pilgrimage) to the House, and fasting in Ramadhan.**"

[Bukhari & Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 3 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:3*

About the Narrator

ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿUmar — d. 73 AH

عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ عُمَرَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا

The son of ʿUmar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb, he accepted Islam as a child in Makkah and emigrated with his father. He was too young for Badr and Uḥud, and his first battle was the Trench. He was famous for following the Sunnah in the smallest details — praying where the Prophet ﷺ prayed and stopping where he stopped — and for his night prayer, generosity and avoiding the disputes of his time. He is among the Companions who narrated the most hadith, and gave fatwas for sixty years. He died in Makkah in 73 AH, one of the last of the great Companions there.

Background of the Hadith

سَبَبُ الوُرُود

Ibn ʿUmar answers a question. In Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Nāfiʿ reported that during the years of civil strife a man came to Ibn ʿUmar and asked: "Why do you perform Hajj one year and ʿUmrah another, and leave jihad in the path of Allah?" Ibn ʿUmar replied: "O son of my brother, Islam is built on five..." and narrated this hadith, showing that his religion rested on its pillars, and that he would not join fighting between Muslims.[1]

The order of the pillars. In Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim, when Ibn ʿUmar narrated the hadith, a man repeated it back as "...Hajj, and fasting Ramadan." Ibn ʿUmar corrected him: "No — fasting Ramadan, and Hajj. This is how I heard it from the Messenger of Allah ﷺ."[2] Both orders are found in the narrations, and the Companions were careful to repeat the words exactly as they heard them.

Explanatory Note

The Prophet ﷺ compared Islam to a building that stands on five pillars. The rest of the building — the other obligations and good deeds — rests on them. If a pillar is missing, the building is weak; if the main pillar is removed, the building falls. The first pillar, the **two testimonies**, is the foundation of all of them: no deed is accepted without it.

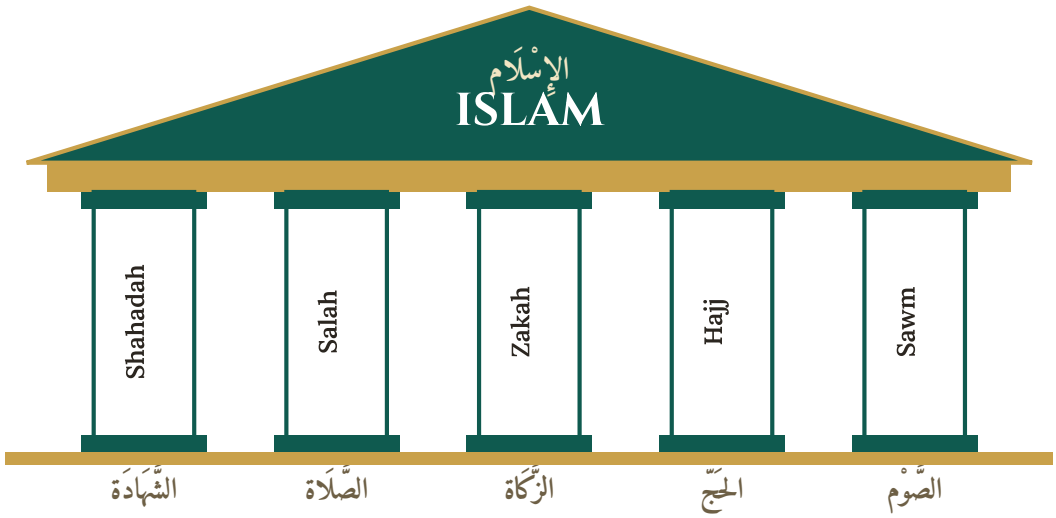
The **testimony** means: there is nothing worthy of worship in truth except Allah, and Muhammad ﷺ is His servant and messenger, so we worship Allah alone in the way the Messenger taught. **Salah** is the pillar most connected to the testimony; the Prophet ﷺ said that between a man and disbelief is abandoning the prayer[3]. **Zakah** purifies wealth and supports the poor. **Hajj** is obligatory once in a lifetime on whoever is able. **Fasting Ramadan** trains taqwā.

These five are the clearest outward marks of a Muslim, and whoever denies any of them has left Islam. Whoever neglects one of them out of laziness has weakened his building and is in great danger, especially with the prayer.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 3.

Picture

see and remember



Islam pictured as a building: the roof rests on five pillars.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Islam is like a building: it cannot stand without its pillars.
2. The two testimonies are the first and greatest pillar; all others depend on them.
3. Salah is the most important pillar after the testimony.
4. Zakah, fasting and Hajj each have conditions, and Hajj is once in a lifetime for the able.
5. Denying any of the five pillars takes a person out of Islam.
6. The Prophet ﷺ used examples from daily life to make knowledge easy to understand.

Step by Step

Making the five pillars strong in your life

1. **Shahadah**
   Learn its meaning and its conditions; live by it, not just say it.

2. **Salah**
   Pray all five on time; start with the one you most often miss.

3. **Zakah**
   Learn the niṣāb and calculate your zakah each lunar year; give charity meanwhile.

4. **Sawm**
   Prepare for Ramadan early with voluntary Monday and Thursday fasts.

5 Hajj

Make the intention, save for it, and learn its rites before going.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 What did the Prophet ﷺ compare Islam to in this hadith? Why is this a good example?

Q2 Name the five pillars in the order of this narration.

Q3 Why is the shahadah the foundation of all the other pillars?

Q4 Which pillar is described as the dividing line between a person and disbelief?

Q5 Who must perform Hajj, and how many times?

Q6 Which pillar do you find hardest to keep perfectly? Write a plan to strengthen it.

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith in Arabic.	☐
Sun	Draw the building of Islam with its five pillars and label each one.	☐
Mon	Pray every salah of the day within its time.	☐
Tue	Learn the meaning of «لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ» and explain it to someone.	☐
Wed	Give a small charity today, even a coin.	☐
Thu	Make an intention to fast a voluntary day (Monday or Thursday).	☐
Fri	Watch or read about the steps of Hajj and make du'a to perform it.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 4 OF 50

4

The Creation of Man and the Writing of Destiny

الحَدِيثُ الرَّابِعُ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/4

From a drop to a soul — and the importance of the final deed.

عَنْ أَبِي عَبْدِ الرَّحْمَنِ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ مَسْعُودٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: حَدَّثَنَا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ - وَهُوَ الصَّادِقُ المَصْدُوقُ -: «إِنَّ أَحَدَكُمْ يُجْمَعُ خَلْقُهُ فِي بَطْنِ أُمِّهِ أَرْبَعِينَ يَوْمًا نُطْفَةً، ثُمَّ يَكُونُ عَلَقَةً مِثْلَ ذَلِكَ، ثُمَّ يَكُونُ مُضْغَةً مِثْلَ ذَلِكَ، ثُمَّ يُرْسَلُ إِلَيْهِ المَلَكُ فَيَنْفُخُ فِيهِ الرُّوحَ، وَيُؤْمَرُ بِأَرْبَعِ كَلِمَاتٍ: بِكَتْبِ رِزْقِهِ، وَأَجَلِهِ، وَعَمَلِهِ، وَشَقِيٌّ أَوْ سَعِيدٌ.

فَوَاللَّهِ الَّذِي لَا إِلَهَ غَيْرُهُ، إِنَّ أَحَدَكُمْ لَيَعْمَلُ بِعَمَلِ أَهْلِ الجَنَّةِ حَتَّى مَا يَكُونُ بَيْنَهُ وَبَيْنَهَا إِلَّا ذِرَاعٌ، فَيَسْبِقُ عَلَيْهِ الكِتَابُ فَيَعْمَلُ بِعَمَلِ أَهْلِ النَّارِ فَيَدْخُلُهَا، وَإِنَّ أَحَدَكُمْ لَيَعْمَلُ بِعَمَلِ أَهْلِ النَّارِ حَتَّى مَا يَكُونُ بَيْنَهُ وَبَيْنَهَا إِلَّا ذِرَاعٌ، فَيَسْبِقُ عَلَيْهِ الكِتَابُ فَيَعْمَلُ بِعَمَلِ أَهْلِ الجَنَّةِ فَيَدْخُلُهَا».

رَوَاهُ البُخَارِيُّ وَمُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abdullah ibn Masood (ra), who said: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ, and he is the truthful, the believed, narrated to us, **"Verily the creation of each one of you is brought together in his mother's womb for forty days in the form of a nutfah (a drop), then he becomes an alaqah (clot of blood) for a like period, then a mudghah (morsel of flesh) for a like period, then there is sent to him the angel who blows his soul into him and who is commanded with four matters: to write down his rizq (sustenance), his life span, his actions, and whether he will be happy or unhappy (i.e., whether or not he will enter Paradise).**

By the One, other than Whom there is no deity, verily one of you performs the actions of the people of Paradise until there is but an arms length between him and it, and that which has been written overtakes him, and so he acts with the actions of the people of the Hellfire and thus enters it; and verily one of you performs the actions of the people of the Hellfire, until there is but an arms length between him and it, and that which has been written overtakes him and so he acts with the actions of the people of Paradise and thus he enters it."

[Bukhari & Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 4 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:4*

About the Narrator

ʿAbdullāh ibn Masʿūd (عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ مَسْعُودٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ) — d. 32 AH

A young shepherd of Makkah and among the first six people to accept Islam, he was the first to recite the Qur'an aloud at the Kaʿbah, and was beaten for it. He served the Prophet ﷺ closely, carrying his sandals and his siwāk. The Prophet ﷺ said: "Whoever would like to recite the Qur'an fresh as it was revealed, let him recite it like Ibn Umm ʿAbd." He was one of the greatest scholars of the Qur'an and fiqh, and ʿUmar sent him to teach the people of Kūfah. He died in Madinah in 32 AH.

Explanatory Note

This hadith describes the stages of the human being in the womb: forty days as a *nuṭfah* (drop), then as an *ʿalaqah* (something that clings), then as a *muḍghah* (a chewed-like lump). Then an angel is sent who breathes the soul into it and is commanded to write four things: the person's provision, life-span, deeds, and whether he will be wretched or happy. Ibn Masʿūd introduced it by calling the Prophet ﷺ 'the truthful and believed' because it tells of matters of the unseen.

The hadith confirms belief in **qadar**: Allah knows and has written everything. But this knowledge does not force anyone. Every person chooses and acts, and will be judged for his choices. When the

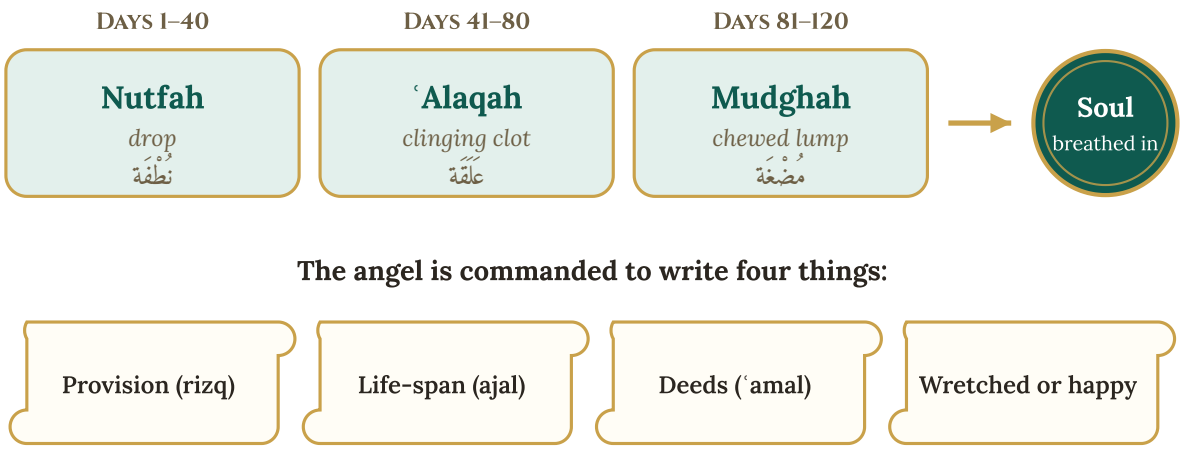
Companions asked why they should act if everything is written, the Prophet ﷺ said: "Act, for each person is eased towards what he was created for."[1]

The last part warns us that **deeds are judged by how they end**. In another narration: "...a person does the deeds of the people of Paradise *as it appears to the people*."[2] So the one who ends badly was not truly sincere in his heart; and the one who ends well was given the gift of repentance. This makes the believer humble, never proud of his deeds, always fearing a bad ending and hoping for a good one, and asking Allah for steadfastness.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 4.

Picture

see and remember



The stages of creation, the breathing of the soul and the four things that are written.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Allah creates the human being in stages, by His wisdom and power.
2. Belief in qadar: our provision, life-span, deeds and final destination are known and written by Allah.
3. Qadar is no excuse for laziness or sin; we are commanded to act and strive.
4. Deeds are judged by their endings, so no one should be proud or feel safe.
5. No one should despair of a sinner; he may end his life in goodness.
6. The soul is breathed in after 120 days; the life of the unborn child must be respected.
7. We should often ask Allah to keep our hearts firm upon His religion.

Step by Step

Working for a good ending

1. **Sincerity**
   Keep checking that your deeds are for Allah, inside as well as outside.

2. **Consistency**
   Keep a small deed every day; the most loved deeds are the regular ones.

3. **Quick repentance**
   Do not delay tawbah; you do not know when your life ends.

4. **Good company**
   Stay with people who remind you of Allah.

5. **Du'a**
   Say often: «يَا مُقَلِّبَ القُلُوبِ ثَبِّتْ قَلْبِي عَلَى دِينِكَ».

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **Name the three stages in the womb and how long each lasts.**

Q2 **What four things is the angel commanded to write?**

Q3 **Why did Ibn Mas'ūd call the Prophet ﷺ 'the truthful, the believed'?**

Q4 **If everything is written, why do we still need to work? Use the Prophet's ﷺ answer.**

Q5 **Explain the meaning of 'the book overtakes him'.**

Q6 **How should this hadith affect the way we look at sinners, and at ourselves?**

Q7 **What will you do this week to work for a good ending?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the first part, up to «وَشَقِيٌّ أَوْ سَعِيدٌ…».	☐
Sun	Say «يَا مُقَلِّبَ القُلُوبِ ثَبِّتْ قَلْبِي عَلَى دِينِكَ» seven times after one salah.	☐
Mon	Choose one small daily deed and keep it every day this week.	☐
Tue	Thank Allah for your creation; reflect on one wonder of your own body.	☐
Wed	Make sincere tawbah from one sin you keep repeating.	☐
Thu	Avoid looking down on anyone today; you do not know their ending.	☐
Fri	Ask Allah for a good ending (ḥusn al-khātimah) in your sujūd.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 5 OF 50

5

Rejecting Innovations in the Religion

الحَدِيثُ الخَامِسُ

Listen & study online
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/40hadith/5

Worship is accepted only in the way the Prophet ﷺ taught.

عَنْ أُمِّ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ أُمِّ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ عَائِشَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا قَالَتْ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «مَنْ أَحْدَثَ فِي أَمْرِنَا هَذَا مَا لَيْسَ مِنْهُ فَهُوَ رَدٌّ». رَوَاهُ الْبُخَارِيُّ وَمُسْلِمٌ.

وَفِي رِوَايَةٍ لِمُسْلِمٍ: «مَنْ عَمِلَ عَمَلًا لَيْسَ عَلَيْهِ أَمْرُنَا فَهُوَ رَدٌّ».

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of the mother of the faithful, Aisha (ra), who said: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "**He who innovates something in this matter of ours (i.e., Islam) that is not of it will have it rejected (by Allah).**" [Bukhari & Muslim]

In another version in Muslim it reads: "**He who does an act which we have not commanded, will have it rejected (by Allah).**"

Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 5 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:5*

About the Narrator

ʿĀʾishah bint Abī Bakr — d. 57 AH

عَائِشَةُ أُمُّ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا

The daughter of Abū Bakr aṣ-Ṣiddīq and the beloved wife of the Prophet ﷺ, she is a Mother of the Believers. Allah declared her innocence in Sūrah an-Nūr. She had a sharp memory and deep understanding, and became one of the greatest scholars of the Ummah: senior Companions came to ask her about the Sunnah, fiqh, poetry and medicine. She narrated over two thousand hadith, especially about the Prophet's ﷺ life at home. The Prophet ﷺ passed away in her room, with his head on her chest. She died in Madinah in 57 AH.

Explanatory Note

Scholars say this hadith is the scale for **outward** deeds, just as Hadith 1 is the scale for **inward** deeds. A deed is accepted by Allah only when it has two conditions: it is done **sincerely for Allah** and it is done **according to the Sunnah** of the Prophet ﷺ. If either is missing, the deed is rejected (*radd*).

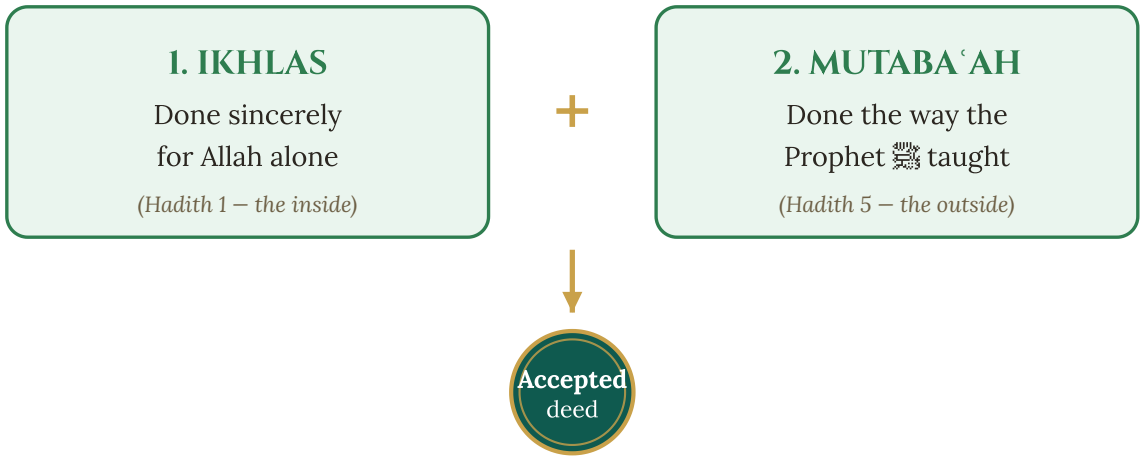
The words "in this matter of ours" mean the religion: acts of worship and beliefs. Inventing new ways of worship — new prayers, new festivals, special numbers or times of dhikr with no evidence — is what is meant by *bidʿah*. Allah has completed the religion (al-Mā'idah 5:3)[1], so there is no need to add to it. Worldly matters, like new technology, transport and ways of organising life, are not included: they are permitted unless there is a text against them.

The second narration, in Muslim, is even more general: "Whoever does a deed that is not according to our matter, it is rejected." It includes the person who did not invent the innovation himself but follows it. The hadith also covers contracts and dealings: a contract that goes against the Shariah is void, as the Prophet ﷺ ruled about conditions that are not in the Book of Allah[2].

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 5.

Picture

see and remember



The two conditions of an accepted deed: sincerity inside, following the Sunnah outside.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. A deed is accepted only with sincerity (Hadith 1) and following the Sunnah (Hadith 5).
2. The religion is complete; adding new acts of worship is rejected.
3. Good intentions do not make an innovation acceptable.
4. New worldly inventions are not bidʿah; the rule in worldly matters is permission.

5 Contracts and dealings that break the Shariah are invalid.

6 We must learn the Sunnah in order to follow it correctly.

7 Following is safer and more rewarding than inventing.

Step by Step

Checking whether an act of worship is from the Sunnah

1 **Ask for the evidence**
What verse or authentic hadith is this based on?

2 **Check the form**
Is the time, number, place and way the same as the Prophet ﷺ taught?

3 **Ask the people of knowledge**
Ask a trusted scholar if you are unsure.

4 **Follow with love**
Do it as the Prophet ﷺ did — no more, no less.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **What does 'it is rejected' (radd) mean?**

Q2 **What are the two conditions for a deed to be accepted? Which hadith gives each one?**

Q3 **What is meant by 'this matter of ours'?**

Q4 **Is using a phone or a car a bidʿah? Why or why not?**

Q5 **What extra meaning does the narration in Muslim add?**

Q6 **Why can a good intention not make an innovation acceptable?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise both narrations of the hadith.	☐
Sun	Learn the Sunnah way of making wudu and practise it.	☐
Mon	Learn one authentic morning dhikr with its source.	☐
Tue	Check the source of one practice you do; ask a teacher if unsure.	☐
Wed	Read al-Mā'idah 5:3 and its meaning: the religion has been completed.	☐
Thu	Pray two sunnah rakʿahs exactly as described in the authentic hadith.	☐
Fri	Share this hadith with a friend and explain the two conditions.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 6 OF 50

6

The Halal Is Clear and the Haram Is Clear

الحَدِيثُ السَّادِسُ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/6

Guard the boundaries — and guard the heart.

عَنْ أَبِي عَبْدِ اللَّهِ النُّعْمَانِ بْنِ بَشِيرٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا قَالَ: سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَقُولُ: «إِنَّ الحَلَالَ بَيِّنٌ، وَإِنَّ الحَرَامَ بَيِّنٌ، وَبَيْنَهُمَا أُمُورٌ مُشْتَبِهَاتٌ لَا يَعْلَمُهُنَّ كَثِيرٌ مِنَ النَّاسِ، فَمَنِ اتَّقَى الشُّبُهَاتِ فَقَدِ اسْتَبْرَأَ لِدِينِهِ وَعِرْضِهِ، وَمَنْ وَقَعَ فِي الشُّبُهَاتِ وَقَعَ فِي الحَرَامِ، كَالرَّاعِي يَرْعَى حَوْلَ الحِمَى يُوشِكُ أَنْ يَرْتَعَ فِيهِ، أَلَا وَإِنَّ لِكُلِّ مَلِكٍ حِمًى، أَلَا وَإِنَّ حِمَى اللَّهِ مَحَارِمُهُ، أَلَا وَإِنَّ فِي الجَسَدِ مُضْغَةً إِذَا صَلَحَتْ صَلَحَ الجَسَدُ كُلُّهُ، وَإِذَا فَسَدَتْ فَسَدَ الجَسَدُ كُلُّهُ، أَلَا وَهِيَ القَلْبُ».

رَوَاهُ البُخَارِيُّ وَمُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of an-Nu'man ibn Basheer (ra), who said: I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say, "**That which is lawful is clear and that which is unlawful is clear, and between the two of them are doubtful matters about which many people do not know. Thus he who avoids doubtful matters clears himself in regard to his religion and his honor, but he who falls into doubtful matters [eventually] falls into that which is unlawful, like the shepherd who pastures around a sanctuary, all but grazing therein. Truly every king has a sanctuary, and truly Allah's sanctuary is His prohibitions.**

Truly in the body there is a morsel of flesh, which, if it be whole, all the body is whole, and which, if it is diseased, all of [the body] is diseased. Truly, it is the heart."

[Bukhari & Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 6 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:6*

About the Narrator

An-Nuʿmān ibn Bashīr d. 65 AH

النُّعْمَانُ بْنُ بَشِيرٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا

The first child born to the Anṣār after the Hijrah; his parents were both Companions. He was only about eight when the Prophet ﷺ died, yet he narrated this hadith clearly, pointing to his ears and saying he heard it himself. He later became a governor of Kūfah and Ḥimṣ, a judge and a poet, known for his gentleness. He was killed in the troubles of 65 AH.

Explanatory Note

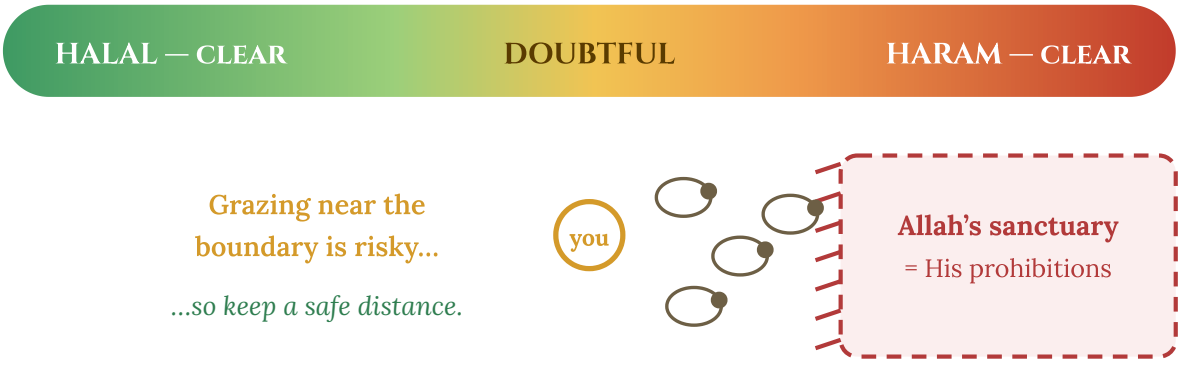
Things are of three kinds. **Clear halal**, like bread, water and honest trade. **Clear haram**, like alcohol, theft and interest. And **doubtful matters** (*mushtabihāt*) between them, which many people do not know the ruling of — either because the evidence is unclear, or the scholars differ, or because a person is unsure about the source of something. Those who have knowledge know their ruling; others should stay away from them.

Whoever avoids doubtful matters protects his **religion** (from falling into haram) and his **honour** (from people's criticism). Whoever keeps falling into doubtful matters will soon fall into the haram, like a shepherd who lets his sheep graze right next to a king's private pasture: before long they will enter it. Allah's private pasture (*ḥimā*) is everything He has forbidden.

The hadith ends with the **heart**: a small piece of flesh which, if it is sound, the whole body becomes sound, and if it is corrupt, the whole body becomes corrupt. The limbs follow the heart. A heart full of love and fear of Allah keeps the body away from the haram and even the doubtful. So the cure for our deeds starts by curing the heart.

Picture

see and remember



The heart is the king of the body: guard it and the limbs follow.

Clear halal, doubtful matters, and clear haram: the wise shepherd stays far from the boundary.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Allah has made the halal and the haram clear in general.
2. Doubtful matters should be avoided by those who do not know their ruling.
3. Avoiding doubt protects both your religion and your reputation.
4. Small sins and doubts are the road to big sins.
5. Allah's boundaries are His prohibitions; respect them.
6. The heart is the king of the body; reforming the heart reforms actions.
7. Scholars are needed to explain the rulings of doubtful matters.

Step by Step

What to do when you face a doubtful matter

1. **Pause**
   Do not rush into it just because others do.
2. **Ask**
   Ask someone with knowledge about the ruling (an-Naḥl 16:43).
3. **Check your heart**
   If it still feels uneasy, leave it for what is clearly fine (Hadith 11).
4. **Replace**
   Find a clearly halal alternative.
5. **Strengthen the heart**
   Make du'a and dhikr; a living heart recognises the haram.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **What are the three kinds of things mentioned in this hadith? Give an example of each.**

Q2 **Why do many people not know the ruling of doubtful matters?**

Q3 **What two things does a person protect by avoiding doubtful matters?**

Q4 **Explain the example of the shepherd and the private pasture.**

Q5 **What is the 'piece of flesh', and why is it so important?**

Q6 **Think of a doubtful matter young people face today. What would you do?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the final part: «أَلَا وَإِنَّ فِي الجَسَدِ مُضْغَةً...».	☐
Sun	Check the ingredients of one food product before buying it.	☐
Mon	Leave one thing this week that you are not sure is halal.	☐
Tue	Ask a teacher about one doubtful matter you have wondered about.	☐
Wed	Make du'a: «اللَّهُمَّ أَصْلِحْ قَلْبِي».	☐
Thu	Stay away from one place or app that leads you near haram.	☐
Fri	Draw the shepherd and the boundary picture and explain it to someone.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

7

HADITH 7 OF 50

The Religion Is Sincere Advice

الحَدِيثُ السَّابِعُ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/7

Wanting good for everyone you deal with — and showing it.

عَنْ أَبِي رُقَيَّةَ تَمِيمِ بْنِ أَوْسٍ الدَّارِيِّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ أَنَّ النَّبِيَّ ﷺ قَالَ: «الدِّينُ النَّصِيحَةُ». قُلْنَا: لِمَنْ؟ قَالَ: «لِلَّهِ، وَلِكِتَابِهِ، وَلِرَسُولِهِ، وَلِأَئِمَّةِ الْمُسْلِمِينَ وَعَامَّتِهِمْ».

رَوَاهُ مُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Tameem ibn Aus ad-Daree (ra): The Prophet ﷺ said, "**The deen (religion) is naseehah (advice, sincerity).**" We said, "To whom?" He ﷺ said, "**To Allah, His Book, His Messenger, and to the leaders of the Muslims and their common folk.**"

[Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 7 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:7*

About the Narrator

Tamīm ibn Aws ad-Dārī (d. 40 AH)

تَمِيمُ بْنُ أَوْسٍ الدَّارِيُّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

A Christian monk from Palestine who came to Madinah and accepted Islam in 9 AH. He was famous for long night prayers, sometimes reciting the whole Qur'an in one rakʿah. He was the first to light lamps in the Prophet's Mosque. The Prophet ﷺ himself narrated from him the story of the Dajjāl (Muslim). This hadith on naṣīḥah is the only one Muslim records from him. He settled in Palestine and died around 40 AH.

Explanatory Note

Naṣīḥah is a beautiful Arabic word that means to sincerely want good for someone and to act on it. It comes from purifying honey and from sewing a garment tightly. The Prophet ﷺ said that the whole religion is *naṣīḥah*, as if to say: this is its heart. When asked, "To whom?", he named five.

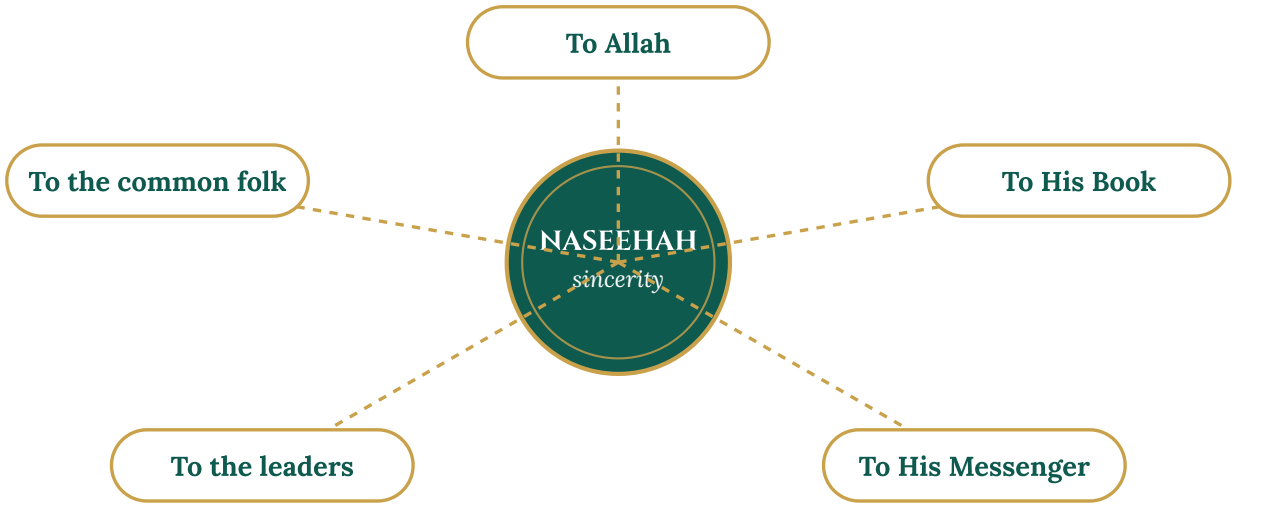
To Allah: believing in Him, worshipping Him alone, obeying Him and loving what He loves. **To His Book**: believing it is His word, reciting it properly, understanding and acting on it, and defending it. **To His Messenger**: believing him, obeying him, loving him, following his Sunnah and reviving it. **To**

the leaders of the Muslims: helping them in the truth, obeying them in good, advising them gently and privately, and not rebelling against them. Scholars are also included among the 'leaders'. **To the common Muslims**: guiding them, covering their faults, loving for them what you love for yourself, and teaching them what they do not know.

Advice should be given sincerely, privately and gently. Whoever advises you in public has embarrassed you, as the scholars said. And the one who receives advice should accept it with thanks, even if it is hard to hear.

Picture

see and remember



Naṣīḥah to five: Allah, His Book, His Messenger, the leaders and the common Muslims.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Sincere goodwill is the essence of the whole religion.
2. Naṣīḥah is owed to Allah, His Book, His Messenger, the leaders and all Muslims.
3. Advice to Allah benefits the one who gives it, for Allah does not need anyone.
4. Advice to leaders should be given wisely and, where possible, privately.
5. Advice to people includes teaching, guiding and covering their faults.
6. Good manners in advising: gentle words, right time, private place.
7. Accepting advice is a sign of humility.

Step by Step

How to give advice the right way

1. **Purify your intention**
   Advise to help, not to show you are better.

2 **Be sure**
Make sure the matter is really a mistake, with knowledge.

3 **Choose the moment**
Speak in private, at a calm time.

4 **Speak gently**
Start with something good, then advise kindly.

5 **Make du'a**
Pray for the person, whether they accept or not.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 What is the meaning of naṣīḥah? Where does the word come from?

Q2 List the five that naṣīḥah is owed to.

Q3 How can a person be sincere to the Book of Allah?

Q4 Why is advice to leaders best given privately?

Q5 Give two examples of naṣīḥah to ordinary Muslims.

Q6 How do you feel when someone advises you? How should you respond?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Read one page of the Qur'an with its meaning (naṣīḥah to His Book).	☐
Mon	Learn and revive one Sunnah you were not doing (naṣīḥah to His Messenger).	☐
Tue	Make duʿa for the leaders of the Muslims to be guided.	☐
Wed	Give a friend one piece of gentle, private advice.	☐
Thu	Accept advice from someone this week without arguing.	☐
Fri	Teach a younger person something useful you know.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

8

HADITH 8 OF 50

The Sanctity of a Muslim

الحَدِيثُ الثَّامِنُ

Listen & study online
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/40hadith/8

The testimony and the pillars protect life and wealth.

عَنِ ابْنِ عُمَرَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ: «أُمِرْتُ أَنْ أُقَاتِلَ النَّاسَ حَتَّى يَشْهَدُوا أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ وَأَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ، وَيُقِيمُوا الصَّلَاةَ، وَيُؤْتُوا الزَّكَاةَ، فَإِذَا فَعَلُوا ذَلِكَ عَصَمُوا مِنِّي دِمَاءَهُمْ وَأَمْوَالَهُمْ إِلَّا بِحَقِّ الإِسْلَامِ، وَحِسَابُهُمْ عَلَى اللَّهِ تَعَالَى».

رَوَاهُ البُخَارِيُّ وَمُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abdullah ibn Umar (ra): The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "**I have been ordered to fight against the people until they testify that there is none worthy of worship except Allah and that Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah, and until they establish the salah and pay the zakat. And if they do that then they will have gained protection from me for their lives and property, unless [they commit acts that are punishable] in Islam, and their reckoning will be with Allah.**"

[Bukhari & Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 8 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:8*

About the Narrator

عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ عُمَرَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا

ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿUmar d. 73 AH

Biography: see Hadith 3.

Explanatory Note

This hadith explains how a person enters Islam and what Islam gives him: when someone testifies that there is no god but Allah and that Muhammad is His Messenger, establishes the prayer and pays the zakah, his **blood and wealth become protected**. He is treated as a Muslim according to

what he shows outwardly, and his inner reality is between him and Allah: "his reckoning is with Allah".

The 'fighting' mentioned here is the duty of the Muslim state under its legitimate authority, with its conditions; it is not for individuals and gives nobody permission to harm others. The Qur'an states that there is no compulsion in religion (al-Baqarah 2:256)[1], and the Prophet ﷺ and his successors accepted the jizyah from People of the Book and made treaties. The hadith shows what makes a person's life and property sacred within Islam, not a call to violence.

Abū Bakr used this hadith[2] when some tribes refused to pay zakah after the Prophet's ﷺ death: he said zakah is the right of wealth, and he would not separate what Allah joined — the prayer and zakah. The phrase "except by the right of Islam" means that a Muslim's life or wealth may only be touched in the cases the Shariah has defined, like those in Hadith 14, and only by the courts.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 8.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. The two testimonies are the door into Islam.
2. Salah and zakah are clear signs of a Muslim, joined together many times in the Qur'an.
3. Whoever shows Islam is treated as a Muslim; we judge by the outward and leave the heart to Allah.
4. The life, wealth and honour of a Muslim are sacred.
5. Punishments are carried out only by legitimate authority, never by individuals.
6. There is no compulsion in religion; Islam spreads by conviction and justice.

Step by Step

Treating people by what they show

1. **Accept the outward**
   If someone says the shahadah and prays, treat them as a Muslim.
2. **Leave the hearts**
   Do not accuse people of hidden hypocrisy or disbelief.
3. **Protect rights**
   Never take a Muslim's money or harm him without a right.
4. **Leave judgement to the courts**
   Individuals do not carry out punishments.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 What three things are mentioned that protect a person's life and wealth?

Q2 What does 'their reckoning is with Allah' mean?

Q3 Who is responsible for the fighting mentioned here — individuals or the state?

Q4 How did Abū Bakr use this hadith?

Q5 What does 'except by the right of Islam' mean?

Q6 Why is it wrong to accuse a Muslim of being a hypocrite without clear proof?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Pray every prayer of the day on time.	☐
Mon	Learn how zakah is calculated on savings.	☐
Tue	Avoid saying 'he is a hypocrite' or 'she is not a real Muslim' about anyone.	☐
Wed	Return or ask permission for anything you took from someone without asking.	☐
Thu	Read al-Baqarah 2:256 with its meaning.	☐
Fri	Make du'a for safety and peace for all Muslims.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

9

HADITH 9 OF 50

Do What You Are Able

الحَدِيثُ التَّاسِعُ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/9

Avoid every prohibition; do the commands as much as you can.

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ عَبْدِ الرَّحْمَنِ بْنِ صَخْرٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَقُولُ: «مَا نَهَيْتُكُمْ عَنْهُ فَاجْتَنِبُوهُ، وَمَا أَمَرْتُكُمْ بِهِ فَأْتُوا مِنْهُ مَا اسْتَطَعْتُمْ، فَإِنَّمَا أَهْلَكَ الَّذِينَ مِنْ قَبْلِكُمْ كَثْرَةُ مَسَائِلِهِمْ وَاخْتِلَافُهُمْ عَلَى أَنْبِيَائِهِمْ».

رَوَاهُ البُخَارِيُّ وَمُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Hurayrah (ra): I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say, "**What I have forbidden for you, avoid. What I have ordered you [to do], do as much of it as you can. For verily, it was only the excessive questioning and their disagreeing with their Prophets that destroyed [the nations] who were before you.**"

[Bukhari & Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 9 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:9*

About the Narrator

Abū Hurayrah d. 57 AH

أَبُو هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

ʿAbd ar-Raḥmān ibn Ṣakhr ad-Dawsī, from the tribe of Daws in Yemen, came to the Prophet ﷺ in 7 AH at the time of Khaybar. He was nicknamed 'father of the little cat' because he played with a kitten. He lived among the poor of the Ṣuffah and stayed by the Prophet ﷺ day and night for four years, often hungry, so that he would not miss anything. The Prophet ﷺ prayed for his memory, and he became the Companion who narrated the most hadith — over five thousand. He was later governor of Madinah and died there in 57 AH.

Background of the Hadith

سَبَبُ الوُرُود

The occasion. Abū Hurayrah said: the Messenger of Allah ﷺ addressed us and said: "O people, Allah has made Hajj obligatory upon you, so perform Hajj." A man said: "Every year, O Messenger of Allah?" He remained silent until the man had asked three times. Then the Prophet ﷺ said: "If I had said yes, it would have become obligatory, and you would not have been able to do it."[1]

Then he said: "Leave me as long as I leave you. Those before you were destroyed only by their many questions and their disagreeing with their prophets. So when I command you to do something, do of it as much as you are able, and when I forbid you from something, leave it." In other narrations the man who asked is named as al-Aqraʿ ibn Ḥābis.[2]

Explanatory Note

The Prophet ﷺ set out a clear rule. **Prohibitions must be left completely**, because leaving something is within everyone's power. **Commands are done according to ability**, because doing something may be hard or impossible at times. For example, a person who cannot stand in prayer prays sitting, and if he cannot sit he prays lying down. This shows the ease of the religion: "Allah does not burden a soul beyond what it can bear" (al-Baqarah 2:286)[3].

Leaving prohibitions is put first, because avoiding harm is more urgent. However, in cases of necessity, some prohibitions become permitted to save life (like eating forbidden meat when starving), and scholars say: 'Necessity makes forbidden things permissible, in the amount needed.'

The hadith therefore warns against **excessive and unnecessary questions** (see the background above) and against **disagreeing with the prophets**, which destroyed earlier nations, like the Children of Israel who kept asking about the cow (al-Baqarah 2:67-71)[4]. Useful questions about what one needs to practise are praised.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 9.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Every prohibition must be avoided completely.
2. Commands are done as much as one is able; Islam is a religion of ease.
3. Whatever part of a command one can do must be done; inability in part does not cancel the rest.
4. Necessity can make a forbidden thing allowed, but only to the needed amount.
5. Asking too many unnecessary questions is blameworthy; asking about what you need is praised.
6. Disagreeing with the prophets destroyed earlier nations.
7. We must accept the Prophet's ﷺ commands without looking for excuses.

Step by Step

Applying 'as much as you are able'

1. **Leave the haram fully**
   Make no excuses for doing what is forbidden.

2. **Do the command**
   Start doing what is commanded right away.

3. **If you cannot do all**
   Do what you can (e.g. pray sitting if you cannot stand).

4. **Keep growing**
   Increase little by little as your ability grows.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 What is the difference between how we treat prohibitions and commands?

Q2 Why are prohibitions to be avoided completely?

Q3 Give an example of doing a command 'as much as you are able'.

Q4 What story is behind this hadith?

Q5 What destroyed the nations before us according to this hadith?

Q6 What kinds of questions are good to ask, and which are not?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	List three things you know are forbidden and make a firm decision to avoid them.	☐
Mon	Choose one command you are weak in and do as much as you can today.	☐
Tue	Learn how to pray when sick or travelling.	☐
Wed	Before asking a question, ask yourself: 'Do I need this to practise my religion?'	☐
Thu	Read the story of the cow in al-Baqarah 2:67-71.	☐
Fri	Thank Allah for the ease of the religion.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 10 OF 50

10

Allah Is Good and Accepts Only Good

الحَدِيثُ العَاشِرُ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/10

Halal food opens the door to an answered du'a.

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «إِنَّ اللَّهَ تَعَالَى طَيِّبٌ لَا يَقْبَلُ إِلَّا طَيِّبًا، وَإِنَّ اللَّهَ أَمَرَ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ بِمَا أَمَرَ بِهِ الْمُرْسَلِينَ، فَقَالَ تَعَالَى: ﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الرُّسُلُ كُلُوا مِنَ الطَّيِّبَاتِ وَاعْمَلُوا صَالِحًا﴾، وَقَالَ تَعَالَى: ﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا كُلُوا مِنْ طَيِّبَاتِ مَا رَزَقْنَاكُمْ﴾». ثُمَّ ذَكَرَ الرَّجُلَ يُطِيلُ السَّفَرَ أَشْعَثَ أَغْبَرَ يَمُدُّ يَدَيْهِ إِلَى السَّمَاءِ: يَا رَبِّ، يَا رَبِّ، وَمَطْعَمُهُ حَرَامٌ، وَمَشْرَبُهُ حَرَامٌ، وَمَلْبَسُهُ حَرَامٌ، وَغُذِيَ بِالحَرَامِ، فَأَنَّى يُسْتَجَابُ لَهُ؟

رَوَاهُ مُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Hurayrah (ra): The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "**Allah the Almighty is Good and accepts only that which is good. And verily Allah has commanded the believers to do that which He has commanded the Messengers. So the Almighty has said: "O (you) Messengers! Eat of the tayyibat [all kinds of halal (legal) foods], and perform righteous deeds." [23:51] and the Almighty has said: "O you who believe! Eat of the lawful things that We have provided you." [2:172]"**

Then he ﷺ mentioned [the case] of **a man who, having journeyed far, is disheveled and dusty, and who spreads out his hands to the sky saying "O Lord! O Lord!," while his food is haram (unlawful), his drink is haram, his clothing is haram, and he has been nourished with haram, so how can [his supplication] be answered?**

[Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 10 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:10*

About the Narrator

Abū Hurayrah d. 57 AH

أَبُو هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Biography: see Hadith 9.

Explanatory Note

Allah is *Ṭayyib*: Good and Pure, free of every fault, and He accepts only what is good: good deeds that are sincere and correct, good wealth that is earned lawfully, and good words. The same command was given to the messengers and to the believers: eat from what is good and lawful, and do righteous deeds. Eating halal is connected to doing good deeds; the halal food helps a person do good, and the haram weakens him.

Then the Prophet ﷺ described a man who has many of the means for his du'a to be answered: he is on a long journey, dishevelled and dusty, he raises his hands to the sky, and he calls 'O Lord, O Lord'. Yet his food, drink and clothing are haram, and he was nourished on haram. "So how can he be answered?" The haram became a barrier that blocked his du'a.

This hadith teaches us to check where our money comes from. Charity from stolen or interest money is not accepted by Allah. Parents must feed their children from halal. And it teaches us the etiquette of du'a: raising the hands, calling Allah by 'O Lord' (*Yā Rabb*), humility, and asking in times of travel and need.

Picture

see and remember

What stands between a du'a and its answer?

✓ reasons for an answer	BARRIER	× …blocked by the haram
✓ Long journey		× Haram food
✓ Dishevelled & dusty		× Haram drink
✓ Raised hands		× Haram clothing
✓ Calling 'O Lord!'		× Nourished on haram

The man had many reasons for his du'a to be answered, but the haram blocked it.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Allah is Good and Pure, and He accepts only good deeds, wealth and words.
2. Eating halal is a command for messengers and believers alike.
3. Good food helps good deeds; haram food harms the heart and the deeds.
4. Haram earnings are a reason for du'a not being answered.
5. Charity from haram wealth is not accepted.
6. Some means of an answered du'a: travel, humility, raising hands, saying 'Yā Rabb'.
7. A Muslim must check the sources of his income and food.

Step by Step

Making your du'a more likely to be answered

1 Purify your earnings
Eat, drink and dress from halal.

2 Start with praise
Praise Allah and send blessings on the Prophet ﷺ.

3 Raise your hands
Face the qiblah if possible, humbly.

4 Call Him by His names
Say 'Yā Rabb', 'Yā Allāh' with presence of heart.

5 Choose good times
Last third of the night, in sujūd, between adhān and iqāmah, while travelling.

6 Be certain and patient
Do not say 'I asked and was not answered'.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **What does it mean that Allah is 'Ṭayyib'?**

Q2 **What did Allah command both the messengers and the believers?**

Q3 **Describe the man in the hadith. What made his du'a likely to be answered?**

Q4 **What blocked his du'a?**

Q5 **How can a person make sure their income is halal?**

Q6 **Why is a good deed connected with eating good food?**

Q7 **Write a short du'a you will make this week at a special time.**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise «إِنَّ اللَّهَ طَيِّبٌ لَا يَقْبَلُ إِلَّا طَيِّبًا».	☐
Sun	Check that all you eat today is halal.	☐
Mon	Make du'a in sujūd for something important to you.	☐
Tue	Return anything you have that was taken unlawfully.	☐
Wed	Say Bismillah before eating and Alhamdulillah after.	☐
Thu	Make du'a between the adhān and iqāmah.	☐
Fri	Give a good, lawful charity — from your best, not your worst.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

PART ONE · HADITH 1–10

Review Test

اخْتِبَارُ المُرَاجَعَة

Take this test online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/test1

Name: ..... Date: ..... Score: ..... / 50

Answer from memory first, then check your answers with the chapters. The answer key is at the back of the book.

A Multiple Choice

Circle the correct answer · 25 marks

1. **Which hadith did an-Nawawī place first in his collection?**
   - (A) The halal is clear
   - (B) Actions are by intentions
   - (C) Islam is built on five
   - (D) The religion is sincere advice

2. **Where is the intention (niyyah) found?**
   - (A) In the heart
   - (B) In the hands
   - (C) In writing
   - (D) On the tongue

3. **In Hadith 1, which journey did the Prophet ﷺ use as his example?**
   - (A) Hajj
   - (B) Hijrah (migration)
   - (C) The Night Journey
   - (D) Trade to Shām

4. **Who came to the gathering in Hadith 2 in the form of a man?**
   - (A) Mīkā'īl
   - (B) A Bedouin from Najd
   - (C) Jibrīl
   - (D) Isrāfīl

5. **How many pillars of Īmān are mentioned in Hadith 2?**
   - (A) Seven
   - (B) Six
   - (C) Four
   - (D) Five

6. **Iḥsān means to worship Allah…**
   - (A) as though you see Him
   - (B) only in Ramadan
   - (C) with loud dhikr
   - (D) only in congregation

7. **About the time of the Hour, the Prophet ﷺ said:**
   - (A) The one asked knows no more than the one asking
   - (B) It will come on a Monday
   - (C) It will be in 100 years
   - (D) Only Jibrīl knows it

8. **In Hadith 3, Islam is compared to…**
   - (A) a river
   - (B) a ship
   - (C) a tree
   - (D) a building

9. **Which is the first and foundation pillar of Islam?**
   - (A) Salah
   - (B) Zakah
   - (C) The two testimonies
   - (D) Fasting

10. **According to Hadith 4, how long is each stage in the womb?**
    - (A) 40 days
    - (B) 30 days
    - (C) 60 days
    - (D) 7 days

11. Which of these is NOT one of the four things the angel writes?

(A) Life-span
(B) Nationality
(C) Provision
(D) Wretched or happy

12. Hadith 4 teaches that deeds are judged by...

(A) their beginnings
(B) their size
(C) their number
(D) their endings

13. "Whoever introduces into this affair of ours what is not of it" refers mainly to...

(A) new languages
(B) new technology
(C) new buildings
(D) new acts of worship

14. A deed is accepted when it is sincere AND...

(A) done in public
(B) done many times
(C) according to the Sunnah
(D) done in Arabic

15. Hadith 6 divides matters into...

(A) three kinds
(B) four kinds
(C) two kinds
(D) five kinds

16. In Hadith 6, the shepherd who grazes near the sanctuary...

(A) must leave his sheep
(B) is safe
(C) will soon fall into it
(D) is rewarded

17. Allah's sanctuary (ḥimā) is...

(A) the Kaʿbah
(B) His prohibitions
(C) Paradise
(D) Madinah

18. Which part of the body, when sound, makes the whole body sound?

(A) The brain
(B) The hands
(C) The tongue
(D) The heart

19. "The religion is naṣīḥah." Naṣīḥah means...

(A) anger
(B) travelling
(C) fasting
(D) sincere goodwill

20. Which of these is NOT among the five that naṣīḥah is owed to?

(A) Wealth
(B) His Messenger
(C) His Book
(D) Allah

21. In Hadith 8, which two acts are mentioned with the testimony?

(A) Jihad and Hajj
(B) Wudu and prayer
(C) Prayer and zakah
(D) Fasting and Hajj

22. Who used Hadith 8 against those who refused to pay zakah?

(A) ʿAlī
(B) ʿUmar
(C) ʿUthmān
(D) Abū Bakr

23. In Hadith 9, prohibitions should be avoided...

(A) only in public
(B) only in Ramadan
(C) completely
(D) as much as you can

24. What destroyed the nations before us, according to Hadith 9?

(A) Poverty
(B) Too many questions and disagreeing with their prophets
(C) Lack of buildings
(D) Earthquakes

25. **In Hadith 10, why was the traveller's du'a not answered?**

(A) His food, drink and clothing were haram
(B) He prayed too quickly
(C) He was not in Makkah
(D) He did not raise his hands

B MATCHING

Write the letter of the English meaning next to each Arabic phrase · 10 marks

1	إِنَّمَا الأَعْمَالُ بِالنِّيَّاتِ		A	His creation is gathered in his mother's womb.
2	أَنْ تَعْبُدَ اللَّهَ كَأَنَّكَ تَرَاهُ		B	Islam is built upon five.
3	بُنِيَ الإِسْلَامُ عَلَى خَمْسٍ		C	Whoever introduces into this matter of ours what is not from it, it is rejected.
4	يُجْمَعُ خَلْقُهُ فِي بَطْنِ أُمِّهِ		D	The religion is sincere advice.
5	مَنْ أَحْدَثَ فِي أَمْرِنَا هَذَا مَا لَيْسَ مِنْهُ فَهُوَ رَدٌّ		E	Actions are only by intentions.
6	إِنَّ الحَلَالَ بَيِّنٌ وَإِنَّ الحَرَامَ بَيِّنٌ		F	That you worship Allah as though you see Him.
7	الدِّينُ النَّصِيحَةُ		G	Allah is good and accepts only what is good.
8	وَحِسَابُهُمْ عَلَى اللَّهِ		H	The lawful is clear and the unlawful is clear.
9	فَأْتُوا مِنْهُ مَا اسْتَطَعْتُمْ		I	And their reckoning is with Allah.
10	إِنَّ اللَّهَ طَيِّبٌ لَا يَقْبَلُ إِلَّا طَيِّبًا		J	Do of it as much as you are able.

C SHORT ANSWER

Answer in one or two sentences · 10 marks

1. **What two things does Hadith 1 teach about actions?**

2. **List the five pillars of Islam.**

3. List the six pillars of Īmān.

4. Name the three stages of creation in the womb.

5. What are the two conditions for a deed to be accepted?

6. What does a person protect by avoiding doubtful matters?

7. Name the five to whom naṣīḥah is owed.

8. What does ‘their reckoning is with Allah’ mean in Hadith 8?

9. What is the difference between how we treat commands and prohibitions (Hadith 9)?

10. Give two things that help a du‘a to be answered, from Hadith 10.

D Critical Thinking

Explain your thinking with evidence from the hadith · 5 marks

1. **Two students both help to clean the mosque. One is rewarded and the other is not. Using Hadith 1, explain how this can happen, and how the second student could have earned the reward.**

2. **Hadith 2 calls Iḥsān the highest level. Describe what your day would look like if you lived with Iḥsān from morning to night.**

3. **Your friend says: "Everything is already written, so there is no point in working hard." Using Hadith 4, how would you reply kindly and correctly?**

4. Give an example of a ‘doubtful matter’ that young people face today. How do Hadith 6 and the shepherd example help you decide what to do?

5. Hadith 5 rejects new acts of worship, but Muslims use cars and phones. Explain the difference between worship and worldly matters, with your own examples.



PART TWO

Purity of Heart and Tongue

Hadith 11 – 20

11 Leave What Makes You Doubt

12 Leaving What Does Not Concern You

13 Love for Your Brother What You Love for Yourself

14 The Sanctity of Muslim Blood

15 Speak Good or Stay Silent

16 Do Not Become Angry

17 Excellence in Everything

18 Taqwa, Repentance and Good Character

19 Be Mindful of Allah, He Will Protect You

20 Modesty: If You Feel No Shame...

11

HADITH 11 OF 50

Leave What Makes You Doubt

الحَدِيثُ الحَادِي عَشَرَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/11

Choose certainty over doubt, and calm over unease.

عَنْ أَبِي مُحَمَّدٍ الحَسَنِ بْنِ عَلِيِّ بْنِ أَبِي طَالِبٍ، سِبْطِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ وَرَيْحَانَتِهِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا قَالَ: حَفِظْتُ مِنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «دَعْ مَا يَرِيبُكَ إِلَى مَا لَا يَرِيبُكَ».

رَوَاهُ التِّرْمِذِيُّ وَالنَّسَائِيُّ، وَقَالَ التِّرْمِذِيُّ: حَدِيثٌ حَسَنٌ صَحِيحٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Muhammad al-Hasan ibn Ali ibn Abee Talib (may Allah be pleased with him), the grandson of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, and the one much loved by him, who said: I memorised from the Messenger of Allah ﷺ: "**Leave that which makes you doubt for that which does not make you doubt.**"

[At-Tirmidhi] [An-Nasai] At-Tirmidhi said that it was a good and sound (hasan saheeh) hadeeth · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 11 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:11*

About the Narrator

Al-Ḥasan ibn ʿAlī (d. 49/50 AH)

الحَسَنُ بْنُ عَلِيٍّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا

The grandson of the Prophet ﷺ, the son of ʿAlī and Fāṭimah, born in 3 AH. The Prophet ﷺ loved him dearly, carried him on his shoulders, called him 'my sweet basil', and said that he and al-Ḥusayn are the masters of the youth of Paradise. He foretold: "This son of mine is a master, and through him Allah will make peace between two great groups of Muslims." This came true when al-Ḥasan gave up the caliphate in 41 AH to unite the Muslims. He died in Madinah in 49 or 50 AH.

Explanatory Note

Al-Ḥasan was only about seven years old when the Prophet ﷺ died, yet he memorised this short and deep saying. It means: leave what you are unsure about and take what you are sure about. If something makes you doubt whether it is halal or haram, right or wrong, leave it for something about which you have no doubt. It is the practical rule that follows from Hadith 6.

Doubt here includes doubtful food and money, doubtful words, and doubtful actions. The truthful heart finds peace in truth and feels uneasy with falsehood, as at-Tirmidhī's fuller narration adds: "For truthfulness is tranquillity, and lying is doubt."[1] A person who follows this rule lives with a calm heart and a clean record.

This rule is not about whispers (*waswās*). If a person has clear certainty — for example, that he has wudu — then a passing doubt does not change it. The scholars say: 'Certainty is not removed by doubt.' Being scrupulous (*waraʿ*) is praised, but it should be in the right place: avoiding real doubts, not torturing yourself about things that are clearly fine.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 11.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Leave doubtful matters for things that are clearly lawful.
2. Truth brings peace to the heart; falsehood brings unease.
3. Scrupulousness (waraʿ) is a sign of strong faith.
4. Certainty is not removed by a passing doubt; do not obey whispers.
5. Even young children can memorise and benefit from the words of the Prophet ﷺ.
6. Short words of wisdom can guide a whole life.

Step by Step

When you feel doubt

1 Name the doubt
What exactly makes me unsure about this?

2 Is it a real doubt or a whisper?
If you had certainty before, ignore the whisper.

3 If real
Leave it, or ask someone with knowledge.

4 Choose the clear option
Take what leaves your heart at peace.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 How old was al-Ḥasan when the Prophet ﷺ died, and what does that teach us?

Q2 **Explain the hadith in your own words.**

Q3 **How is this hadith connected to Hadith 6?**

Q4 **What is the difference between a real doubt and waswās?**

Q5 **What does the fuller narration say about truthfulness and lying?**

Q6 **Describe a situation where you chose the 'safe' option. How did you feel?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith — only four words in Arabic!	☐
Sun	Leave one thing this week that your heart is not comfortable with.	☐
Mon	When unsure about the qiblah or a ruling, ask instead of guessing.	☐
Tue	Ignore one whisper of doubt about your wudu or prayer.	☐
Wed	Choose words you are sure are true; avoid exaggeration.	☐
Thu	Read about the life of al-Ḥasan ibn ʿAlī for ten minutes.	☐
Fri	Teach the hadith to a child.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 12 OF 50

12

Leaving What Does Not Concern You

الحَدِيثُ الثَّانِي عَشَرَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/12

A sign of beautiful Islam: spending life only on what matters.

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «مِنْ حُسْنِ إِسْلَامِ المَرْءِ تَرْكُهُ مَا لَا يَعْنِيهِ».

حَدِيثٌ حَسَنٌ، رَوَاهُ التِّرْمِذِيُّ وَغَيْرُهُ هَكَذَا.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Hurayrah (may Allah be pleased with him) who said: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "**Part of the perfection of one's Islam is his leaving that which does not concern him.**"

A hasan (good) hadeeth which was related by at-Tirmidhi and others in this fashion · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 12 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:12*

About the Narrator

Abū Hurayrah d. 57 AH — أَبُو هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Biography: see Hadith 9.

Explanatory Note

Ibn Rajab said this hadith is a great foundation of good manners. It means that among the signs of a person's Islam being beautiful and complete is that he leaves what does not concern him — words and actions that bring him no benefit in this life or the Hereafter. What 'concerns' a person is judged by the Shariah, not by his desires: his duties, his family, his work, his learning and his worship.

Most of what does not concern us is in **speech**: gossip, unnecessary questions about people's private lives, arguing over useless matters, and endless chatter. Today it also includes scrolling, fol-

lowing news that does not affect us, and getting involved in other people's business online. All of this wastes time, which is our life, and often leads to sin.

This does not mean being careless about others. Advising, helping and caring about Muslims *does* concern us (Hadith 7, 13). The hadith teaches us to ask, before speaking or acting: 'Will this benefit me with Allah?' If not, leave it, and you will find time for what truly matters.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Islam has levels; leaving the useless raises its beauty.
2. What concerns a person is decided by the Shariah, not by desire.
3. Most useless matters are in speech, so guard the tongue.
4. Time is life; wasting it on what does not concern you is a loss.
5. Prying into other people's private lives is forbidden.
6. Caring for Muslims and advising them is not 'interfering'; it is part of the religion.

Step by Step

The 'Does it concern me?' test

1. **Before you speak or click**
   Ask: is this my business?
2. **Ask about benefit**
   Will it benefit me in my religion or my world?
3. **Ask about harm**
   Could it lead to backbiting, waste or sin?
4. **Decide**
   If there is no benefit, leave it and replace it with something useful.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **What does 'what does not concern him' mean?**

Q2 **Who decides what concerns a person — the person himself or the Shariah?**

Q3 **Give three examples of things that do not concern us.**

Q4 **Why is speech the biggest area where we involve ourselves in what does not concern us?**

Q5 **Is advising a friend 'interfering'? Explain.**

Q6 **How much time do you spend daily on things that do not concern you? How will you change that?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Track your phone screen time today and note useless minutes.	☐
Mon	Do not ask anyone a personal question that does not concern you.	☐
Tue	Leave a conversation that turns into gossip.	☐
Wed	Replace 20 minutes of useless scrolling with Qur'an or reading.	☐
Thu	Before speaking, pause and ask: 'Does this concern me?'	☐
Fri	Write a list of the five things that truly concern you in life.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 13 OF 50

13

Love for Your Brother What You Love for Yourself

الحَدِيثُ الثَّالِثَ عَشَرَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/13

Faith is not complete until your heart wants good for others.

عَنْ أَبِي حَمْزَةَ أَنَسِ بْنِ مَالِكٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ ـ خَادِمِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ ـ عَنِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ قَالَ:
«لَا يُؤْمِنُ أَحَدُكُمْ حَتَّى يُحِبَّ لِأَخِيهِ مَا يُحِبُّ لِنَفْسِهِ».

رَوَاهُ البُخَارِيُّ وَمُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Hamzah Anas bin Malik (may Allah be pleased with him) — the servant of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ — that the Prophet ﷺ said: **None of you [truly] believes until he loves for his brother that which he loves for himself.**

[Al-Bukhari] [Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 13 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:13*

About the Narrator

Anas ibn Mālik d. 93 AH

أَنَسُ بْنُ مَالِكٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

From the Anṣār, his mother Umm Sulaym brought him at ten years old to serve the Prophet ﷺ, which he did for ten years. He said: "He never once said 'uff' to me, nor asked me why I did something." The Prophet ﷺ prayed for him to have much wealth and many children and a long life, and Allah answered: he lived to about a hundred and had a very large family. He narrated over two thousand hadith and was among the last Companions to die, in Basra in 93 AH.

Explanatory Note

The words "none of you believes" mean that faith is not **complete**; they do not mean a person leaves Islam. Complete faith requires that a believer wants for his brother the same good he wants for himself — in guidance, knowledge, health, wealth and Paradise — and dislikes for him the harm he dislikes for himself. In a narration of an-Nasā'ī: "...the *good* that he loves for himself."[1]

This hadith removes envy, hatred and selfishness from the heart. If you would like people to be honest with you, be honest with them. If you would like to be respected, respect them. If you would love to be guided, wish guidance for others — even non-Muslims, by wanting them to accept Islam.

It is a high level that needs struggle. A Muslim should be happy when his brother receives a blessing, and sad when he is struck by a calamity. Al-Fuḍayl ibn ʿIyāḍ even said that the best of people would love that others become better than themselves. This is the root of a strong, loving community, like one body.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 13.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Complete faith includes loving good for others as for oneself.
2. Envy and selfishness weaken faith.
3. Treat people as you would love to be treated.
4. Being happy for others' blessings is a sign of a pure heart.
5. Wishing guidance for all people is part of this love.
6. A loving community is built from loving hearts.

Step by Step

Training your heart to love good for others

1 Notice
When someone gets a blessing, notice your first feeling.

2 Correct
If you feel envy, say «بَارَكَ اللَّهُ لَكَ» and make du'a for them.

3 Act
Give others what you would love to receive: a smile, help, a gift.

4 Pray in secret
Make du'a for your brother in his absence; an angel says 'And for you the same'.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 Does 'none of you believes' mean the person is not a Muslim? Explain.

Q2 What does it mean to love for your brother what you love for yourself?

Q3 Give two examples from daily life.

Q4 How does this hadith remove envy?

Q5 What does an angel say when you make du'a for your brother in his absence?

Q6 Who is someone you find it hard to love good for? What will you do about it?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Make du'a by name for three people in their absence.	☐
Mon	Share something you like (food, a book) with someone.	☐
Tue	Congratulate someone on a blessing and say 'Bārak Allāhu lak'.	☐
Wed	Treat someone today exactly as you would love to be treated.	☐
Thu	Help a classmate or colleague understand something you know.	☐
Fri	Make du'a for the guidance of all people.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

14

HADITH 14 OF 50

The Sanctity of Muslim Blood

الحَدِيثُ الرَّابِعَ عَشَرَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/14

A Muslim's life is sacred except in three cases decided by the courts.

عَنِ ابْنِ مَسْعُودٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «لَا يَحِلُّ دَمُ امْرِئٍ مُسْلِمٍ إِلَّا بِإِحْدَى ثَلَاثٍ: الثَّيِّبُ الزَّانِي، وَالنَّفْسُ بِالنَّفْسِ، وَالتَّارِكُ لِدِينِهِ المُفَارِقُ لِلْجَمَاعَةِ».

رَوَاهُ البُخَارِيُّ وَمُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Ibn Masood (may Allah be pleased with him) who said: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "**It is not permissible to spill the blood of a Muslim except in three [instances]: the married person who commits adultery, a life for a life, and the one who forsakes his religion and separates from the community.**"

[Al-Bukhari] [Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 14 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:14*

About the Narrator

ʿAbdullāh ibn Masʿūd d. 32 AH — عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ مَسْعُودٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Biography: see Hadith 4.

Explanatory Note

This hadith shows how sacred the life of a Muslim is: his blood is not lawful to spill except in three cases. **The married person who commits adultery**, **a life for a life** (just retribution for deliberate murder), and **the one who abandons his religion and separates from the community**. Outside these, and a few cases that scholars connect to them, a Muslim's life is protected.

These punishments (*ḥudūd* and *qiṣāṣ*) are for the **Muslim ruler and his courts** only, after proof and a fair trial, with the conditions the scholars explain. They are not for individuals or groups to carry out. Ḥudūd are also avoided where there is doubt, and the family of a murdered person may forgive or accept blood-money instead of retribution, and forgiveness is praised (al-Baqarah 2:178)[1].

The wisdom of these laws is to protect five necessities that every just law protects: religion, life, lineage, mind and wealth. Strong deterrents protect society, so that people live in safety. Killing an innocent soul is among the greatest sins: "Whoever kills a soul… it is as if he had killed all mankind" (al-Mā'idah 5:32)[2].

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 14.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. The life of a Muslim is sacred and protected.
2. There are only three main cases in which the Shariah allows taking a life.
3. Carrying out punishments belongs to the legitimate authority and courts, never individuals.
4. Punishments are avoided where there is doubt.
5. Forgiving the killer, or accepting blood-money, is allowed and praised.
6. Islamic law protects religion, life, lineage, mind and wealth.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **What are the three cases mentioned in the hadith?**

Q2 **Who is allowed to carry out these punishments?**

Q3 **What does 'separates from the community' mean?**

Q4 **What alternatives to retribution does Islam allow the victim's family?**

Q5 **Name the five necessities that the Shariah protects.**

Q6 **Why is killing one innocent person described as killing all mankind?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Read al-Mā'idah 5:32 with its meaning.	☐
Mon	Learn the five necessities of the Shariah and write them down.	☐
Tue	Avoid violent games or videos that make killing seem normal.	☐
Wed	Make du'a for safety and peace in Muslim lands.	☐
Thu	Forgive someone who wronged you in a small matter.	☐
Fri	Thank Allah for the gift of Islam and pray to die upon it.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

15

HADITH 15 OF 50

Speak Good or Stay Silent

الحَدِيثُ الخَامِسَ عَشَرَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/15

Three signs of true faith: the tongue, the neighbour and the guest.

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ: «مَنْ كَانَ يُؤْمِنُ بِاللَّهِ وَاليَوْمِ الآخِرِ فَلْيَقُلْ خَيْرًا أَوْ لِيَصْمُتْ، وَمَنْ كَانَ يُؤْمِنُ بِاللَّهِ وَاليَوْمِ الآخِرِ فَلْيُكْرِمْ جَارَهُ، وَمَنْ كَانَ يُؤْمِنُ بِاللَّهِ وَاليَوْمِ الآخِرِ فَلْيُكْرِمْ ضَيْفَهُ».

رَوَاهُ البُخَارِيُّ وَمُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Hurayrah (may Allah be pleased with him), that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: **Let him who believes in Allah and the Last Day speak good, or keep silent; and let him who believes in Allah and the Last Day be generous to his neighbour; and let him who believes in Allah and the Last Day be generous to his guest.**

[Al-Bukhari] [Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 15 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:15*

About the Narrator

Abū Hurayrah d. 57 AH — أَبُو هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Biography: see Hadith 9.

Explanatory Note

Three times the Prophet ﷺ repeated: “Whoever believes in Allah and the Last Day…”, showing that these actions are signs of true faith. Whoever truly believes he will meet Allah and be judged will watch his tongue and treat people well.

Speak good or stay silent: before speaking, think. If the words are good — remembering Allah, teaching, advising, making peace, a kind word — say them. If they are bad or useless, keep quiet.

Imam ash-Shāfiʿī said: if you want to speak, think first; if there is clear good in it, speak. Silence is safety for the one who is not sure.

Honouring the neighbour: Jibrīl kept advising the Prophet ﷺ about the neighbour until he thought the neighbour would be made an heir[1]. Honouring includes greeting, giving gifts, helping, being patient with them and above all not harming them. **Honouring the guest**: welcoming him, serving him from the best of what you have, and hosting him generously. The guest's right is a day and a night of special care, and hospitality is up to three days[2].

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 15.

Picture

see and remember

Signs of true faith in Allah and the Last Day

Your tongue
speak good or stay silent

Your neighbour
honour and never harm

Your guest
welcome and serve generously

Three duties linked to faith in Allah and the Last Day.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Faith in Allah and the Last Day shows itself in actions.
2. Think before you speak: good words or silence.
3. The neighbour has great rights; harming him is a major sin.
4. Generosity to guests is a sign of faith and an old tradition of the prophets.
5. Islam joins worship of Allah with good treatment of people.
6. Small acts like a gift of food to a neighbour build strong communities.

Step by Step

The three-gate test before speaking

1. **Is it true?**
   Do not say what you are unsure of.

2. **Is it good or needed?**
   Will it please Allah or help someone?

3 **Is it the right time and way?**
Could it hurt, embarrass or cause a fight?

4 **If any gate is closed**
Stay silent — and be rewarded for it.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 Why did the Prophet ﷺ repeat 'whoever believes in Allah and the Last Day'?

Q2 What should a person do before speaking?

Q3 How did Jibrīl stress the rights of the neighbour?

Q4 List three ways to honour a neighbour.

Q5 How long is the right of hospitality for a guest?

Q6 Which of the three do you most need to improve? What is your plan?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Spend one hour today speaking only good, or staying silent.	☐
Mon	Greet your neighbour and ask how they are.	☐
Tue	Send a small plate of food or a gift to a neighbour.	☐
Wed	Make your home ready to welcome guests and invite someone.	☐
Thu	Serve a guest yourself and offer them the best you have.	☐
Fri	Apologise to someone you hurt with words.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

16

HADITH 16 OF 50

Do Not Become Angry

الحَدِيثُ السَّادِسَ عَشَرَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/16

A short advice repeated many times — because it guards the whole religion.

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ أَنَّ رَجُلًا قَالَ لِلنَّبِيِّ ﷺ: أَوْصِنِي. قَالَ: «لَا تَغْضَبْ». فَرَدَّدَ مِرَارًا، قَالَ: «لَا تَغْضَبْ».

رَوَاهُ البُخَارِيُّ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | sunnah.com

On the authority of Abu Hurayrah (may Allah be pleased with him): A man said to the Prophet ﷺ, "Counsel me," so he ﷺ said, "**Do not become angry**." The man repeated [his request for counsel] several times, and [each time] he ﷺ said, "**Do not become angry**."

[Al-Bukhari] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 16 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:16*

About the Narrator

Abū Hurayrah d. 57 AH — أَبُو هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Biography: see Hadith 9.

In a narration of Aḥmad, the man who asked is named as Jāriyah ibn Qudāmah.

Explanatory Note

A man asked for advice, and the Prophet ﷺ said: "Do not become angry." The man asked again and again, and each time the answer was the same. This shows how much harm anger brings: in anger people curse, hit, divorce, break family ties, and do things they regret for years. Anger is a coal of fire from Shayṭān in the heart.

The advice has two meanings. First: build a character that is **slow to anger** — patient, generous, humble — because good character prevents anger from starting. Second: when anger comes, **do not act upon it**; control your tongue and hands. The Prophet ﷺ said: "The strong person is not the one who wrestles others down; the strong one is he who controls himself when angry."[1]

Not all anger is wrong. The Prophet ﷺ never became angry for himself, but he became angry when the limits of Allah were violated. Even then, his anger led only to what was right. The remedies he taught include seeking refuge with Allah from Shayṭān[2], staying silent[3] and changing position[4]; scholars also advise making wudu, which cools the heat of anger. Allah praises "those who restrain anger and pardon people" (Āl ʿImrān 3:134)[5].

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 16.

Picture

see and remember



Cool the fire of anger with the remedies the Prophet ﷺ taught.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Anger is a key to many evils, so avoiding it guards against them.
2. Real strength is controlling oneself when angry.
3. Good character and patience prevent anger before it begins.
4. There are practical cures for anger taught by the Prophet ﷺ.
5. Anger for the sake of Allah, when His limits are violated, is praised if kept within the Shariah.
6. Repeating advice shows its importance.

Step by Step

What to do the moment anger rises

1 Seek refuge
Say «أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ».

2 Stay silent
Do not say anything you might regret.

3 **Change position**
If standing, sit; if sitting, lie down.

4 **Make wudu**
Water puts out the fire of anger.

5 **Leave and return**
Walk away; deal with the matter when calm.

6 **Pardon**
Remember the reward for those who restrain anger and forgive.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 Why did the Prophet ﷺ repeat the same advice several times?

Q2 Name four harmful things people do in anger.

Q3 Who is truly strong according to the Prophet ﷺ?

Q4 List four remedies for anger.

Q5 When is anger praiseworthy?

Q6 Think of the last time you got angry. What could you have done differently?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise «لَا تَغْضَبْ» and the hadith.	☐
Sun	Write the six steps on a card and keep it with you.	☐
Mon	When annoyed today, say «أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ» immediately.	☐
Tue	Stay silent in one argument instead of replying.	☐
Wed	Forgive one person who annoyed you this week.	☐
Thu	Read Āl ʿImrān 3:133–134.	☐
Fri	Make duʿa to be given patience and good character.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

17

HADITH 17 OF 50

Excellence in Everything

الحَدِيثُ السَّابِعَ عَشَرَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/17

Allah has prescribed excellence and kindness in every matter — even to animals.

عَنْ أَبِي يَعْلَى شَدَّادِ بْنِ أَوْسٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ عَنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ: «إِنَّ اللَّهَ كَتَبَ الإِحْسَانَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ، فَإِذَا قَتَلْتُمْ فَأَحْسِنُوا القِتْلَةَ، وَإِذَا ذَبَحْتُمْ فَأَحْسِنُوا الذِّبْحَةَ، وَلْيُحِدَّ أَحَدُكُمْ شَفْرَتَهُ، وَلْيُرِحْ ذَبِيحَتَهُ».

رَوَاهُ مُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Ya'la Shaddad bin Aws (may Allah be pleased with him), that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: **Verily Allah has prescribed ihsan (proficiency, perfection) in all things. So if you kill then kill well; and if you slaughter, then slaughter well. Let each one of you sharpen his blade and let him spare suffering to the animal he slaughters.**"

[Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 17 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:17*

About the Narrator

Shaddād ibn Aws (d. 58 AH)

شَدَّادُ بْنُ أَوْسٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

An Anṣārī Companion from Madinah, the nephew of Ḥassān ibn Thābit, the poet of the Prophet ﷺ. He was known for knowledge, wisdom and gentle speech; Abū ad-Dardā' said that every people have a man of understanding and that Shaddād was theirs. He settled in Palestine, where he taught, and died there in 58 AH.

Explanatory Note

Iḥsān means doing something well, perfectly and kindly. Allah has prescribed it in **everything**: worship, work, studies, dealings with family and neighbours, and even with animals. The Prophet ﷺ chose the most extreme example — killing and slaughtering — to show that if excellence is required even there, it is required everywhere else even more.

When a punishment is carried out lawfully, it should be done in the least painful way, without mutilation or torture. When an animal is slaughtered for food, the knife must be sharp, the animal should not see the blade being sharpened, it should not see another animal slaughtered, and it should be treated gently. Islam forbids using animals as targets, overloading them, or starving them; a woman entered the Fire because of a cat she starved[1], and a man was forgiven for giving water to a thirsty dog[2].

So this hadith teaches a Muslim to do every job beautifully: to pray with presence of heart, study seriously, work honestly and carefully, and treat all creation with mercy. The Prophet ﷺ said: "Allah loves that when one of you does a job, he perfects it."[3]

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 17.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Excellence and kindness are required in every matter.
2. Islam teaches mercy even to animals.
3. Slaughter must be done quickly with a sharp knife and gentleness.
4. Torture and mutilation are forbidden.
5. A Muslim perfects his work, studies and worship.
6. Kindness to animals can be a reason for forgiveness; cruelty can lead to punishment.

Step by Step

The Sunnah way of slaughtering

1 Prepare
Sharpen the knife out of the animal's sight; give it water.

2 Lay it gently
Face it towards the qiblah, on its left side.

3 Say
«بِسْمِ اللَّهِ، وَاللَّهُ أَكْبَرُ».

4 Cut quickly
Cut the throat and the main vessels in one swift movement.

5 Wait
Let the animal be still before skinning it.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 What does iḥsān mean in this hadith?

Q2 Why did the Prophet ﷺ use killing and slaughtering as examples?

Q3 List three rules of kindness when slaughtering an animal.

Q4 Tell the stories of the woman and the cat, and the man and the dog.

Q5 How can you show iḥsān in your studies or work?

Q6 Choose one task you usually rush. How will you do it with iḥsān?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the first sentence: «إِنَّ اللَّهَ كَتَبَ الإِحْسَانَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ».	☐
Sun	Put out water for birds or animals.	☐
Mon	Do your homework or job today with full care and neatness.	☐
Tue	Make wudu and pray with extra care and calm.	☐
Wed	Be gentle with a pet or animal; never hit or scare one.	☐
Thu	Tidy your room perfectly, as an act of iḥsān.	☐
Fri	Thank someone who does their job excellently.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 18 OF 50

18

Taqwa, Repentance and Good Character

الحَدِيثُ الثَّامِنَ عَشَرَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/18

Three short commands: with Allah, with yourself and with people.

عَنْ أَبِي ذَرٍّ جُنْدُبِ بْنِ جُنَادَةَ، وَأَبِي عَبْدِ الرَّحْمَنِ مُعَاذِ بْنِ جَبَلٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا عَنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ: «اتَّقِ اللَّهَ حَيْثُمَا كُنْتَ، وَأَتْبِعِ السَّيِّئَةَ الحَسَنَةَ تَمْحُهَا، وَخَالِقِ النَّاسَ بِخُلُقٍ حَسَنٍ».

رَوَاهُ التِّرْمِذِيُّ وَقَالَ: حَدِيثٌ حَسَنٌ، وَفِي بَعْضِ النُّسَخِ: حَسَنٌ صَحِيحٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Dharr Jundub ibn Junadah, and Abu Abdur-Rahman Muadh bin Jabal (may Allah be pleased with him), that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: **Have taqwa (fear) of Allah wherever you may be, and follow up a bad deed with a good deed which will wipe it out, and behave well towards the people.**

It was related by at-Tirmidhi, who said it was a hasan (good) hadeeth, and in some copies it is stated to be a hasan saheeh hadeeth · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 18 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:18*

About the Narrators

Abū Dharr al-Ghifārī d. 32 AH

أَبُو ذَرٍّ الغِفَارِيُّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Jundub ibn Junādah of the tribe of Ghifār worshipped Allah alone even before Islam. He travelled to Makkah, accepted Islam among the very first, and announced it loudly at the Kaʿbah, for which he was beaten. He returned and brought much of his tribe to Islam. He was famous for honesty — the Prophet ﷺ said the earth has not carried anyone more truthful in speech — and for his zuhd and love of the poor. He died alone in ar-Rabadhah in 32 AH, as the Prophet ﷺ had foretold.

Muʿādh ibn Jabal d. 18 AH

مُعَاذُ بْنُ جَبَلٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

A young Anṣārī who accepted Islam as a teenager and attended the Pledge of ʿAqabah, Badr and all the battles. He was one of the few who gathered the Qur'an in the Prophet's ﷺ lifetime. The Prophet ﷺ said he was the most knowledgeable of the Ummah about the halal and the haram, and once took his hand and said: "O Muʿādh, by Allah I love you." He sent him to Yemen as a teacher and judge. He died in the plague of ʿAmwās in Shām in 18 AH, aged about 33.

Explanatory Note

This hadith gathers the rights of Allah and the rights of people. **'Fear Allah wherever you are'**: *taqwā* is to put a shield between yourself and Allah's anger by doing what He commands and leaving what He forbids — in public and in private, at home and abroad, online and offline.

'Follow a bad deed with a good deed and it will wipe it out': since no one is perfect, the Prophet ﷺ gave us a way to repair our mistakes. A good deed, especially sincere repentance, wipes away minor sins (Hūd 11:114)[1]. Major sins need specific repentance, and wrongs against people need to be returned or forgiven. The good deed may be of the same kind: if you sinned with your eyes, use them in good; if you wasted money, give charity.

'Treat people with good character': smiling, kind words, patience, generosity, humility, and not harming anyone. The Prophet ﷺ said that nothing is heavier on the scale than good character[2], and that the best of people are the best in character[3]. Character is not separate from religion; it is part of taqwā itself.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 18.

Picture

see and remember

Three commands in one hadith

A bad deed
slips out

+

A good deed
istighfar, salah, charity, kindness

→

Wiped out
by Allah's mercy

Taqwa everywhere • Repair mistakes quickly • Good character with people

Follow a bad deed with a good deed and it will wipe it out.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Taqwā is required everywhere, in private as in public.
2. No one is free of mistakes; the believer repairs them quickly.
3. Good deeds wipe out minor sins; repentance is the best good deed after sin.
4. Wrongs against people must be returned or forgiven.
5. Good character is one of the heaviest deeds on the scale.
6. Religion includes our relationship with Allah and our treatment of people.

Step by Step

The steps of sincere repentance (tawbah)

1. **Stop the sin**
   Leave it immediately.
2. **Regret**
   Feel sorry in your heart for disobeying Allah.
3. **Resolve**
   Decide firmly never to return to it.
4. **Return rights**
   If someone was wronged, give back their right or ask forgiveness.
5. **Follow with good**
   Pray two rakʿahs, give charity, increase in good deeds.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **What does ‘fear Allah wherever you are’ mean in today’s world?**

Q2 **How can a good deed wipe out a bad deed? Which verse supports this?**

Q3 **What must be done when the sin involves the rights of another person?**

Q4 **Give three examples of good character.**

Q5 **What did the Prophet ﷺ say is heaviest on the scale?**

Q6 **Think of one mistake you made this week. Which good deed will you follow it with?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Do one act of obedience in private that nobody sees.	☐
Mon	After any mistake today, immediately do a good deed.	☐
Tue	Say «أَسْتَغْفِرُ اللَّهَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْهِ» 100 times.	☐
Wed	Smile and greet everyone you meet today.	☐
Thu	Apologise to someone you wronged, and make it right.	☐
Fri	Be patient with someone who annoys you, and speak kindly.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 19 OF 50

19

Be Mindful of Allah, He Will Protect You

الحَدِيثُ التَّاسِعَ عَشَرَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/19

Words of advice to a young boy – for every young heart.

عَنْ أَبِي العَبَّاسِ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ عَبَّاسٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا قَالَ: كُنْتُ خَلْفَ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ يَوْمًا، فَقَالَ: «يَا غُلَامُ، إِنِّي أُعَلِّمُكَ كَلِمَاتٍ: احْفَظِ اللَّهَ يَحْفَظْكَ، احْفَظِ اللَّهَ تَجِدْهُ تُجَاهَكَ، إِذَا سَأَلْتَ فَاسْأَلِ اللَّهَ، وَإِذَا اسْتَعَنْتَ فَاسْتَعِنْ بِاللَّهِ، وَاعْلَمْ أَنَّ الأُمَّةَ لَوِ اجْتَمَعَتْ عَلَى أَنْ يَنْفَعُوكَ بِشَيْءٍ لَمْ يَنْفَعُوكَ إِلَّا بِشَيْءٍ قَدْ كَتَبَهُ اللَّهُ لَكَ، وَإِنِ اجْتَمَعُوا عَلَى أَنْ يَضُرُّوكَ بِشَيْءٍ لَمْ يَضُرُّوكَ إِلَّا بِشَيْءٍ قَدْ كَتَبَهُ اللَّهُ عَلَيْكَ، رُفِعَتِ الأَقْلَامُ وَجَفَّتِ الصُّحُفُ».

رَوَاهُ التِّرْمِذِيُّ وَقَالَ: حَدِيثٌ حَسَنٌ صَحِيحٌ.

وَفِي رِوَايَةِ غَيْرِ التِّرْمِذِيِّ: «احْفَظِ اللَّهَ تَجِدْهُ أَمَامَكَ، تَعَرَّفْ إِلَى اللَّهِ فِي الرَّخَاءِ يَعْرِفْكَ فِي الشِّدَّةِ، وَاعْلَمْ أَنَّ مَا أَخْطَأَكَ لَمْ يَكُنْ لِيُصِيبَكَ، وَمَا أَصَابَكَ لَمْ يَكُنْ لِيُخْطِئَكَ، وَاعْلَمْ أَنَّ النَّصْرَ مَعَ الصَّبْرِ، وَأَنَّ الفَرَجَ مَعَ الكَرْبِ، وَأَنَّ مَعَ العُسْرِ يُسْرًا».

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Abbas Abdullah bin Abbas (may Allah be pleased with him) who said: One day I was behind the Prophet ﷺ [riding on the same mount] and he said, "**O young man, I shall teach you some words [of advice]: Be mindful of Allah and Allah will protect you. Be mindful of Allah and you will find Him in front of you. If you ask, then ask Allah [alone]; and if you seek help, then seek help from Allah [alone]. And know that if the nation were to gather together to benefit you with anything, they would not benefit you except with what Allah had already prescribed for you. And if they were to gather together to harm you with anything, they would not harm you except with what Allah had already prescribed against you. The pens have been lifted and the pages have dried.**"

It was related by at-Tirmidhi, who said it was a good and sound hadeeth.

Another narration, other than that of Tirmidhi, reads: **Be mindful of Allah, and you will find Him in front of you. Recognize and acknowledge Allah in times of ease and prosperity, and He will remember you in times of adversity. And know that what has passed you by [and you have failed to attain] was not going to befall you, and what has befallen you was not going to pass you by. And know that victory comes with patience, relief with affliction, and hardship with ease**

Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 19 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:19*

About the Narrator

ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿAbbās d. 68 AH

عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ عَبَّاسٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا

The cousin of the Prophet ﷺ, born three years before the Hijrah. He was about thirteen when the Prophet ﷺ died, yet the Prophet ﷺ had prayed for him: "O Allah, give him understanding of the religion and teach him interpretation." After the Prophet's ﷺ death he went from Companion to Companion collecting knowledge, sometimes sleeping at their doors. He became known as **the scholar of the Ummah** and the interpreter of the Qur'an, and ʿUmar sat him with the senior Companions. He died in aṭ-Ṭā'if in 68 AH.

Explanatory Note

Ibn ʿAbbās was a young boy riding behind the Prophet ﷺ when he received this advice. **'Guard Allah and He will guard you'**: guard His limits, His rights and His commands — especially the prayer, the tongue and the private parts — and Allah will protect you in your body, family and religion. **'You will find Him in front of you'**: with you, helping and guiding you.

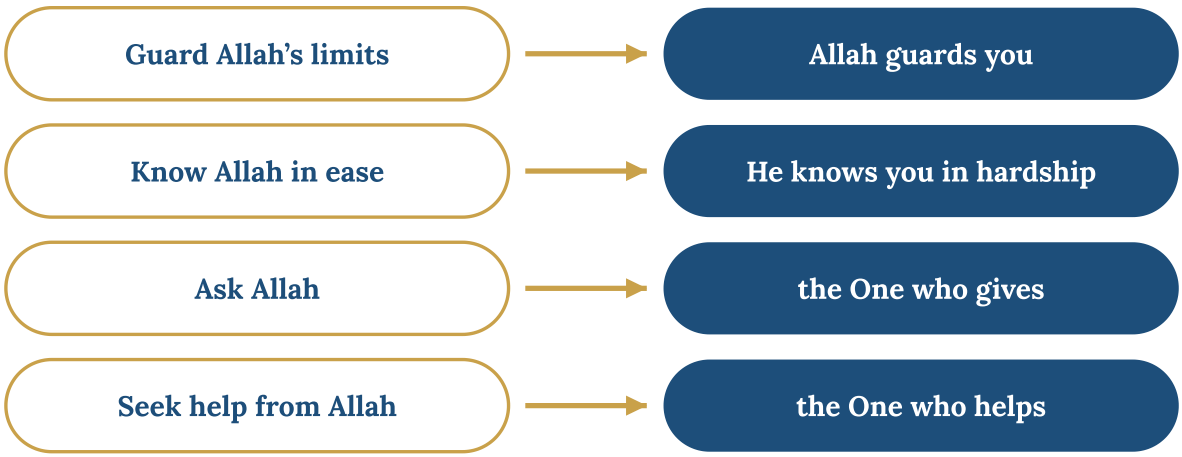
Ask Allah, seek help from Allah: du'a and seeking help are worship. We may ask people for help in what they are able to do, but our hearts rely only on Allah. **The whole nation cannot benefit or harm you** except with what Allah has written. This removes fear of people and hope in people from the heart. **'The pens have been lifted and the pages have dried'**: Allah's decree is complete.

The longer narration adds[1]: **know Allah in ease and He will know you in hardship** — whoever obeys Allah when life is easy will find Allah's help when life is hard, like Yūnus in the belly of the whale. And: what missed you was never going to hit you; victory comes with patience, relief with distress, and ease with hardship. This gives the believer strength, hope and calm in every situation.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 19.

Picture

see and remember



Guard Allah's rights and He guards you; turn to Him alone in every need.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Guarding Allah's commands brings Allah's protection.
2. Du'a and seeking help are worship to be directed to Allah alone.
3. No one can benefit or harm you except by Allah's decree.
4. Obedience in times of ease brings Allah's help in times of hardship.
5. Patience is the key to victory; every hardship is followed by ease.
6. Children should be taught tawḥīd and trust in Allah from a young age.

Step by Step

What to do in times of difficulty

1. **Turn to Allah first**
   Make du'a before calling anyone.

2. **Take the means**
   Do what you can, and ask people for help in what they are able to do.

3. **Remember qadar**
   What reached you was written; do not say 'if only...'.

4. **Be patient**
   Victory comes with patience.

5. **Wait for ease**
   «فَإِنَّ مَعَ الْعُسْرِ يُسْرًا» — ease is coming.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 How old was Ibn 'Abbās, and where was he when he received this advice?

Q2 What does 'guard Allah' mean? Give examples.

Q3 What is the difference between asking Allah and asking people for help?

Q4 What does 'the pens have been lifted and the pages have dried' mean?

Q5 Explain 'know Allah in ease and He will know you in hardship'.

Q6 Which sentence of this hadith gives you the most comfort? Why?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the first part, up to «جَفَّتِ الصُّحُفُ…».	☐
Sun	Before asking anyone for anything, ask Allah first.	☐
Mon	Guard your five prayers perfectly this week.	☐
Tue	Do one extra good deed while life is easy.	☐
Wed	When something goes wrong, say «قَدَّرَ اللَّهُ وَمَا شَاءَ فَعَلَ».	☐
Thu	Teach a young person the first lines of this hadith.	☐
Fri	Read the story of Yūnus (al-Anbiyā' 21:87-88).	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

20

HADITH 20 OF 50

Modesty: If You Feel No Shame...

الحَدِيثُ العِشْرُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/20

A saying from the earliest prophets: modesty is the guard of good deeds.

عَنْ أَبِي مَسْعُودٍ عُقْبَةَ بْنِ عَمْرٍو الأَنْصَارِيِّ البَدْرِيِّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «إِنَّ مِمَّا أَدْرَكَ النَّاسُ مِنْ كَلَامِ النُّبُوَّةِ الأُولَى: إِذَا لَمْ تَسْتَحِ فَاصْنَعْ مَا شِئْتَ».

رَوَاهُ البُخَارِيُّ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Masood Uqbah bin 'Amr al-Ansaree al-Badree (may Allah be pleased with him) who said: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "**Verily, from what was learnt by the people from the speech of the earliest prophecy is: If you feel no shame, then do as you wish.**"

[Al-Bukhari] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 20 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:20*

About the Narrator

Abū Masʿūd al-Badrī d. c. 40 AH

أَبُو مَسْعُودٍ البَدْرِيُّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

ʿUqbah ibn ʿAmr al-Anṣārī was one of the youngest at the Second Pledge of ʿAqabah. He is called al-Badrī because he lived at the well of Badr. He fought at Uḥud and later battles, settled in Kūfah, and was known for his knowledge. He died around 40 AH.

Explanatory Note

This saying was known from the speech of the earlier prophets and was passed down among people, which shows that modesty (*ḥayā'*) is a value of all the prophets. *Ḥayā'* is a feeling inside that stops a person from doing what is ugly and pushes him to do what is beautiful. The Prophet ﷺ said: "Modesty is a branch of faith"[1] and "Modesty brings nothing but good."[2]

The words "then do as you wish" have two explanations. First, they are a **warning**: if you have no shame, do what you like — you will be punished for it, like the verse "Do whatever you will" (Fuṣṣilat

41:40). Second, they are a **permission**: if a deed is not something to be ashamed of before Allah or people, you may do it. Both meanings are true.

The best modesty is modesty before **Allah**: knowing that He sees us, so we feel shy to disobey Him. Then modesty before **people**, by avoiding what is shameful, and modesty before **oneself**. True modesty never stops a person from learning, asking or speaking the truth. ʿĀ'ishah praised the women of the Anṣār because their modesty did not prevent them from learning their religion[3].

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 20.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Modesty is a value taught by all the prophets.
2. Modesty is part of faith and brings only good.
3. Losing modesty opens the door to every evil.
4. The highest modesty is before Allah, who sees everything.
5. A deed you would be ashamed of before Allah or people should be left.
6. Shyness that stops you from learning or speaking the truth is not true modesty.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **Where did this saying come from?**

Q2 **Define ḥayā' in your own words.**

Q3 **Give the two explanations of 'do as you wish'.**

Q4 **What are the three kinds of modesty?**

Q5 **Why was ʿĀ'ishah pleased with the women of the Anṣār?**

Q6 **How does social media test modesty? How can a Muslim stay modest online?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Choose clothing that shows modesty and dignity.	☐
Mon	Before posting or sharing anything, ask: 'Would I be shy if Allah sees this?'	☐
Tue	Lower your gaze from what is not appropriate.	☐
Wed	Use polite and clean words only today.	☐
Thu	Ask a question in class or a study circle you were too shy to ask.	☐
Fri	Make du'a: «اللَّهُمَّ إِنِّي أَسْأَلُكَ الهُدَى وَالتُّقَى وَالعَفَافَ وَالغِنَى».	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

PART TWO · HADITH 11–20

Review Test

اخْتِبَارُ المُرَاجَعَة

Take this test online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/test2

Name: ..... Date: ..... Score: ..... / 50

Answer from memory first, then check your answers with the chapters. The answer key is at the back of the book.

A Multiple Choice

Circle the correct answer · 25 marks

1. **Who narrated "Leave what makes you doubt for what does not make you doubt"?**
   - (A) Ibn ʿAbbās
   - (B) Anas ibn Mālik
   - (C) Abū Hurayrah
   - (D) Al-Ḥasan ibn ʿAlī

2. **Hadith 11 is a practical rule that follows from which earlier hadith?**
   - (A) Hadith 8
   - (B) Hadith 6
   - (C) Hadith 3
   - (D) Hadith 10

3. **A passing doubt about wudu after being certain of it should be…**
   - (A) followed by a new ghusl
   - (B) obeyed
   - (C) told to everyone
   - (D) ignored, because certainty is not removed by doubt

4. **"Part of the perfection of one's Islam is…"**
   - (A) leaving what does not concern him
   - (B) travelling
   - (C) giving a lot of money
   - (D) praying at night

5. **Who decides what 'concerns' a person?**
   - (A) The Shariah
   - (B) His friends
   - (C) His desires
   - (D) The news

6. **In Hadith 13, 'none of you believes' means…**
   - (A) he cannot pray
   - (B) his faith is not complete
   - (C) he leaves Islam
   - (D) he must repeat his shahadah

7. **Anas ibn Mālik served the Prophet ﷺ for…**
   - (A) ten years
   - (B) one year
   - (C) five years
   - (D) twenty years

8. **Hadith 14 mentions how many cases in which a Muslim's life may be taken?**
   - (A) Four
   - (B) Five
   - (C) Two
   - (D) Three

9. **Who may carry out the punishments in Hadith 14?**
   - (A) Neighbours
   - (B) The legitimate authority and courts
   - (C) The family
   - (D) Any Muslim

10. **Hadith 15 tells the believer to speak good or…**
    - (A) leave the room
    - (B) shout
    - (C) stay silent
    - (D) write it down

11. Which two people does Hadith 15 tell us to honour?

(A) Father and son
(B) Ruler and judge
(C) Neighbour and guest
(D) Teacher and student

12. What advice did the Prophet ﷺ repeat many times in Hadith 16?

(A) Give charity
(B) Pray at night
(C) Read Qur'an
(D) Do not become angry

13. Who is truly strong, according to the Prophet ﷺ?

(A) The tallest man
(B) The richest man
(C) The one who controls himself when angry
(D) The best wrestler

14. Which of these is a remedy for anger taught in the Sunnah?

(A) Breaking something
(B) Shouting louder
(C) Making wudu
(D) Running away from home

15. Hadith 17 says Allah has prescribed iḥsān in...

(A) everything
(B) prayer only
(C) trade only
(D) Ramadan only

16. When slaughtering, the knife should be...

(A) shown to the animal
(B) sharp
(C) blunt
(D) heated

17. "Follow a bad deed with a good deed and it will..."

(A) double it
(B) wipe it out
(C) hide it
(D) delay it

18. Who narrated Hadith 18 together with Abū Dharr?

(A) Khālid ibn al-Walīd
(B) Salmān
(C) Bilāl
(D) Muʿādh ibn Jabal

19. Ibn ʿAbbās received the advice of Hadith 19 while...

(A) riding behind the Prophet ﷺ
(B) travelling to Shām
(C) sitting in the mosque
(D) at the battle of Badr

20. "Guard Allah and..."

(A) people will love you
(B) He will guard you
(C) you will never be sad
(D) you will be rich

21. "The pens have been lifted and..."

(A) the angels have left
(B) the books are closed
(C) the Hour has come
(D) the pages have dried

22. If the whole nation gathered to harm you, they could only harm you with...

(A) what Allah has written against you
(B) their weapons
(C) their numbers
(D) their money

23. "Know Allah in ease and He will know you in..."

(A) hardship
(B) Ramadan
(C) the grave
(D) Paradise

24. Hadith 20 says the saying about modesty comes from...

(A) the poets
(B) the Companions
(C) the earliest prophecy
(D) the kings of Persia

25. **"Modesty brings nothing but..."**
   - (A) silence
   - (B) shyness
   - (C) good
   - (D) difficulty

B MATCHING

Write the letter of the English meaning next to each Arabic phrase · 10 marks

1	دَعْ مَا يَرِيبُكَ إِلَى مَا لَا يَرِيبُكَ	☐	A	Follow a bad deed with a good deed and it will wipe it out.
2	مِنْ حُسْنِ إِسْلَامِ الْمَرْءِ تَرْكُهُ مَا لَا يَعْنِيهِ	☐	B	The blood of a Muslim is not lawful except in one of three cases.
3	حَتَّى يُحِبَّ لِأَخِيهِ مَا يُحِبُّ لِنَفْسِهِ	☐	C	Leave what makes you doubt for what does not make you doubt.
4	لَا يَحِلُّ دَمُ امْرِئٍ مُسْلِمٍ إِلَّا بِإِحْدَى ثَلَاثٍ	☐	D	Do not become angry.
5	فَلْيَقُلْ خَيْرًا أَوْ لِيَصْمُتْ	☐	E	Part of the beauty of a person's Islam is leaving what does not concern him.
6	لَا تَغْضَبْ	☐	F	If you feel no shame, then do as you wish.
7	إِنَّ اللَّهَ كَتَبَ الْإِحْسَانَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ	☐	G	Until he loves for his brother what he loves for himself.
8	وَأَتْبِعِ السَّيِّئَةَ الْحَسَنَةَ تَمْحُهَا	☐	H	Let him speak good or keep silent.
9	احْفَظِ اللَّهَ يَحْفَظْكَ	☐	I	Allah has prescribed excellence in everything.
10	إِذَا لَمْ تَسْتَحِ فَاصْنَعْ مَا شِئْتَ	☐	J	Guard Allah and He will guard you.

C SHORT ANSWER

Answer in one or two sentences · 10 marks

1. **What is the difference between a real doubt and waswās?**

2. **Give three examples of things that do not concern a person.**

3. How does Hadith 13 remove envy from the heart?

4. What are the three cases mentioned in Hadith 14?

5. What is the right of a guest according to the Sunnah?

6. List four remedies for anger.

7. Name three rules of kindness when slaughtering an animal.

8. What are the three commands of Hadith 18?

9. Which steps make repentance sincere?

10. What are the two explanations of ‘do as you wish’ in Hadith 20?

D Critical Thinking

Explain your thinking with evidence from the hadith · 5 marks

1. Hadith 12 tells us to leave what does not concern us. How can a young Muslim apply this to phones and social media? Give a practical plan.

2. Is it possible to love for others what you love for yourself while competing with them in an exam or a race? Explain using Hadith 13.

3. A classmate insults you in front of others. Using Hadith 16 and Hadith 18, describe step by step what you should do, both in the moment and afterwards.

4. Hadith 19 was taught to a young boy. Why do you think the Prophet ﷺ chose to teach these words to a child? What would change if every child learned them?

5. Modesty sometimes stops people from asking questions in class. Is that true modesty? Explain using Hadith 20 and the example of the women of the Anṣār.



PART THREE

The Paths of Goodness

Hadith 21 – 30

21 Say: I Believe in Allah, Then Be Steadfast

22 The Obligations Lead to Paradise

23 Purity Is Half of Faith

24 O My Servants, I Have Forbidden Oppression

25 Every Tasbih Is a Charity

26 A Charity for Every Joint

27 Righteousness Is Good Character

28 Hold Fast to the Sunnah

29 The Deed That Leads to Paradise

30 Obligations, Limits and Things Left Unmentioned

HADITH 21 OF 50

21

Say: I Believe in Allah, Then Be Steadfast

الحَدِيثُ الحَادِي وَالعِشْرُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/21

The whole religion in two words: faith and steadfastness.

عَنْ أَبِي عَمْرٍو - وَقِيلَ: أَبِي عَمْرَةَ - سُفْيَانَ بْنِ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ الثَّقَفِيِّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قُلْتُ: يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ، قُلْ لِي فِي الإِسْلَامِ قَوْلًا لَا أَسْأَلُ عَنْهُ أَحَدًا غَيْرَكَ. قَالَ: «**قُلْ: آمَنْتُ بِاللَّهِ، ثُمَّ اسْتَقِمْ**».

رَوَاهُ مُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu `Amr — and he is also called Abu `Amrah — Sufyan bin Abdullah ath- Thaqafee (may Allah be pleased with him) who said: I said, "O Messenger of Allah, tell me something about al-Islam which I can ask of no one but you." He ﷺ said, "**Say I believe in Allah — and then be steadfast.**"

[Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 21 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:21*

About the Narrator

Sufyān ibn ʿAbdullāh ath-Thaqafī

سُفْيَانُ بْنُ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ الثَّقَفِيُّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

From the tribe of Thaqīf in aṭ-Ṭā'if, he came with the delegation of his people and accepted Islam in 9 AH. His request for 'one statement about Islam' shows his wish for clear, complete guidance. ʿUmar later appointed him to collect the zakah of aṭ-Ṭā'if.

Explanatory Note

Sufyān asked for one complete statement about Islam, so that he would never need to ask anyone else. The Prophet ﷺ gave him two things. **'I believe in Allah'**: true faith in the heart, spoken by the tongue, including belief in all that Allah has told us. **'Then be steadfast'** (*istiqāmah*): stay firmly on

the straight path, doing what is commanded and leaving what is forbidden, without turning right or left.

Allah says: "Indeed, those who say 'Our Lord is Allah' and then remain steadfast — the angels descend upon them: 'Do not fear and do not grieve, but receive good news of Paradise'" (Fuṣṣilat 41:30)[1]. ʿUmar explained istiqāmah as being steadfast in obedience and not slipping away like foxes. Ibn ʿAbbās said no verse was harder on the Prophet ﷺ than "So be steadfast as you have been commanded" (Hūd 11:112)[2].

Perfect steadfastness is difficult, so the Prophet ﷺ also said: "Be steadfast, though you will not be able to do it fully"[3] and "Aim for what is right and come close."[4] Mistakes will happen; we correct them with repentance. The key to steadfastness is the heart and the tongue: when they are upright, the limbs follow.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 21.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Faith must be followed by steadfast action.
2. Istiqāmah means staying on the straight path in belief, worship and character.
3. Those who are steadfast receive the angels' glad tidings at death.
4. Perfect steadfastness is hard; aim close to it and repent from shortcomings.
5. The heart and the tongue are the keys of steadfastness.
6. Asking for a comprehensive advice is a sign of wisdom.

Step by Step

Staying steadfast every day

1. **Renew faith**
   Begin each day with the morning adhkār.

2. **Hold to the obligations**
   Prayers on time, no matter what.

3. **Keep small regular deeds**
   A few verses, a little dhikr, every day.

4. **Correct quickly**
   When you slip, repent and return immediately.

5. **Ask Allah**
   «اهْدِنَا الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِيمَ» — mean it in every rakʿah.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 What did Sufyān ask for, and why?

Q2 Explain the two parts of the Prophet's ﷺ answer.

Q3 What do the angels say to those who are steadfast (Fuṣṣilat 41:30)?

Q4 How did ʿUmar describe istiqāmah?

Q5 If perfect steadfastness is so hard, what should we do?

Q6 What makes you lose steadfastness, and what will you do about it?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Read Fuṣṣilat 41:30-32 with the meaning.	☐
Mon	Pray every prayer on time this week — no exceptions.	☐
Tue	Choose one small daily deed and do it every day.	☐
Wed	Reflect on «اهْدِنَا الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِيمَ» in each rakʿah.	☐
Thu	Remove one thing from your life that pulls you away from the path.	☐
Fri	Make duʿa: «يَا مُقَلِّبَ الْقُلُوبِ ثَبِّتْ قَلْبِي عَلَى دِينِكَ».	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 22 OF 50

22

The Obligations Lead to Paradise

الحَدِيثُ الثَّانِي وَالعِشْرُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/22

Doing the obligations and avoiding the forbidden is the road to Jannah.

عَنْ أَبِي عَبْدِ اللَّهِ جَابِرِ بْنِ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ الأَنْصَارِيِّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا أَنَّ رَجُلًا سَأَلَ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ فَقَالَ: أَرَأَيْتَ إِذَا صَلَّيْتُ المَكْتُوبَاتِ، وَصُمْتُ رَمَضَانَ، وَأَحْلَلْتُ الحَلَالَ، وَحَرَّمْتُ الحَرَامَ، وَلَمْ أَزِدْ عَلَى ذَلِكَ شَيْئًا، أَأَدْخُلُ الجَنَّةَ؟ قَالَ: «نَعَمْ».

رَوَاهُ مُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Abdullah Jabir bin Abdullah al-Ansaree (may Allah be pleased with him) that: A man questioned the Messenger of Allah ﷺ and said, "Do you think that if I perform the obligatory prayers, fast in Ramadhan, treat as lawful that which is halal, and treat as forbidden that which is haram, and do not increase upon that [in voluntary good deeds], then I shall enter Paradise?" He ﷺ replied, "**Yes.**"

[Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 22 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:22*

About the Narrator

Jābir ibn ʿAbdullāh d. 78 AH — جَابِرُ بْنُ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا

An Anṣārī Companion who attended the Second Pledge of ʿAqabah as a boy with his father, who was later martyred at Uḥud. Jābir cared for his many sisters, and the Prophet ﷺ helped him pay his father's debts with a blessing in his dates. He took part in nineteen expeditions and the Pledge of Riḍwān, travelled a month to hear a single hadith, and narrated over 1,500 hadith. He was among the last Companions to die in Madinah, in 78 AH.

The man who asked is named in Muslim as an-Nuʿmān ibn Qawqal.

Explanatory Note

A man asked: if I pray the obligatory prayers, fast Ramadan, treat the halal as halal and the haram as haram, and do nothing more — will I enter Paradise? The Prophet ﷺ said: "Yes." The religion is easy: whoever does the obligations and avoids the prohibitions will enter Paradise by Allah's mercy.

'Treating the halal as halal' means believing it is lawful and using it; 'treating the haram as haram' means believing it is forbidden **and avoiding it**. Zakah and Hajj are not mentioned, perhaps because they were not yet obligatory or because the man was not able. Other hadith complete the picture.

This does not mean a Muslim should ignore voluntary acts. The voluntary deeds raise one's rank in Paradise, protect the obligations and complete what is missing from them on the Day of Judgement. But the hadith gives great hope: the minimum required is clear and achievable, so no one should despair.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Doing the obligations and avoiding the prohibitions leads to Paradise.
2. The religion of Allah is easy and clear.
3. Making the halal lawful and the haram forbidden is part of faith.
4. Voluntary deeds raise ranks and make up for shortcomings.
5. Asking about the path to Paradise is the best question.
6. We must be firm on the obligations before anything else.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **What four things did the man mention?**

Q2 **What did the Prophet ﷺ answer, and what does it teach us about the religion?**

Q3 **What does 'treat the haram as haram' mean?**

Q4 **Why might zakah and Hajj not be mentioned?**

Q5 **Why are voluntary deeds still important?**

Q6 **Which obligation do you need to be more careful with?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Pray all five obligatory prayers on time every day.	☐
Mon	Write a list of the obligations upon you right now.	☐
Tue	Leave one thing you know is haram.	☐
Wed	Thank Allah for making the religion easy.	☐
Thu	Add one voluntary prayer to protect your obligations.	☐
Fri	Make du'a to enter Paradise without reckoning.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

23

HADITH 23 OF 50

Purity Is Half of Faith

الحَدِيثُ الثَّالِثُ وَالعِشْرُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/23

A list of deeds that fill the scales and light the way.

عَنْ أَبِي مَالِكٍ الحَارِثِ بْنِ عَاصِمٍ الأَشْعَرِيِّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «الطُّهُورُ شَطْرُ الإِيمَانِ، وَالحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ تَمْلَأُ المِيزَانَ، وَسُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ وَالحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ تَمْلَآنِ ـ أَوْ تَمْلَأُ ـ مَا بَيْنَ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالأَرْضِ، وَالصَّلاَةُ نُورٌ، وَالصَّدَقَةُ بُرْهَانٌ، وَالصَّبْرُ ضِيَاءٌ، وَالقُرْآنُ حُجَّةٌ لَكَ أَوْ عَلَيْكَ، كُلُّ النَّاسِ يَغْدُو فَبَائِعٌ نَفْسَهُ فَمُعْتِقُهَا أَوْ مُوبِقُهَا».

رَوَاهُ مُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Malik al-Harith bin Asim al-Asharee (may Allah be pleased with him) who said: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "**Purity is half of iman (faith). 'Al-hamdu lillah (praise be to Allah)' fills the scales, and 'subhan-Allah (how far is Allah from every imperfection) and 'Al-hamdulillah (praise be to Allah)' fill that which is between heaven and earth. And the salah (prayer) is a light, and charity is a proof, and patience is illumination, and the Qur'an is a proof either for you or against you. Every person starts his day as a vendor of his soul, either freeing it or causing its ruin.**"

[Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 23 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:23*

About the Narrator

Abū Mālik al-Ashʿarī (d. 18 AH) أَبُو مَالِكٍ الأَشْعَرِيُّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Al-Ḥārith ibn ʿĀṣim of the Ashʿarī tribe of Yemen came to Madinah with his people, whom the Prophet ﷺ praised for their soft hearts and generosity. He settled in Shām and died in the plague of ʿAmwās in 18 AH, in the same year as Muʿādh ibn Jabal.

Explanatory Note

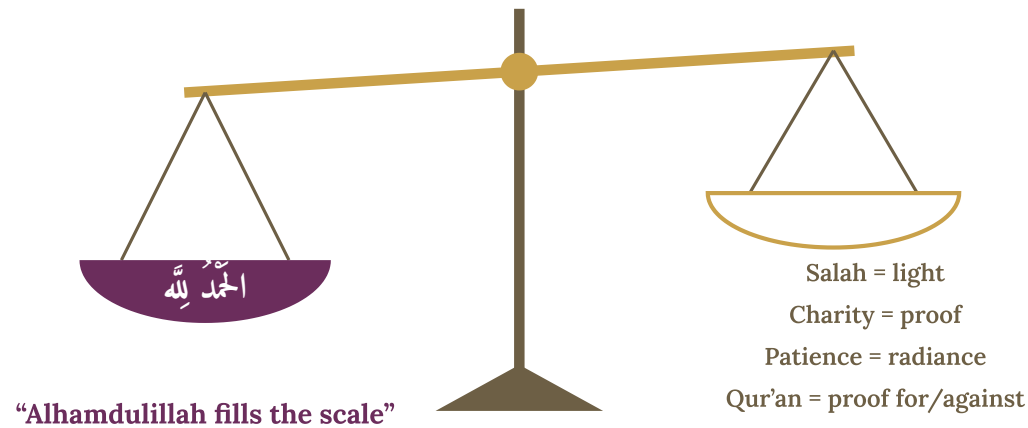
Purity is half of faith: wudu and ghusl cleanse the body, and they also purify the heart, because sins fall away with the water of wudu. Some scholars said the 'half' means outward purity, while faith completes it with inward purity from shirk and sin. **Al-ḥamdu lillāh fills the scale**, and **subḥān Allāh wa-l-ḥamdu lillāh fill what is between heaven and earth**: simple words, enormous weight.

Prayer is light: in the heart, on the face, in the grave and on the Day of Judgement. **Charity is a proof**: proof of true faith, because a hypocrite does not give willingly. **Patience is radiance** (*ḍiyā'*): a light with heat, because patience is hard but it lights the way. **The Qur'an is a proof for you or against you**: for whoever recites and acts upon it, against whoever neglects it.

Every person goes out in the morning selling himself: each day we trade our time and soul. Whoever spends it in obeying Allah frees himself from the Fire; whoever spends it in disobedience destroys himself. Every morning is a market; what will you buy?

Picture

see and remember



"Alhamdulillah fills the scale" — words that weigh heavily on the Day of Judgement.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Purity has great value in Islam; it is half of faith.
2. Simple words of dhikr are very heavy on the scale.
3. Prayer gives light to the heart, face and path.
4. Charity proves the truth of faith.
5. Patience is difficult but it lights up the way.
6. The Qur'an will be a witness for or against us.
7. Every day we either free our soul or destroy it.

Step by Step

Making a perfect wudu

1. **Intend and say Bismillah**
   Intend wudu in the heart.

2. **Wash the hands**
   Three times, then rinse mouth and nose three times.

3. **Wash the face**
   From hairline to chin and ear to ear, three times.

4. **Wash the arms**
   Right then left, up to and including the elbows, three times.

5. **Wipe the head and ears**
   Once, front to back and back again.

6. **Wash the feet**
   Right then left, up to and including the ankles, three times.

7. **Finish with the dua**
   «أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا اللَّهُ...».

Questions

think, then write

Q1 Why is purity called ‘half of faith’?

Q2 Which words fill the scale? Which fill what is between heaven and earth?

Q3 Match each deed to its description: prayer, charity, patience, Qur’an.

Q4 Why is charity called a ‘proof’?

Q5 How can the Qur'an be a proof against someone?

Q6 Explain 'every person goes out in the morning selling himself'.

Q7 How did you 'sell your soul' today — freeing it or destroying it?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the first half, up to «وَالصَّلَاةُ نُورٌ».	☐
Sun	Make every wudu today slowly and perfectly.	☐
Mon	Say subḥān Allāh wa-l-ḥamdu lillāh 100 times.	☐
Tue	Give a charity, even a small one.	☐
Wed	Be patient with one difficulty without complaining.	☐
Thu	Recite and act upon one verse of the Qur'an.	☐
Fri	Each morning ask yourself: 'How will I free my soul today?'	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 24 OF 50

24

O My Servants, I Have Forbidden Oppression

الحَدِيثُ الرَّابِعُ وَالعِشْرُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/24

A ḥadīth qudsī about justice, need, forgiveness and Allah's perfect richness.

عَنْ أَبِي ذَرٍّ الغِفَارِيِّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ عَنِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ فِيمَا يَرْوِيهِ عَنْ رَبِّهِ تَبَارَكَ وَتَعَالَى أَنَّهُ قَالَ: «يَا عِبَادِي، إِنِّي حَرَّمْتُ الظُّلْمَ عَلَى نَفْسِي، وَجَعَلْتُهُ بَيْنَكُمْ مُحَرَّمًا فَلَا تَظَالَمُوا.

يَا عِبَادِي، كُلُّكُمْ ضَالٌّ إِلَّا مَنْ هَدَيْتُهُ، فَاسْتَهْدُونِي أَهْدِكُمْ.

يَا عِبَادِي، كُلُّكُمْ جَائِعٌ إِلَّا مَنْ أَطْعَمْتُهُ، فَاسْتَطْعِمُونِي أُطْعِمْكُمْ.

يَا عِبَادِي، كُلُّكُمْ عَارٍ إِلَّا مَنْ كَسَوْتُهُ، فَاسْتَكْسُونِي أَكْسُكُمْ.

يَا عِبَادِي، إِنَّكُمْ تُخْطِئُونَ بِاللَّيْلِ وَالنَّهَارِ، وَأَنَا أَغْفِرُ الذُّنُوبَ جَمِيعًا، فَاسْتَغْفِرُونِي أَغْفِرْ لَكُمْ.

يَا عِبَادِي، إِنَّكُمْ لَنْ تَبْلُغُوا ضُرِّي فَتَضُرُّونِي، وَلَنْ تَبْلُغُوا نَفْعِي فَتَنْفَعُونِي.

يَا عِبَادِي، لَوْ أَنَّ أَوَّلَكُمْ وَآخِرَكُمْ وَإِنْسَكُمْ وَجِنَّكُمْ كَانُوا عَلَى أَتْقَى قَلْبِ رَجُلٍ وَاحِدٍ مِنْكُمْ، مَا زَادَ ذَلِكَ فِي مُلْكِي شَيْئًا.

يَا عِبَادِي، لَوْ أَنَّ أَوَّلَكُمْ وَآخِرَكُمْ وَإِنْسَكُمْ وَجِنَّكُمْ كَانُوا عَلَى أَفْجَرِ قَلْبِ رَجُلٍ وَاحِدٍ مِنْكُمْ، مَا نَقَصَ ذَلِكَ مِنْ مُلْكِي شَيْئًا.

يَا عِبَادِي، لَوْ أَنَّ أَوَّلَكُمْ وَآخِرَكُمْ وَإِنْسَكُمْ وَجِنَّكُمْ قَامُوا فِي صَعِيدٍ وَاحِدٍ فَسَأَلُونِي، فَأَعْطَيْتُ كُلَّ إِنْسَانٍ مَسْأَلَتَهُ، مَا نَقَصَ ذَلِكَ مِمَّا عِنْدِي إِلَّا كَمَا يَنْقُصُ المِخْيَطُ إِذَا أُدْخِلَ البَحْرَ.

يَا عِبَادِي، إِنَّمَا هِيَ أَعْمَالُكُمْ أُحْصِيهَا لَكُمْ، ثُمَّ أُوَفِّيكُمْ إِيَّاهَا، فَمَنْ وَجَدَ خَيْرًا فَلْيَحْمَدِ اللَّهَ، وَمَنْ وَجَدَ غَيْرَ ذَلِكَ فَلَا يَلُومَنَّ إِلَّا نَفْسَهُ».

رَوَاهُ مُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Dharr al-Ghifaree (may Allah be pleased with him) from the Prophet ﷺ from his Lord, that He said: **O My servants! I have forbidden dhulm (oppression) for Myself, and I have made it forbidden amongst you, so do not oppress one another.**

O My servants, all of you are astray except those whom I have guided, so seek guidance from Me and I shall guide you.

O My servants, all of you are hungry except those whom I have fed, so seek food from Me and I shall feed you.

O My servants, all of you are naked except those whom I have clothed, so seek clothing from Me and I shall clothe you.

O My servants, you commit sins by day and by night, and I forgive all sins, so seek forgiveness from Me and I shall forgive you.

O My servants, you will not attain harming Me so as to harm Me, and you will not attain benefiting Me so as to benefit Me.

O My servants, if the first of you and the last of you, and the humans of you and the jinn of you, were all as pious as the most pious heart of any individual amongst you, then this would not increase My Kingdom an iota.

O My servants, if the first of you and the last of you, and the humans of you and the jinn of you, were all as wicked as the most wicked heart of any individual amongst you, then this would not decrease My Kingdom an iota.

O My servants, if the first of you and the last of you, and the humans of you and the jinn of you, were all to stand together in one place and ask of Me, and I were to give everyone what he requested, then that would not decrease what I Possess, except what is decreased of the ocean when a needle is dipped into it.

O My servants, it is but your deeds that I account for you, and then recompense you for. So he who finds good, let him praise Allah, and he who finds other than that, let him blame no one but himself.

[Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 24 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:24*

About the Narrator

Abū Dharr al-Ghifārī d. 32 AH

أَبُو ذَرٍّ الغِفَارِيُّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Biography: see Hadith 18.

When the Successor Abū Idrīs al-Khawlānī narrated this hadith, he would kneel down out of respect for it.

Explanatory Note

This *ḥadīth qudsī* is called the noblest hadith of the people of Shām[1]. It begins with **justice**: Allah has forbidden Himself oppression, though He is able, out of His perfect justice, and He has forbidden it between us. Oppression includes wronging others in their life, wealth or honour, and wronging oneself by sin, and the greatest wrong is shirk.

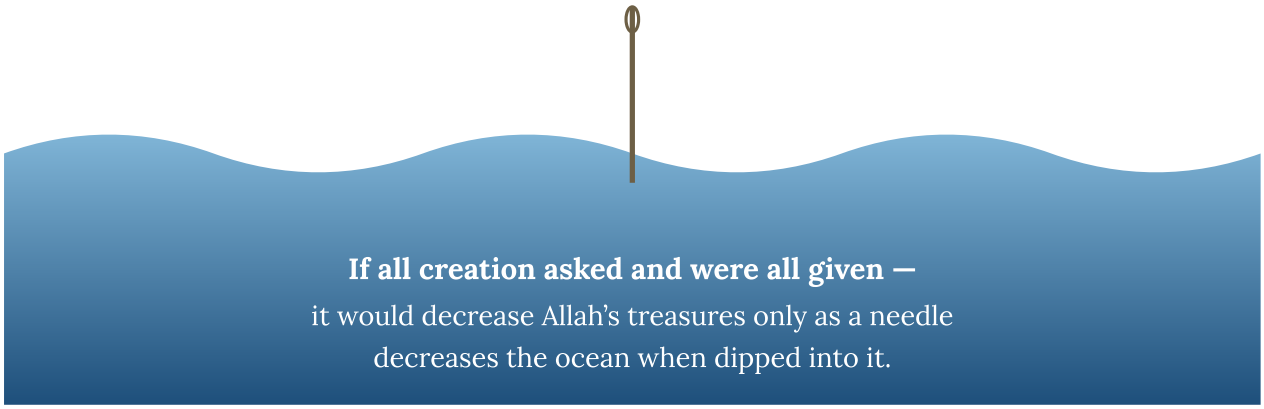
Then it shows our **complete need** for Allah: we are all astray unless He guides us, hungry unless He feeds us, naked unless He clothes us, and sinners unless He forgives us. So we must ask Him for guidance, food, clothing and forgiveness. It shows Allah's **complete richness**: the obedience of all creation adds nothing to His kingdom, and the sins of all creation take nothing from it. If all asked and were all given, it would decrease His treasures no more than a needle decreases the ocean.

It ends with **accountability**: "It is only your deeds that I record for you, then I will repay you for them." Whoever finds good should praise Allah, for it is His favour; whoever finds otherwise should blame no one but himself.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 24.

Picture

see and remember



All of creation's requests together decrease Allah's treasures no more than a needle dipped in the ocean.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Allah is perfectly just; He has forbidden oppression for Himself and for us.

2 We are completely in need of Allah for guidance, food, clothing and forgiveness.

3 Allah is completely free of need; our obedience benefits only us.

4 Allah's treasures never run out, so ask Him for everything.

5 Allah forgives all sins for those who repent and ask forgiveness.

6 We will be repaid for our own deeds; good is from Allah's favour, evil from ourselves.

Step by Step

Asking Allah as this hadith teaches

1 Ask for guidance
«اللَّهُمَّ اهْدِنِي وَسَدِّدْنِي».

2 Ask for provision
Ask Allah for food, clothing and all your needs, big and small.

3 Ask for forgiveness
Seek forgiveness day and night.

4 Be just
Return any right you have taken from anyone.

5 Praise Allah
Thank Him for every good you find.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 What has Allah forbidden for Himself and for us?

Q2 Name the four things the hadith says we need from Allah.

Q3 Why can our obedience not benefit Allah, nor our sins harm Him?

Q4 Explain the example of the needle and the ocean.

Q5 **What should a person do if he finds good? And if he finds otherwise?**

Q6 **Why do you think Abū Idrīs knelt when narrating this hadith?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the first section: «يَا عِبَادِي، إِنِّي حَرَّمْتُ الظُّلْمَ...».	☐
Sun	Return a right or apologise to someone you wronged.	☐
Mon	Ask Allah for even a small need today (e.g. your lost item).	☐
Tue	Seek forgiveness 100 times today.	☐
Wed	Feed someone hungry or give clothes to someone in need.	☐
Thu	Before sleeping, review your deeds of the day.	☐
Fri	Praise Allah for three blessings by name.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

25

HADITH 25 OF 50

Every Tasbih Is a Charity

الحَدِيثُ الخَامِسُ وَالعِشْرُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/25

The poor need not envy the rich: the doors of reward are open to all.

عَنْ أَبِي ذَرٍّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ أَيْضًا: أَنَّ نَاسًا مِنْ أَصْحَابِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالُوا لِلنَّبِيِّ ﷺ: يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ، ذَهَبَ أَهْلُ الدُّثُورِ بِالأُجُورِ، يُصَلُّونَ كَمَا نُصَلِّي، وَيَصُومُونَ كَمَا نَصُومُ، وَيَتَصَدَّقُونَ بِفُضُولِ أَمْوَالِهِمْ. قَالَ: «أَوَلَيْسَ قَدْ جَعَلَ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ مَا تَصَّدَّقُونَ؟ إِنَّ بِكُلِّ تَسْبِيحَةٍ صَدَقَةً، وَكُلِّ تَكْبِيرَةٍ صَدَقَةً، وَكُلِّ تَحْمِيدَةٍ صَدَقَةً، وَكُلِّ تَهْلِيلَةٍ صَدَقَةً، وَأَمْرٌ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ صَدَقَةٌ، وَنَهْيٌ عَنْ مُنْكَرٍ صَدَقَةٌ، وَفِي بُضْعِ أَحَدِكُمْ صَدَقَةٌ». قَالُوا: يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ، أَيَأْتِي أَحَدُنَا شَهْوَتَهُ وَيَكُونُ لَهُ فِيهَا أَجْرٌ؟ قَالَ: «أَرَأَيْتُمْ لَوْ وَضَعَهَا فِي حَرَامٍ أَكَانَ عَلَيْهِ وِزْرٌ؟ فَكَذَلِكَ إِذَا وَضَعَهَا فِي الحَلَالِ كَانَ لَهُ أَجْرٌ».

رَوَاهُ مُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

Also on the authority of Abu Dharr (may Allah be pleased with him): Some people from amongst the Companions of the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said to the Prophet ﷺ, "O Messenger of Allah, the affluent have made off with the rewards; they pray as we pray, they fast as we fast, and they give [much] in charity by virtue of their wealth." He ﷺ said, "**Has not Allah made things for you to give in charity? Truly every tasbeehah [saying: 'subhan-Allah'] is a charity, and every takbeerah [saying: 'Allahu akbar'] is a charity, and every tahmeedah [saying: 'al-hamdu lillah'] is a charity, and every tahleelah [saying: 'laa ilaha illAllah'] is a charity. And commanding the good is a charity, and forbidding an evil is a charity, and in the bud`i [sexual act] of each one of you there is a charity.**"

They said, "O Messenger of Allah, when one of us fulfils his carnal desire will he have some reward for that?" He ﷺ said, "**Do you not see that if he were to act upon it [his desire] in an unlawful manner then he would be deserving of punishment? Likewise, if he were to act upon it in a lawful manner then he will be deserving of a reward.**"

[Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 25 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:25*

About the Narrator

Abū Dharr al-Ghifārī d. 32 AH

أَبُو ذَرٍّ الغِفَارِيُّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Biography: see Hadith 18.

Explanatory Note

Poor Companions came to the Prophet ﷺ sad that the wealthy were winning the rewards: they prayed and fasted like them, but also gave charity from their extra wealth. Their sadness was about missing **good deeds**, not money — a sign of their high faith. The Prophet ﷺ comforted them: there are kinds of charity that everyone can give.

Every *tasbīḥ* (subḥān Allāh), *takbīr* (Allāhu akbar), *taḥmīd* (al-ḥamdu lillāh) and *tahlīl* (lā ilāha illā Allāh) is a charity; enjoining good and forbidding evil is a charity; even intimacy with one's lawful spouse is a charity. When the Companions were surprised, he explained: if it is done in the haram there is sin, so in the halal there is reward.

This teaches that **intention turns habits into worship**, and that the mercy of Allah is wide. In another narration, the rich heard of these words and did them too, and the Prophet ﷺ said: "That is the favour of Allah; He gives it to whom He wills."[1] So we should compete in good deeds without envying others for what Allah has given them.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 25.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Competing in good deeds is praised.
2. Dhikr is charity available to everyone, rich or poor.
3. Enjoining good and forbidding evil is charity.
4. Lawful pleasures done with the right intention become rewarded.
5. Analogy: the reward of halal is understood by comparing it with the sin of haram.
6. Allah's bounty is wide; do not envy others for His favours.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **What were the poor Companions sad about?**

Q2 **List the kinds of charity mentioned in the hadith.**

Q3 **Why were the Companions surprised by the last kind?**

Q4 **How did the Prophet ﷺ explain it to them?**

Q5 **What does this hadith teach us about intention?**

Q6 **Which kind of charity can you give more of every day?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the list: tasbīḥ, takbīr, taḥmīd, tahlīl.	☐
Sun	Say each of the four 33 times after every prayer.	☐
Mon	Encourage someone to do a good deed.	☐
Tue	Gently stop a wrong you see, as far as you are able.	☐
Wed	Make a good intention for your sleep, food and family time.	☐
Thu	Rejoice for someone who was given more than you.	☐
Fri	Teach a child the four phrases of dhikr.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

26

HADITH 26 OF 50

A Charity for Every Joint

الحَدِيثُ السَّادِسُ وَالعِشْرُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/26

Thank Allah for every bone in your body — every single day.

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «كُلُّ سُلَامَى مِنَ النَّاسِ عَلَيْهِ صَدَقَةٌ، كُلَّ يَوْمٍ تَطْلُعُ فِيهِ الشَّمْسُ: تَعْدِلُ بَيْنَ اثْنَيْنِ صَدَقَةٌ، وَتُعِينُ الرَّجُلَ فِي دَابَّتِهِ فَتَحْمِلُهُ عَلَيْهَا أَوْ تَرْفَعُ لَهُ عَلَيْهَا مَتَاعَهُ صَدَقَةٌ، وَالكَلِمَةُ الطَّيِّبَةُ صَدَقَةٌ، وَبِكُلِّ خُطْوَةٍ تَمْشِيهَا إِلَى الصَّلَاةِ صَدَقَةٌ، وَتُمِيطُ الأَذَى عَنِ الطَّرِيقِ صَدَقَةٌ».

رَوَاهُ البُخَارِيُّ وَمُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Hurayrah (may Allah be pleased with him) who said: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "**Every joint of a person must perform a charity each day that the sun rises: to judge justly between two people is a charity. To help a man with his mount, lifting him onto it or hoisting up his belongings onto it, is a charity. And the good word is a charity. And every step that you take towards the prayer is a charity, and removing a harmful object from the road is a charity.**"

[Al-Bukhari] [Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 26 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:26*

About the Narrator

Abū Hurayrah d. 57 AH — أَبُو هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Biography: see Hadith 9.

Explanatory Note

Sulāmā are the joints and small bones of the body. In a narration in Muslim, the Prophet ﷺ said the human being was created with **360 joints**[1]. Each one is a blessing that lets us move, pray and work;

and each day a charity is due as thanks for it.

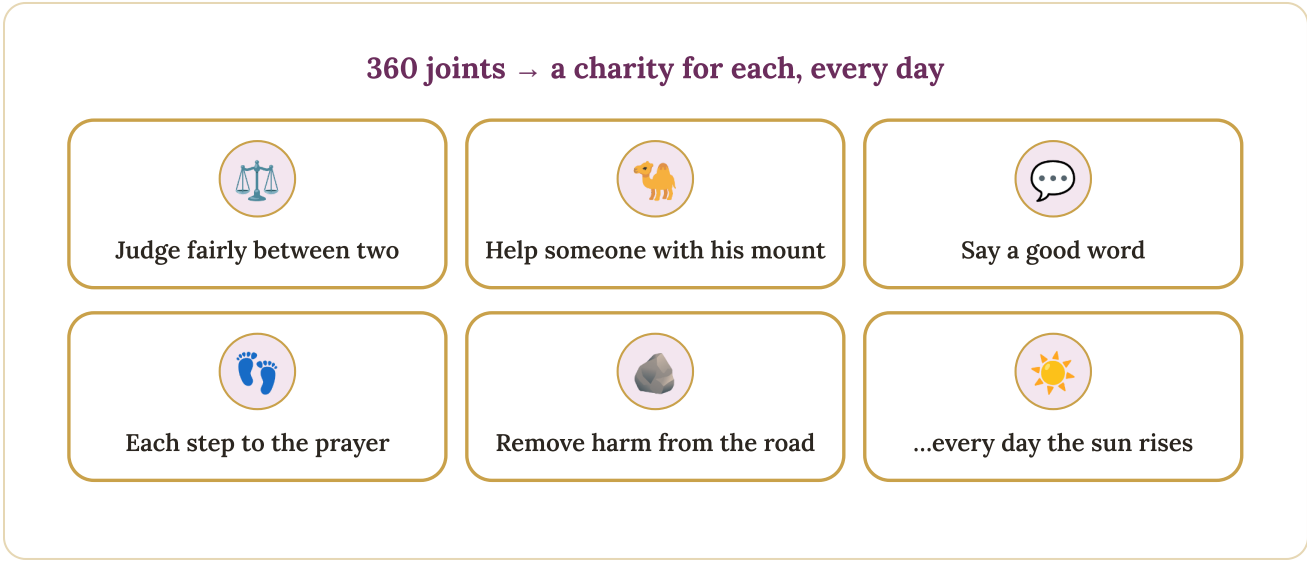
Allah made this charity easy. **Judging fairly** between two people or making peace between them; **helping someone** onto his mount or lifting his luggage; **a good word**; **every step** you take to the prayer; and **removing something harmful** from the road. In another hadith, praying two rakʿahs of Ḍuḥā is enough for all 360[2].

This hadith shows that charity is not only money. Every kind act to people, every word of goodness and every act of worship is thanks for Allah's blessings. It also shows how much Islam values service to society: fixing a broken bench, clearing a path, or helping an old person with shopping is a charity for your bones.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 26.

Picture

see and remember



360 joints — and many easy ways to give thanks for each one every day.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Our bodies are full of blessings that need thanks every day.
2. Charity includes every good deed, not just money.
3. Making peace between people is a great charity.
4. Helping others physically is a charity.
5. Walking to the mosque earns reward for every step.
6. Two rakʿahs of Ḍuḥā are enough for all the joints.

Step by Step

Praying Ḍuḥā

1 When
After the sun has risen about a spear's length (about 15–20 min after sunrise) until shortly before Ẓuhr.

2 How many
At least two rakʿahs; more is better (4, 6, 8…).

3 How
Pray like any two-rakʿah voluntary prayer.

4 Reward
It covers the charity due on all 360 joints.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 What are the sulāmā, and how many does a person have?

Q2 Why is a charity due on each joint every day?

Q3 List the charities mentioned in this hadith.

Q4 Which prayer is enough for all the joints?

Q5 Explain how removing harm from the road is a charity.

Q6 Plan three charities you can do tomorrow without money.

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Pray two rakʿahs of Ḍuḥā every day this week.	☐
Mon	Walk to the mosque for at least one prayer.	☐
Tue	Remove something harmful from a path or pavement.	☐
Wed	Help someone carry their bags.	☐
Thu	Make peace between two people who are upset.	☐
Fri	Say one good word to every member of your family.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 27 OF 50

27

Righteousness Is Good Character

الحَدِيثُ السَّابِعُ وَالعِشْرُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/27

Consult your heart: goodness brings peace, sin brings unease.

عَنِ النَّوَّاسِ بْنِ سَمْعَانَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ عَنِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ قَالَ: «**البِرُّ حُسْنُ الخُلُقِ، وَالإِثْمُ مَا حَاكَ فِي صَدْرِكَ، وَكَرِهْتَ أَنْ يَطَّلِعَ عَلَيْهِ النَّاسُ**». رَوَاهُ مُسْلِمٌ.

وَعَنْ وَابِصَةَ بْنِ مَعْبَدٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: أَتَيْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ فَقَالَ: «**جِئْتَ تَسْأَلُ عَنِ البِرِّ؟**» قُلْتُ: نَعَمْ، فَقَالَ: «**اسْتَفْتِ قَلْبَكَ، البِرُّ مَا اطْمَأَنَّتْ إِلَيْهِ النَّفْسُ، وَاطْمَأَنَّ إِلَيْهِ القَلْبُ، وَالإِثْمُ مَا حَاكَ فِي النَّفْسِ، وَتَرَدَّدَ فِي الصَّدْرِ، وَإِنْ أَفْتَاكَ النَّاسُ وَأَفْتَوْكَ**».

حَدِيثٌ حَسَنٌ، رَوَيْنَاهُ فِي مُسْنَدَيِ الإِمَامَيْنِ أَحْمَدَ بْنِ حَنْبَلٍ وَالدَّارِمِيِّ بِإِسْنَادٍ حَسَنٍ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of an-Nawas bin Sam'an (may Allah be pleased with him), that the Prophet ﷺ said: **Righteousness is in good character, and wrongdoing is that which wavers in your soul, and which you dislike people finding out about.** [Muslim]

And on the authority of Wabisah bin Ma'bad (may Allah be pleased with him) who said: I came to the Messenger of Allah ﷺ and he ﷺ said, "**You have come to ask about righteousness.**" I said, "Yes." He ﷺ said, "**Consult your heart. Righteousness is that about which the soul feels at ease and the heart feels tranquil. And wrongdoing is that which wavers in the soul and causes uneasiness in the breast, even though people have repeatedly given their legal opinion [in its favour].**"

A good hadeeth transmitted from the musnads of the two imams, Ahmed bin Hambal and Al- Darimi, with a good chain of authorities · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 27 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:27*

About the Narrators

An-Nawwās ibn Samʿān — النَّوَّاسُ بْنُ سَمْعَانَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

From the tribe of Kilāb, he stayed in Madinah for a whole year only to learn and ask the Prophet ﷺ questions. He narrated the long hadith about the Dajjāl and the descent of ʿĪsā in Muslim. He later settled in Shām.

Wābiṣah ibn Maʿbad — وَابِصَةُ بْنُ مَعْبَدٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Of the tribe of Asad, he came in 9 AH determined to ask about every kind of good and evil. Before he spoke, the Prophet ﷺ said: "You have come to ask about righteousness," and taught him to consult his heart. He settled in Kūfah and later ar-Raqqah, where he died.

Explanatory Note

Al-Birr (righteousness) is a word that collects all good. The Prophet ﷺ described it as **good character**, because good character with Allah and with people is the heart of all goodness. *Al-Ithm* (sin) is described by its sign in the heart: **what wavers in your chest and you dislike people seeing it**. The sound heart is uneasy with sin even before anyone explains why.

In the hadith of Wābiṣah, the Prophet ﷺ told him: "Consult your heart." Righteousness is what the soul and heart feel at peace with, and sin is what causes unease, **even if people give you fatwas** that it is fine. This refers to a heart that is alive with faith, and to matters that are unclear. It is not a rule for following feelings against clear texts: where there is clear evidence, it must be followed.

This hadith teaches us to keep our hearts clean so they can sense the truth, and to be honest with ourselves: when you hide something from people because you would feel ashamed, that is a warning sign. It also warns against looking for easy fatwas to justify what the heart feels is wrong.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Good character is the essence of righteousness.
2. A living heart is uneasy with sin.
3. What you would hate people to see is often a sign of sin.
4. In unclear matters, listen to a heart that is alive with faith.
5. Clear texts must be followed above feelings.
6. Do not search for fatwas to excuse what your heart knows is wrong.

Step by Step

Consulting your heart in a matter that is unclear

1. **Check the texts**
   Is there a clear ruling in the Qur'an or Sunnah? If so, follow it.

2. **Ask a scholar**
   Ask someone with knowledge you trust.

3. **Listen to your heart**
   Is it at peace or uneasy?

4. **The 'hidden' test**
   Would I be happy for good people to see this?

5. **Choose the peaceful path**
   Leave what disturbs your heart.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 What did the Prophet ﷺ say righteousness is?

Q2 Describe the two signs of sin given in the hadith.

Q3 What did the Prophet ﷺ tell Wābiṣah to do?

Q4 What does 'even if people give you fatwas' mean?

Q5 Can we follow our feelings against a clear text? Explain.

Q6 Recall a time your heart felt uneasy about something. What did you do?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the first narration: «البِرُّ حُسْنُ الخُلُقِ...».	☐
Sun	Do one good deed with good character to a family member.	☐
Mon	Leave one thing you would not want others to see.	☐
Tue	Before a decision, pause and ‘consult your heart’.	☐
Wed	Keep your heart alive with Qur’an and dhikr today.	☐
Thu	Be honest about one thing you were hiding.	☐
Fri	Make du‘a: «اللَّهُمَّ اهْدِنِي لِأَحْسَنِ الأَخْلَاقِ».	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

28

HADITH 28 OF 50

Hold Fast to the Sunnah

الحَدِيثُ الثَّامِنُ وَالعِشْرُونَ

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/40hadith/28

A farewell sermon: taqwā, obedience, the Sunnah and the rightly guided caliphs.

عَنْ أَبِي نَجِيحٍ العِرْبَاضِ بْنِ سَارِيَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: وَعَظَنَا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ مَوْعِظَةً وَجِلَتْ مِنْهَا القُلُوبُ، وَذَرَفَتْ مِنْهَا العُيُونُ، فَقُلْنَا: يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ، كَأَنَّهَا مَوْعِظَةُ مُوَدِّعٍ فَأَوْصِنَا، قَالَ: «أُوصِيكُمْ بِتَقْوَى اللَّهِ، وَالسَّمْعِ وَالطَّاعَةِ وَإِنْ تَأَمَّرَ عَلَيْكُمْ عَبْدٌ، فَإِنَّهُ مَنْ يَعِشْ مِنْكُمْ فَسَيَرَى اخْتِلَافًا كَثِيرًا، فَعَلَيْكُمْ بِسُنَّتِي وَسُنَّةِ الخُلَفَاءِ الرَّاشِدِينَ المَهْدِيِّينَ، عَضُّوا عَلَيْهَا بِالنَّوَاجِذِ، وَإِيَّاكُمْ وَمُحْدَثَاتِ الأُمُورِ، فَإِنَّ كُلَّ بِدْعَةٍ ضَلَالَةٌ».

رَوَاهُ أَبُو دَاوُدَ وَالتِّرْمِذِيُّ وَقَالَ: حَدِيثٌ حَسَنٌ صَحِيحٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Najeeh al-'Irbaad ibn Saariyah (may Allah be pleased with him) who said: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ gave us a sermon by which our hearts were filled with fear and tears came to our eyes. So we said, "O Messenger of Allah! It is as though this is a farewell sermon, so counsel us."

He ﷺ said, "**I counsel you to have taqwa (fear) of Allah, and to listen and obey [your leader], even if a slave were to become your ameer. Verily he among you who lives long will see great controversy, so you must keep to my Sunnah and to the Sunnah of the Khulafa ar-Rashideen (the rightly guided caliphs), those who guide to the right way. Cling to it stubbornly [literally: with your molar teeth]. Beware of newly invented matters [in the religion], for verily every bidah (innovation) is misguidance.**"

[Abu Dawud] It was related by at-Tirmidhi, who said that it was a good and sound hadeeth · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 28 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:28*

About the Narrator

Al-ʿIrbāḍ ibn Sāriyah d. 75 AH

العِرْبَاضُ بْنُ سَارِيَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

A poor Companion from the people of the Ṣuffah. He was among those who wept because they had no mount to join the expedition of Tabūk, about whom Allah revealed at-Tawbah 9:92. He settled in Ḥimṣ in Shām and died there in 75 AH.

Explanatory Note

The Prophet ﷺ gave a sermon so moving that hearts trembled and eyes wept. The Companions felt it was a farewell, so they asked for advice. He gave four commands. **Taqwā of Allah**, the best advice for this world and the next. **Listening and obeying** those in authority in what is good, even if a slave becomes the leader, for unity and peace.

Then he foretold **much disagreement** after him, and gave the way out: **hold to my Sunnah and the Sunnah of the rightly guided caliphs** — Abū Bakr, ʿUmar, ʿUthmān and ʿAlī — and 'bite onto it with your molar teeth', a picture of holding on as hard as you can. Finally, he warned against **newly invented matters** in the religion, for every bidʿah is misguidance (see Hadith 5).

Effective preaching moves the heart; and asking for advice when someone is leaving is wise. When we see confusion and division, the safe way is to return to what the Prophet ﷺ and his Companions were upon, with knowledge, wisdom and good manners.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Effective admonition touches the heart and is short and clear.
2. Taqwā is the best advice.
3. Obeying those in authority in good protects unity.
4. Disagreements will happen; the solution is the Sunnah.
5. The way of the rightly guided caliphs is to be followed.
6. Every innovation in the religion is misguidance.
7. Hold to the truth firmly, especially in times of confusion.

Step by Step

What to do in times of disagreement

1. **Go back to the sources**
   Qur'an and authentic Sunnah, as the Companions understood them.

2. **Ask the scholars**
   Return to the people of knowledge (an-Nisā' 4:83).

3 **Keep unity**
Do not cause division over small matters; obey in what is good.

4 **Avoid innovation**
Do not follow a practice without evidence.

5 **Keep good manners**
Disagree politely, without insult.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 How did the sermon affect the Companions?

Q2 List the four main commands of the Prophet ﷺ in this hadith.

Q3 Who are the rightly guided caliphs?

Q4 What does 'bite onto it with your molar teeth' mean?

Q5 What is the danger of newly invented matters?

Q6 How can this hadith help Muslims today when they disagree?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise from «…فَعَلَيْكُمْ بِسُنَّتِي» to the end.	☐
Sun	Learn one Sunnah of the Prophet ﷺ in eating, sleeping or greeting and practise it.	☐
Mon	Read a short biography of one of the four rightly guided caliphs.	☐
Tue	Obey your parents or teacher in one thing without arguing.	☐
Wed	Avoid an argument about the religion; speak with knowledge and kindness.	☐
Thu	Write the names of the four caliphs in order.	☐
Fri	Make du'a for the unity of the Muslims.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 29 OF 50

29

THE DEED THAT LEADS TO PARADISE

الحَدِيثُ التَّاسِعُ وَالعِشْرُونَ

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The head of the matter, its pillar, its peak — and the tongue that holds it together.

عَنْ مُعَاذِ بْنِ جَبَلٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قُلْتُ: يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ، أَخْبِرْنِي بِعَمَلٍ يُدْخِلُنِي الجَنَّةَ وَيُبَاعِدُنِي مِنَ النَّارِ، قَالَ: «لَقَدْ سَأَلْتَ عَنْ عَظِيمٍ، وَإِنَّهُ لَيَسِيرٌ عَلَى مَنْ يَسَّرَهُ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ: تَعْبُدُ اللَّهَ لَا تُشْرِكُ بِهِ شَيْئًا، وَتُقِيمُ الصَّلَاةَ، وَتُؤْتِي الزَّكَاةَ، وَتَصُومُ رَمَضَانَ، وَتَحُجُّ البَيْتَ».

ثُمَّ قَالَ: «أَلَا أَدُلُّكَ عَلَى أَبْوَابِ الخَيْرِ؟ الصَّوْمُ جُنَّةٌ، وَالصَّدَقَةُ تُطْفِئُ الخَطِيئَةَ كَمَا يُطْفِئُ المَاءُ النَّارَ، وَصَلَاةُ الرَّجُلِ فِي جَوْفِ اللَّيْلِ»، ثُمَّ تَلَا: ﴿تَتَجَافَى جُنُوبُهُمْ عَنِ المَضَاجِعِ﴾ حَتَّى بَلَغَ: ﴿يَعْمَلُونَ﴾.

ثُمَّ قَالَ: «أَلَا أُخْبِرُكَ بِرَأْسِ الأَمْرِ وَعَمُودِهِ وَذِرْوَةِ سَنَامِهِ؟» قُلْتُ: بَلَى يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ، قَالَ: «رَأْسُ الأَمْرِ الإِسْلَامُ، وَعَمُودُهُ الصَّلَاةُ، وَذِرْوَةُ سَنَامِهِ الجِهَادُ».

ثُمَّ قَالَ: «أَلَا أُخْبِرُكَ بِمِلَاكِ ذَلِكَ كُلِّهِ؟» قُلْتُ: بَلَى يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ، فَأَخَذَ بِلِسَانِهِ وَقَالَ: «كُفَّ عَلَيْكَ هَذَا». قُلْتُ: يَا نَبِيَّ اللَّهِ، وَإِنَّا لَمُؤَاخَذُونَ بِمَا نَتَكَلَّمُ بِهِ؟ فَقَالَ: «ثَكِلَتْكَ أُمُّكَ يَا مُعَاذُ! وَهَلْ يَكُبُّ النَّاسَ فِي النَّارِ عَلَى وُجُوهِهِمْ - أَوْ قَالَ: عَلَى مَنَاخِرِهِمْ - إِلَّا حَصَائِدُ أَلْسِنَتِهِمْ؟!».

رَوَاهُ التِّرْمِذِيُّ وَقَالَ: حَدِيثٌ حَسَنٌ صَحِيحٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Muadh bin Jabal (may Allah be pleased with him) who said: I said, "O Messenger of Allah, tell me of an act which will take me into Paradise and will keep me away from the Hellfire." He ﷺ said, "**You have asked me about a great matter, yet it is easy for him for whom Allah makes it easy: worship Allah, without associating any partners with Him; establish the prayer; pay the zakat; fast in Ramadhan; and make the pilgrimage to the House.**"

Then he ﷺ said, "**Shall I not guide you towards the means of goodness? Fasting is a shield; charity wipes away sin as water extinguishes fire; and the praying of a man in the depths of the night.**"

Then he ﷺ recited: "[Those] who forsake their beds, to invoke their Lord in fear and hope, and they spend (charity in Allah's cause) out of what We have bestowed on them. No person knows what is kept hidden for them of joy as a reward for what they used to do." [as-Sajdah, 16-17]

Then he ﷺ said, "**Shall I not inform you of the head of the matter, its pillar and its peak?**" I said, "Yes, O Messenger of Allah." He ﷺ said, "**The head of the matter is Islam, its pillar is the prayer and its peak is jihad.**"

Then he ﷺ said, "**Shall I not tell you of the foundation of all of that?**" I said, "Yes, O Messenger of Allah."

So he took hold of his tongue and said, "**Restrain this.**" I said, "O Prophet ﷺ of Allah, will we be taken to account for what we say with it?" He ﷺ said, "**May your mother be bereaved of you, O Muadh! Is there anything that throws people into the Hellfire upon their faces — or: on their noses — except the harvests of their tongues?**"

It was related by at-Tirmidhi, who said it was a good and sound hadeeth · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 29 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:29*

About the Narrator

Muʿādh ibn Jabal d. 18 AH

مُعَاذُ بْنُ جَبَلٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Biography: see Hadith 18.

Background of the Hadith

سَبَبُ الوُرُود

On a journey. Muʿādh said: "I was with the Prophet ﷺ on a journey. One morning I found myself close to him as we were travelling, so I said: O Messenger of Allah, tell me of a deed that will admit me to Paradise and keep me away from the Fire."[1] The long answer in this hadith was given while they rode side by side — a picture of how the Companions used every chance to learn.

Explanatory Note

Muʿādh asked for a deed that would admit him to Paradise and keep him from the Fire. The Prophet ﷺ said it is great, yet easy for whom Allah makes it easy: **worship Allah without partners and do the pillars**. Then he showed him the **doors of good**: fasting is a shield from sin and the Fire; charity puts out sin like water puts out fire; and prayer in the depths of the night, reciting the verse about those who leave their beds to call on their Lord.

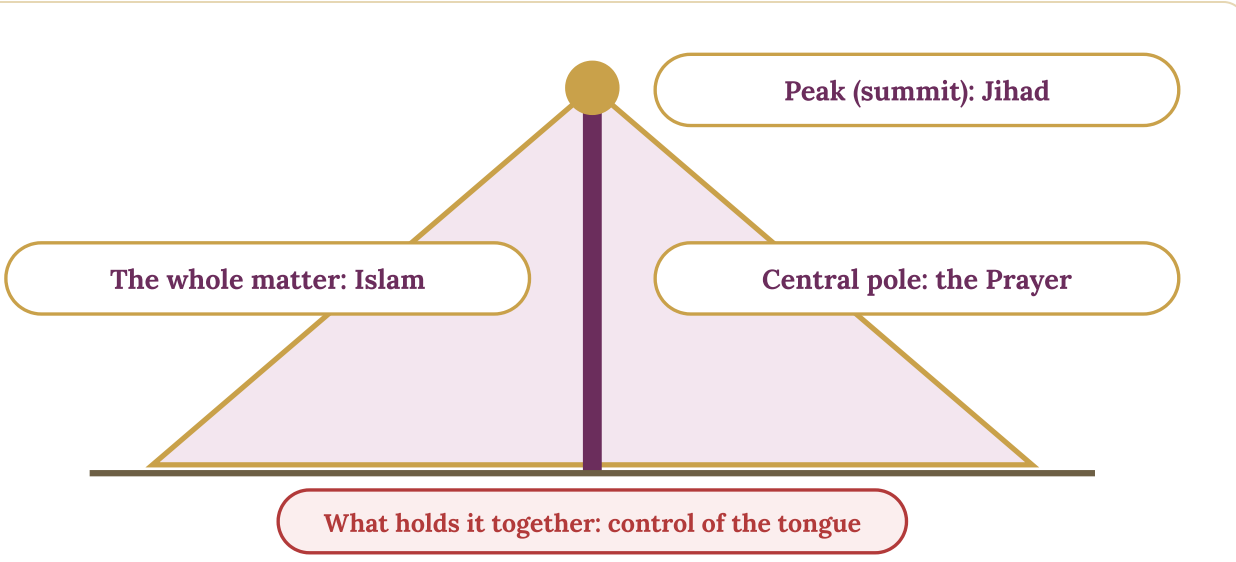
Then he described the religion as a whole: its **head** is Islam (the testimony), its **pillar** is the prayer, and its **peak** is jihad in the path of Allah, the highest effort to make Allah's word supreme, according to its rules and under legitimate leadership.

Finally, the **foundation of it all**: he took hold of his own tongue and said: "Restrain this." Muʿādh was surprised that we are held to account for speech. The Prophet ﷺ answered with a strong expression of surprise, then said that nothing throws people on their faces into the Fire more than the **harvest of their tongues**: lying, backbiting, slander, cursing and false oaths.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 29.

Picture

see and remember



The religion pictured as a tent: Islam is the whole, prayer the central pole, jihad the peak — and guarding the tongue holds it all together.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. The path to Paradise is clear: tawḥīd and the pillars.
2. Good is easy for whom Allah makes it easy, so ask Him.
3. Fasting, charity and night prayer are doors of good.
4. Prayer is the central pillar of the religion.
5. The tongue can destroy all of a person's good deeds.
6. We will be held accountable for every word.
7. Asking about the Hereafter shows the Companions' priorities.

Step by Step

Guarding the tongue

1. **Think first**
   Is it true, good and needed? (Hadith 15)

2. **Avoid the big sins of the tongue**
   Lying, backbiting, slander, cursing, mocking.

3. **Fill it with good**
   Dhikr, Qur'an, advice, kind words.

4. **Repair**
   If you backbit someone, praise them where you spoke ill and ask Allah to forgive them.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **What did Muʿādh ask the Prophet ﷺ?**

Q2 **List the 'doors of good' mentioned in the hadith.**

Q3 **What are the head, pillar and peak of the matter?**

Q4 **Why did the Prophet ﷺ take hold of his tongue?**

Q5 **What are the 'harvests of the tongues'?**

Q6 **Which sin of the tongue do you most need to stop? How?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the last part from «أَلَا أُخْبِرُكَ بِمِلَاكِ ذَلِكَ كُلِّهِ؟».	☐
Sun	Pray two rakʿahs in the last part of the night once this week.	☐
Mon	Fast one voluntary day.	☐
Tue	Give a charity to wipe out a sin.	☐
Wed	Go one full day without backbiting or complaining.	☐
Thu	Read as-Sajdah 32:16-17 with its meaning.	☐
Fri	Say «سُبْحَانَ اللَّهِ وَبِحَمْدِهِ» 100 times instead of idle talk.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 30 OF 50

30

Obligations, Limits and Things Left Unmentioned

الحَدِيثُ الثَّلَاثُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/30

Four kinds of rulings — and the mercy of Allah's silence.

عَنْ أَبِي ثَعْلَبَةَ الخُشَنِيِّ جُرْثُومِ بْنِ نَاشِرٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ عَنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ: «إِنَّ اللَّهَ تَعَالَى فَرَضَ فَرَائِضَ فَلَا تُضَيِّعُوهَا، وَحَدَّ حُدُودًا فَلَا تَعْتَدُوهَا، وَحَرَّمَ أَشْيَاءَ فَلَا تَنْتَهِكُوهَا، وَسَكَتَ عَنْ أَشْيَاءَ رَحْمَةً لَكُمْ غَيْرَ نِسْيَانٍ فَلَا تَبْحَثُوا عَنْهَا».

حَدِيثٌ حَسَنٌ، رَوَاهُ الدَّارَقُطْنِيُّ وَغَيْرُهُ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Tha'labah al-Kushanee — Jurthoom bin Nashir (may Allah be pleased with him) — that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: **Verily Allah ta'ala has laid down religious obligations (fara'id), so do not neglect them; and He has set limits, so do not overstep them; and He has forbidden some things, so do not violate them; and He has remained silent about some things, out of compassion for you, not forgetfulness — so do not seek after them.**

A hasan hadeeth narrated by ad-Daraqutnee and others · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 30 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:30*

About the Narrator

Abū Thaʿlabah al-Khushanī d. 75 AH

أَبُو ثَعْلَبَةَ الخُشَنِيُّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Jurthūm ibn Nāshir gave the Pledge of Riḍwān under the tree and was sent by the Prophet ﷺ to call his own people to Islam, who accepted. He settled in Shām. He used to pray that he would not suffer at death, and he died in sujūd while praying at night in 75 AH.

Explanatory Note

This short hadith divides the rulings of the religion into four. **Obligations** (*farā'iḍ*), like prayer, zakah, fasting and Hajj, which must not be neglected. **Limits** (*ḥudūd*), the boundaries Allah set between halal and haram, which must not be overstepped. **Prohibitions**, which must not be violated. And things **Allah was silent about** as a mercy, not out of forgetfulness, which we should not dig into.

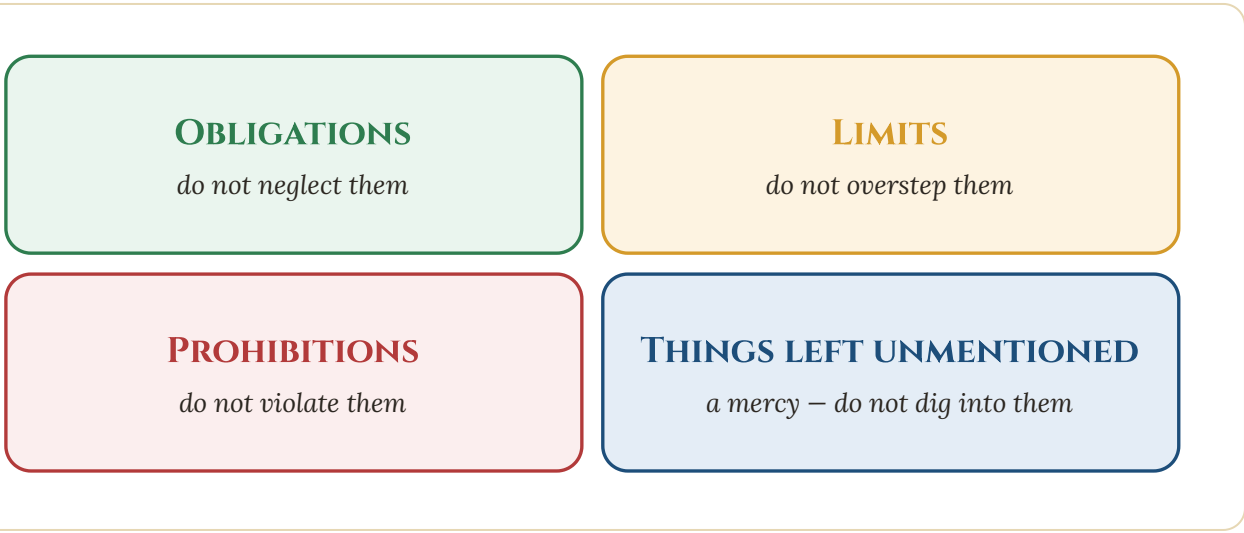
The last part shows that **the default ruling for things is permissibility**: food, drink, clothing, inventions and dealings are halal unless there is a text forbidding them. Allah did not forget anything (Maryam 19:64)[1]; He left these out to make life easy for us. So we should not make things difficult by asking questions that may lead to new obligations, or by forbidding what Allah did not forbid (see Hadith 9).

However, in acts of **worship** the default is the opposite: nothing is an act of worship unless there is evidence for it (Hadith 5). Knowing these two principles protects a Muslim from both extremes: making the halal haram, and inventing new worship.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 30.

Picture

see and remember



Four kinds of matters, four instructions.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Obligations must be done, not neglected.
2. Allah's limits must be respected and not overstepped.
3. Prohibitions must be avoided.
4. What Allah was silent about is a mercy; the default in worldly matters is permission.
5. Allah does not forget.

6 Do not make the religion harder by forbidding what Allah has not forbidden.

7 In worship, the default is that nothing is allowed without evidence.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **Name the four kinds of matters in this hadith and the instruction for each.**

Q2 **What is the difference between 'limits' and 'prohibitions'?**

Q3 **Why did Allah remain silent about some matters?**

Q4 **What is the default ruling for food, clothing and inventions?**

Q5 **How is the default ruling for worship different?**

Q6 **Give an example of someone making something difficult that Allah made easy.**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Draw the four boxes and fill each with two examples.	☐
Mon	Do every obligation of the day completely.	☐
Tue	Avoid one thing that is close to a limit you should not cross.	☐
Wed	Enjoy a halal blessing and thank Allah for His mercy.	☐
Thu	Do not say 'haram' about anything without knowledge.	☐
Fri	Ask a teacher one question about a ruling you are unsure of.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

PART THREE · HADITH 21–30

Review Test

اخْتِبَارُ المُرَاجَعَة

Take this test online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/test3

Name: ..... Date: ..... Score: ..... / 50

Answer from memory first, then check your answers with the chapters. The answer key is at the back of the book.

A Multiple Choice

Circle the correct answer · 25 marks

1. **What did the Prophet ﷺ tell Sufyān ath-Thaqafī to say?**
   - (A) I believe in Allah, then be steadfast
   - (B) I seek forgiveness
   - (C) Allah is the Greatest
   - (D) Glory be to Allah

2. **Istiqāmah means…**
   - (A) travelling
   - (B) leaving the world
   - (C) fasting every day
   - (D) steadfastness on the straight path

3. **Those who say ‘Our Lord is Allah’ and remain steadfast receive what from the angels (Fuṣṣilat 41:30)?**
   - (A) Fame
   - (B) Good news: do not fear and do not grieve
   - (C) A long life
   - (D) Wealth

4. **In Hadith 22, the man asked whether he would enter Paradise if he…**
   - (A) fasted every day
   - (B) travelled for Hajj every year
   - (C) did the obligations and avoided the haram
   - (D) gave all his wealth

5. **What did the Prophet ﷺ answer the man in Hadith 22?**
   - (A) No
   - (B) Yes
   - (C) Allah knows best
   - (D) Only if he does more

6. **“Purity is…”**
   - (A) a quarter of faith
   - (B) all of faith
   - (C) not related to faith
   - (D) half of faith

7. **Which words fill the scale (al-mīzān)?**
   - (A) Allāhu akbar
   - (B) Subḥān Allāh
   - (C) Al-ḥamdu lillāh
   - (D) Astaghfirullāh

8. **“Prayer is…”**
   - (A) light
   - (B) a proof
   - (C) radiance
   - (D) a shield

9. **“Charity is…”**
   - (A) a proof
   - (B) light
   - (C) half of faith
   - (D) radiance

10. **"Patience is..."**

(A) a proof
(B) radiance (ḍiyāʾ)
(C) light
(D) half of faith

11. **The Qur'an is...**

(A) only for scholars
(B) only for Ramadan
(C) a proof for you or against you
(D) only for the dead

12. **Hadith 24 is a ḥadīth qudsī, meaning...**

(A) the Prophet ﷺ relates it from his Lord
(B) a saying of a Companion
(C) a verse of the Qur'an
(D) a weak hadith

13. **What has Allah forbidden for Himself in Hadith 24?**

(A) Oppression
(B) Knowledge
(C) Mercy
(D) Forgiveness

14. **If all creation asked Allah and were given, His treasures would decrease only like...**

(A) a cup from a river
(B) a stone from a mountain
(C) a needle dipped in the ocean
(D) a leaf from a tree

15. **In Hadith 25, the poor Companions were sad about missing...**

(A) food
(B) clothes
(C) money
(D) the rewards of charity

16. **Which of these is called charity in Hadith 25?**

(A) Every tasbīḥ
(B) Sleeping
(C) Buying clothes
(D) Watching people

17. **How many joints does a person have, according to a narration in Muslim?**

(A) 206
(B) 100
(C) 360
(D) 33

18. **Which prayer is enough for the charity due on all the joints?**

(A) Witr
(B) Tahajjud
(C) Ẓuhr
(D) Two rakʿahs of Ḍuḥā

19. **Which of these is mentioned as a charity in Hadith 26?**

(A) Wearing perfume
(B) Removing harm from the road
(C) Buying a car
(D) Sleeping early

20. **"Righteousness is..."**

(A) fasting
(B) knowledge
(C) wealth
(D) good character

21. **Sin is that which wavers in your chest and...**

(A) you dislike people seeing
(B) you share proudly
(C) you write down
(D) you forget

22. **In Hadith 28, the Companions felt the sermon was...**

(A) a war speech
(B) a Friday khutbah
(C) a wedding speech
(D) a farewell sermon

23. **'Bite onto it with your molar teeth' means...**

(A) stay silent
(B) eat slowly
(C) hold on as firmly as possible
(D) be angry

24. **In Hadith 29, the 'pillar' (ʿamūd) of the religion is…**

(A) fasting
(B) the prayer
(C) Hajj
(D) jihad

25. **What did the Prophet ﷺ hold when he said 'Restrain this'?**

(A) His hand
(B) His tongue
(C) His sword
(D) His beard

B MATCHING

Write the letter of the English meaning next to each Arabic phrase · 10 marks

1	قُلْ: آمَنْتُ بِاللَّهِ، ثُمَّ اسْتَقِمْ		A	In every tasbīḥ there is a charity.
2	أَأَدْخُلُ الجَنَّةَ؟ قَالَ: نَعَمْ		B	So hold to my Sunnah.
3	الطُّهُورُ شَطْرُ الإِيمَانِ		C	Restrain this (your tongue).
4	يَا عِبَادِي، إِنِّي حَرَّمْتُ الظُّلْمَ عَلَى نَفْسِي		D	Say: I believe in Allah, then be steadfast.
5	إِنَّ بِكُلِّ تَسْبِيحَةٍ صَدَقَةً		E	And a good word is a charity.
6	وَالكَلِمَةُ الطَّيِّبَةُ صَدَقَةٌ		F	And He was silent about some things out of mercy for you.
7	البِرُّ حُسْنُ الخُلُقِ		G	"Will I enter Paradise?" He said: "Yes."
8	فَعَلَيْكُمْ بِسُنَّتِي		H	O My servants, I have forbidden oppression for Myself.
9	كُفَّ عَلَيْكَ هَذَا		I	Purity is half of faith.
10	وَسَكَتَ عَنْ أَشْيَاءَ رَحْمَةً لَكُمْ		J	Righteousness is good character.

C SHORT ANSWER

Answer in one or two sentences · 10 marks

1. **How did ʿUmar explain istiqāmah?**

2. Why might zakah and Hajj not be mentioned in Hadith 22?

3. Match each deed to its description in Hadith 23: prayer, charity, patience.

4. Name the four things Hadith 24 says we need to ask Allah for.

5. Why were the Companions surprised by the last charity in Hadith 25, and how was it explained?

6. Give four charities from Hadith 26.

7. What should you do in an unclear matter when your heart feels uneasy (Hadith 27)?

8. List the four commands of the Prophet ﷺ in Hadith 28.

9. Name the three ‘doors of good’ in Hadith 29.

10. What are the four kinds of matters in Hadith 30?

D Critical Thinking

Explain your thinking with evidence from the hadith · 5 marks

1. Hadith 22 shows that doing only the obligations leads to Paradise. Why, then, do Muslims still do voluntary deeds? Give at least three reasons.

2. 'Every person goes out in the morning selling himself.' Describe a normal school or work day and show where a person 'frees' or 'ruins' his soul.

3. Hadith 24 says obeying Allah adds nothing to His kingdom. If Allah does not need our worship, why do we worship Him? Explain using the hadith.

4. The tongue can destroy a person's good deeds (Hadith 29). Choose three sins of the tongue that are common today and suggest a practical cure for each.

5. Hadith 30 says Allah left some things unmentioned as a mercy. How does this protect Muslims from two extremes: making the halal haram, and inventing new worship?



PART FOUR

Brotherhood and Justice

Hadith 31 – 40

31 Renounce the World and Allah Will Love You

32 No Harm and No Reciprocating Harm

33 The Burden of Proof Is on the Claimant

34 Changing an Evil

35 Be Brothers, O Servants of Allah

36 Relieving a Believer's Distress

37 Allah Records Good and Bad Deeds

38 Drawing Near to Allah: The Friends of Allah

39 Mistakes, Forgetfulness and Coercion Are Pardoned

40 Be in This World as a Stranger

HADITH 31 OF 50

31

Renounce the World and Allah Will Love You

الحَدِيثُ الحَادِي وَالثَّلَاثُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/31

The secret of being loved by Allah and by people.

عَنْ أَبِي العَبَّاسِ سَهْلِ بْنِ سَعْدٍ السَّاعِدِيِّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: جَاءَ رَجُلٌ إِلَى النَّبِيِّ ﷺ فَقَالَ: يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ، دُلَّنِي عَلَى عَمَلٍ إِذَا عَمِلْتُهُ أَحَبَّنِيَ اللَّهُ وَأَحَبَّنِيَ النَّاسُ. فَقَالَ: «**ازْهَدْ فِي الدُّنْيَا يُحِبَّكَ اللَّهُ، وَازْهَدْ فِيمَا عِنْدَ النَّاسِ يُحِبَّكَ النَّاسُ**».

حَدِيثٌ حَسَنٌ، رَوَاهُ ابْنُ مَاجَهْ وَغَيْرُهُ بِأَسَانِيدَ حَسَنَةٍ.

English Translation | sunnah.com

On the authority of Abu al-'Abbas Sahl bin Sa'ad as-Sa'idee (may Allah be pleased with him) who said: A man came to the Prophet ﷺ and said, "O Messenger of Allah, direct me to an act which, if I do it, [will cause] Allah to love me and the people to love me." So he ﷺ said, "**Renounce the world and Allah will love you, and renounce what the people possess and the people will love you.**"

A hasan hadeeth related by Ibn Majah and others with good chains of authorities · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 31 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:31*

About the Narrator

Sahl ibn Saʿd as-Sāʿidī (d. 91 AH)

سَهْلُ بْنُ سَعْدٍ السَّاعِدِيُّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

An Anṣārī who was fifteen when the Prophet ﷺ died. He narrated many hadith, including that Paradise has a gate called ar-Rayyān for those who fast. He lived long and is said to be the last Companion to die in Madinah, in 91 AH, at about a hundred years old.

Explanatory Note

A man asked for a deed that would make Allah and people love him. The answer: **zuhd** in the world brings Allah's love, and **zuhd** in what people have brings people's love. *Zuhd* does not mean leaving

all wealth or living in poverty. Ibn Taymiyyah defined it[1] as **leaving what does not benefit you in the Hereafter**. The Prophet ﷺ and many Companions had wealth, but it was in their hands, not in their hearts.

Zuhd in the world means the heart is not attached to it: you use it to obey Allah, you are not sad over what you lose or overjoyed with what you gain (al-Ḥadīd 57:23)[2], and you prefer the Hereafter. Allah loves such a person because he loves what Allah loves.

Zuhd in what people have means not desiring their wealth, not begging and not envying. People love the one who does not compete with them for their worldly things and who asks only from Allah. The hadith is graded ḥasan by an-Nawawī, though some scholars discussed its chain; its meaning is supported by many other texts.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 31.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Zuhd means leaving what does not benefit you in the Hereafter, not leaving all wealth.
2. Detachment from the world earns the love of Allah.
3. Not desiring people's possessions earns their love.
4. Seeking Allah's love is the highest goal; people's love follows.
5. A rich person can be a zāhid, and a poor person can be greedy.
6. Asking only from Allah preserves dignity.

Step by Step

Practising zuhd in daily life

1. **Check your heart**
   Do I feel pain when I lose something worldly? Train contentment.

2. **Use, don't worship**
   Use your phone, money and clothes for good; let them serve you.

3. **Simplify**
   Remove one unnecessary thing from your spending.

4. **Do not look at others' things**
   Avoid comparing; say 'mā shā' Allāh'.

5. **Invest in the Hereafter**
   Spend some of what you love for Allah.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 What did the man ask for?

Q2 Define zuhd in your own words using Ibn Taymiyyah's definition.

Q3 Does zuhd mean being poor? Explain with an example.

Q4 Why do people love someone who does not desire what they have?

Q5 How does zuhd in the world bring Allah's love?

Q6 What worldly thing is your heart most attached to? How can you loosen that attachment?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Give away one thing you do not need.	☐
Mon	Do not ask anyone for anything today except Allah.	☐
Tue	Avoid buying one unnecessary thing this week.	☐
Wed	When you see something nice with someone, say «مَا شَاءَ اللَّهُ، بَارَكَ اللَّهُ».	☐
Thu	Read al-Ḥadīd 57:20-23 and reflect.	☐
Fri	Spend some time today on something only for the Hereafter.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 32 OF 50

32

No Harm and No Reciprocating Harm

الحَدِيثُ الثَّانِي وَالثَّلَاثُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/32

A golden rule of Islamic law: harm must be removed.

عَنْ أَبِي سَعِيدٍ سَعْدِ بْنِ مَالِكِ بْنِ سِنَانٍ الخُدْرِيِّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ:

«لَا ضَرَرَ وَلَا ضِرَارَ».

حَدِيثٌ حَسَنٌ، رَوَاهُ ابْنُ مَاجَهْ وَالدَّارَقُطْنِيُّ وَغَيْرُهُمَا مُسْنَدًا، وَرَوَاهُ مَالِكٌ فِي «المُوَطَّأِ» عَنْ عَمْرِو بْنِ يَحْيَى عَنْ أَبِيهِ عَنِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ مُرْسَلًا فَأَسْقَطَ أَبَا سَعِيدٍ، وَلَهُ طُرُقٌ يَقْوِّي بَعْضُهَا بَعْضًا.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Sa'eed al-Khudree (may Allah be pleased with him), that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: **There should be neither harming (darar) nor reciprocating harm (dirar).**

A hasan hadeeth related by Ibn Majah, ad-Daraqutnee and others as a musnad hadeeth. It was also related by Malik in al-Muwatta in mursal form from Amr bin Yahya, from his father from the Prophet ﷺ, but leaving Abu Sa'eed from the chain. And it has other chains of narrations that strengthen one another · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 32 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:32*

About the Narrator

Abū Saʿīd al-Khudrī d. 74 AH

أَبُو سَعِيدٍ الخُدْرِيُّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Saʿd ibn Mālik ibn Sinān al-Anṣārī tried to join Uḥud at thirteen but was sent home for being too young; his father was martyred there. He then joined twelve expeditions. He became one of the jurists among the young Companions and narrated over a thousand hadith. He was known for speaking the truth to rulers, as when he objected to Marwān's change of the Eid sermon. He died in Madinah in 74 AH.

Explanatory Note

This two-word hadith became one of the five great rules of Islamic law: **'Harm is to be removed.'** *Ḍarar* is to harm someone at all; *ḍirār* is to harm someone in return for harm, more than what is

just, or to harm others while benefiting yourself. Both are forbidden.

Many rulings are built on it: a neighbour may not build something that seriously harms his neighbour; a seller may not hide defects; a husband may not keep his wife only to harm her (al-Baqarah 2:231)[1]; a person may not make a will to harm his heirs (an-Nisā' 4:12)[2]. Rights that are used to cause harm are restricted. A person may defend himself and take back his right, but without going beyond it.

It also protects our own bodies: a person may not harm himself with drugs, smoking or dangerous behaviour. And it includes harm in words and online: spreading rumours, posting hurtful comments or embarrassing photos. The chain of this hadith has weakness, but its many routes support one another, and the rule is agreed upon by the scholars.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 32.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Harming others is forbidden in Islam.
2. Responding to harm with greater harm is also forbidden.
3. Harm must be removed as far as possible.
4. A right may not be used to cause harm to others.
5. A person may not harm his own body.
6. Many rules of Islamic law are built on this hadith.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **What is the difference between ḍarar and ḍirār?**

Q2 **Which great legal rule is taken from this hadith?**

Q3 **Give three examples of rulings based on this hadith.**

Q4 **Is it allowed to harm yourself? Give examples.**

Q5 How can people cause harm online?

Q6 Think of something you do that may harm others. How will you change it?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith — only four words!	☐
Sun	Check that nothing you do bothers your neighbours (noise, parking, rubbish).	☐
Mon	Delete any post or message that could hurt someone.	☐
Tue	Avoid harming your body: sleep enough, eat well, avoid harmful habits.	☐
Wed	When someone wrongs you, respond fairly or forgive — never more.	☐
Thu	Remove something that could harm people at home or outside.	☐
Fri	Make du'a for anyone you may have harmed.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: Teacher / parent:

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 33 OF 50

33

The Burden of Proof Is on the Claimant

الحَدِيثُ الثَّالِثُ وَالثَّلَاثُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/33

A basic rule of justice in every court.

عَنِ ابْنِ عَبَّاسٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ: «لَوْ يُعْطَى النَّاسُ بِدَعْوَاهُمْ لَادَّعَى رِجَالٌ أَمْوَالَ قَوْمٍ وَدِمَاءَهُمْ، لَكِنِ الْبَيِّنَةُ عَلَى الْمُدَّعِي، وَالْيَمِينُ عَلَى مَنْ أَنْكَرَ».

حَدِيثٌ حَسَنٌ، رَوَاهُ الْبَيْهَقِيُّ وَغَيْرُهُ هَكَذَا، وَبَعْضُهُ فِي «الصَّحِيحَيْنِ».

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Ibn Abbas (may Allah be pleased with him), that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: **Were people to be given everything that they claimed, men would [unjustly] claim the wealth and lives of [other] people. But, the onus of proof is upon the claimant, and the taking of an oath is upon him who denies.**

A hasan hadeeth narrated by al-Baihaqee and others in this form, and part of it is in the two Saheehs · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 33 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:33*

About the Narrator

ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿAbbās (d. 68 AH)

عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ عَبَّاسٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا

Biography: see Hadith 19.

Background of the Hadith

سَبَبُ الوُرُود

A real case before the Prophet ﷺ. Al-Ashʿath ibn Qays said: "There was a dispute between me and a man over a piece of land (in another narration: a well), so we took it to the Prophet ﷺ. He said: 'Your two witnesses, or his oath.' I said: 'Then he will swear and not care!' The Prophet ﷺ said: 'Whoever swears an oath to take the wealth of a Muslim, while he is lying, will meet Allah while He is angry with him.'" Then Allah revealed: "Those who sell the covenant of Allah and their oaths for a small price..." (Āl ʿImrān 3:77).[1]

This is the part of the hadith that an-Nawawī meant when he said "part of it is in the two Ṣaḥīḥs": the claimant brings proof, and the one who denies takes an oath.

Explanatory Note

This hadith is a foundation of the Islamic justice system. If people were given whatever they claimed just by claiming it, some would claim other people's wealth and even their lives. So the Prophet ﷺ set a rule: **the one who makes a claim must bring proof** (*bayyinah*: witnesses or clear evidence), and **the one who denies must take an oath**.

The claimant is the one whose claim goes against the normal state of things, so he needs proof. The defendant keeps what is in his hands unless proof is brought; if there is no proof, he swears an oath and the case is closed. Allah will judge the liar on the Day of Judgement, and a false oath to take someone's property is a major sin which the Prophet ﷺ warned leads to the Fire[2].

Outside the courtroom too, the hadith teaches us not to accept accusations without proof, not to believe rumours, and to treat people as innocent until there is clear evidence. A Muslim also should not make claims he cannot prove, and should fear Allah before swearing any oath.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 33.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Claims are not accepted without proof.
2. The claimant must bring evidence; the denier takes an oath.
3. This rule protects people's wealth, lives and honour.
4. Everyone is innocent until proven otherwise.
5. A false oath to take someone's right is a major sin.
6. Do not accuse anyone or believe rumours without evidence.

Step by Step

Settling a dispute fairly

1. **Hear both sides**
   Do not judge after hearing only one person.

2. **Ask the claimant for proof**
   Witnesses or clear evidence.

3. **If no proof**
   The one who denies swears an oath.

4 **Judge justly**
Even against relatives or friends (an-Nisā' 4:135).

5 **Encourage reconciliation**
Making peace is better (an-Nisā' 4:128).

QUESTIONS

think, then write

Q1 What would happen if people were given whatever they claimed?

Q2 Who must bring proof? Who must take the oath?

Q3 What counts as 'proof'?

Q4 What is the sin of a false oath?

Q5 How can we apply this hadith in daily life, outside courts?

Q6 Why is it important to hear both sides of a story?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Do not believe or share any rumour without checking it.	☐
Mon	When two friends argue, listen to both sides before judging.	☐
Tue	Avoid swearing by Allah except when necessary and truthful.	☐
Wed	Read an-Nisā' 4:135 about justice.	☐
Thu	Apologise if you accused someone unfairly.	☐
Fri	Keep receipts or written records for any money you lend or borrow (al-Baqarah 2:282).	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

34

HADITH 34 OF 50

Changing an Evil

الحَدِيثُ الرَّابِعُ وَالثَّلَاثُونَ

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/40hadith/34

Hand, tongue or heart — every believer has a role.

عَنْ أَبِي سَعِيدٍ الخُدْرِيِّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَقُولُ: «مَنْ رَأَى مِنْكُمْ مُنْكَرًا فَلْيُغَيِّرْهُ بِيَدِهِ، فَإِنْ لَمْ يَسْتَطِعْ فَبِلِسَانِهِ، فَإِنْ لَمْ يَسْتَطِعْ فَبِقَلْبِهِ، وَذَلِكَ أَضْعَفُ الإِيمَانِ».

رَوَاهُ مُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Sa`eed al-Khudree (may Allah be pleased with him) who said: I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say, "**Whosoever of you sees an evil, let him change it with his hand; and if he is not able to do so, then [let him change it] with his tongue; and if he is not able to do so, then with his heart — and that is the weakest of faith.**"

[Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 34 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:34*

About the Narrator

Abū Saʿīd al-Khudrī d. 74 AH

أَبُو سَعِيدٍ الخُدْرِيُّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Biography: see Hadith 32.

Background of the Hadith

سَبَبُ الوُرُود

When Abū Saʿīd narrated it. Ṭāriq ibn Shihāb said: the first person to give the khuṭbah before the prayer on the day of Eid was Marwān (then governor of Madinah). A man stood up and said: "The prayer comes before the khuṭbah!" Marwān said: "That has been left." Abū Saʿīd al-Khudrī said: "As for this man, he has done what was due upon him. I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say: 'Whoever of you sees an evil, let him change it with his hand…'"[1]

> The man changed the evil with his tongue — with a short, clear reminder in public, because the change itself was public — and Abū Saʿīd supported him with the hadith.

Explanatory Note

Enjoining good and forbidding evil is a duty that protects the community. This hadith gives three levels according to ability. **With the hand**: for those who have authority over the matter, such as parents at home, a teacher in class, or the ruler and his officials. **With the tongue**: with wise and gentle words, advice or a reminder. **With the heart**: hating the evil and leaving the place where it happens — this is the minimum, and it is 'the weakest of faith'.

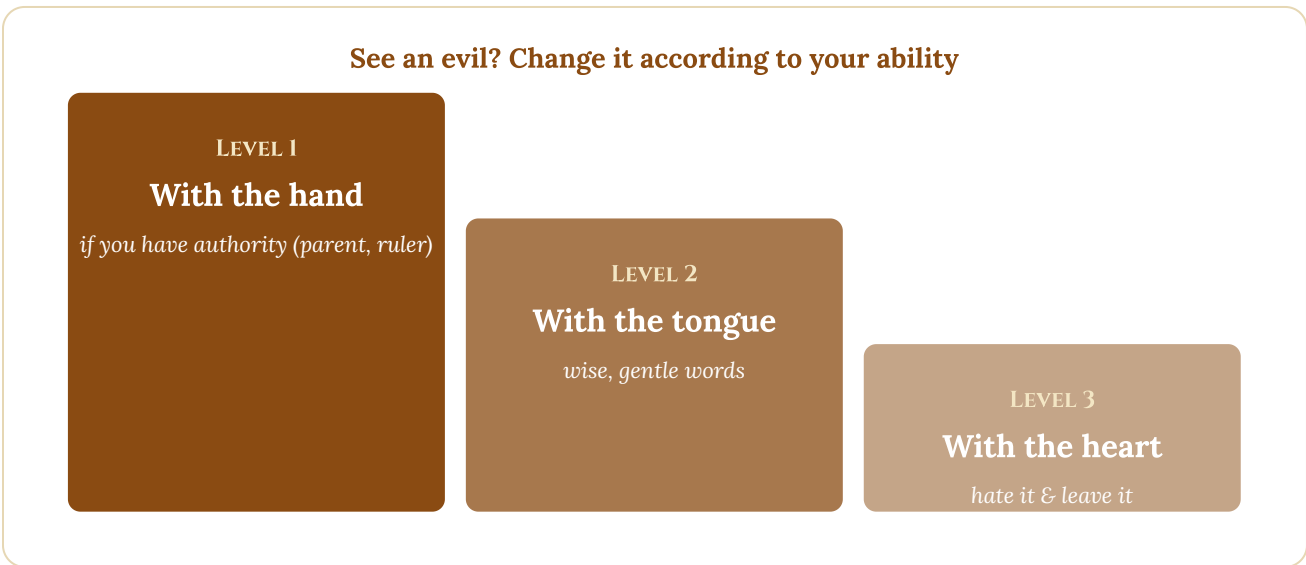
Changing evil has conditions: having knowledge that it is truly an evil, gentleness, and making sure that changing it does not cause a greater evil. Ordinary people may not use force against others in matters that belong to the authorities, as this leads to chaos. The Prophet ﷺ said: "Gentleness is not in anything except that it beautifies it."[2]

Whoever does not even hate the evil in his heart is in serious danger, for this is the last level of faith. The hadith also shows that faith increases and decreases, and that actions are part of faith.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 34.

Picture

see and remember



Three levels of changing an evil, according to one's ability.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Forbidding evil is a duty for every Muslim according to ability.
2. There are three levels: hand, tongue and heart.
3. Using the hand is for those with authority; it must not cause greater harm.

4 Advice should be gentle, wise and based on knowledge.

5 Hating evil in the heart is the minimum duty.

6 Faith increases and decreases; actions are part of faith.

Step by Step

Before you change an evil

1 **Be sure**
Is it clearly forbidden, by agreement of scholars?

2 **Check your ability and role**
Am I in authority here? Can I speak?

3 **Weigh the outcome**
Will changing it cause a greater harm?

4 **Be gentle**
Use kind words, in private if possible.

5 **At least hate it**
If you can do nothing, hate it and leave the place.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **What are the three levels of changing an evil?**

Q2 **Who may change an evil with the hand?**

Q3 **What conditions should be met before changing an evil?**

Q4 **Why is hating evil in the heart called 'the weakest of faith'?**

Q5 **Give an example of changing an evil with the tongue in a wise way.**

Q6 **Describe an evil you see often. What is the right level for you to act?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Turn off or leave something haram you see at home, if you have that authority.	☐
Mon	Gently advise a friend about one mistake.	☐
Tue	Leave a gathering where something wrong is happening.	☐
Wed	Encourage one good deed among your friends.	☐
Thu	Learn the difference between agreed-upon evils and matters of scholarly difference.	☐
Fri	Make du'a for those who are falling into sins to be guided.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 35 OF 50

35

Be Brothers, O Servants of Allah

الحَدِيثُ الخَامِسُ وَالثَّلَاثُونَ

Listen & study online
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/40hadith/35

Five 'do not's and the rights of Muslim brotherhood.

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «لَا تَحَاسَدُوا، وَلَا تَنَاجَشُوا، وَلَا تَبَاغَضُوا، وَلَا تَدَابَرُوا، وَلَا يَبِعْ بَعْضُكُمْ عَلَى بَيْعِ بَعْضٍ، وَكُونُوا عِبَادَ اللَّهِ إِخْوَانًا، الْمُسْلِمُ أَخُو الْمُسْلِمِ، لَا يَظْلِمُهُ، وَلَا يَخْذُلُهُ، وَلَا يَكْذِبُهُ، وَلَا يَحْقِرُهُ، التَّقْوَى هَاهُنَا - وَيُشِيرُ إِلَى صَدْرِهِ ثَلَاثَ مَرَّاتٍ - بِحَسْبِ امْرِئٍ مِنَ الشَّرِّ أَنْ يَحْقِرَ أَخَاهُ الْمُسْلِمَ، كُلُّ الْمُسْلِمِ عَلَى الْمُسْلِمِ حَرَامٌ: دَمُهُ وَمَالُهُ وَعِرْضُهُ».

رَوَاهُ مُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Hurayrah (may Allah be pleased with him) who said: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "**Do not envy one another, and do not inflate prices for one another, and do not hate one another, and do not turn away from one another, and do not undercut one another in trade, but [rather] be slaves of Allah and brothers [amongst yourselves]. A Muslim is the brother of a Muslim: he does not oppress him, nor does he fail him, nor does he lie to him, nor does he hold him in contempt. Taqwa (piety) is right here** [and he pointed to his chest three times]. **It is evil enough for a man to hold his brother Muslim in contempt. The whole of a Muslim is inviolable for another Muslim: his blood, his property, and his honour.**"

[Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 35 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:35*

About the Narrator

Abū Hurayrah d. 57 AH — أَبُو هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Biography: see Hadith 9.

Explanatory Note

This hadith lists diseases that break brotherhood. **Do not envy**: wishing that a blessing be taken from someone. **Do not inflate prices** (*najash*): bidding up a price with no intention to buy, to cheat the buyer. **Do not hate one another** for worldly reasons. **Do not turn your backs** on one another by cutting off. **Do not undercut** another's sale by offering a buyer a better deal after he has agreed with someone else.

Instead, **be servants of Allah, brothers**. A Muslim is the brother of a Muslim: he does not oppress him, abandon him when he needs help, lie to him, or look down on him. **Taqwā is here**, and the Prophet ﷺ pointed to his chest three times. Taqwā is in the heart, so do not judge people by their appearance or wealth; the one you despise may be better than you before Allah.

It is enough evil for a person to despise his Muslim brother. The hadith ends with a great rule: **everything of a Muslim is sacred to another Muslim: his blood, his wealth and his honour.** This was also declared by the Prophet ﷺ in his farewell sermon[1].

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 35.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Envy, hatred and cutting off destroy brotherhood.
2. Cheating in trade, like najash and undercutting, is forbidden.
3. Muslims are brothers and must help, not abandon, one another.
4. Taqwā is in the heart; do not judge people by looks.
5. Despising a Muslim is a great evil.
6. The blood, wealth and honour of a Muslim are sacred.

Step by Step

Treating envy when you feel it

1 Recognise
Envy is a disease of the heart; do not act on it.

2 Make du'a for them
Ask Allah to bless them more.

3 **Say**
«مَا شَاءَ اللَّهُ، لَا قُوَّةَ إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ».

4 **Do good to them**
A gift or kind word removes bad feelings.

5 **Ask Allah from His bounty**
"Ask Allah of His bounty" (an-Nisā' 4:32).

QUESTIONS

think, then write

Q1 List the five 'do not's in this hadith and explain each one.

Q2 What is najash?

Q3 What four things must a Muslim never do to his brother?

Q4 Where did the Prophet ﷺ point when he said 'taqwā is here'? What does it teach?

Q5 What three things of a Muslim are sacred?

Q6 Is there someone you have cut off? What will you do this week?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise from «وَكُونُوا عِبَادَ اللَّهِ إِخْوَانًا» to «وَلَا يَحْقِرُهُ».	☐
Sun	Make du'a for someone you feel envious of.	☐
Mon	Contact someone you have not spoken to for a long time.	☐
Tue	Help a Muslim who needs it; do not leave him alone.	☐
Wed	Avoid mocking anyone's appearance, accent or clothes.	☐
Thu	Do not speak about anyone's honour behind their back.	☐
Fri	Give a gift to someone to increase love.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

36

HADITH 36 OF 50

Relieving a Believer's Distress

الحَدِيثُ السَّادِسُ وَالثَّلَاثُونَ

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/40hadith/36

As you treat Allah's servants, Allah will treat you.

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ عَنِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ قَالَ: «مَنْ نَفَّسَ عَنْ مُؤْمِنٍ كُرْبَةً مِنْ كُرَبِ الدُّنْيَا نَفَّسَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ كُرْبَةً مِنْ كُرَبِ يَوْمِ القِيَامَةِ، وَمَنْ يَسَّرَ عَلَى مُعْسِرٍ يَسَّرَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالآخِرَةِ، وَمَنْ سَتَرَ مُسْلِمًا سَتَرَهُ اللَّهُ فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالآخِرَةِ، وَاللَّهُ فِي عَوْنِ العَبْدِ مَا كَانَ العَبْدُ فِي عَوْنِ أَخِيهِ، وَمَنْ سَلَكَ طَرِيقًا يَلْتَمِسُ فِيهِ عِلْمًا سَهَّلَ اللَّهُ لَهُ بِهِ طَرِيقًا إِلَى الجَنَّةِ، وَمَا اجْتَمَعَ قَوْمٌ فِي بَيْتٍ مِنْ بُيُوتِ اللَّهِ يَتْلُونَ كِتَابَ اللَّهِ وَيَتَدَارَسُونَهُ بَيْنَهُمْ إِلَّا نَزَلَتْ عَلَيْهِمُ السَّكِينَةُ، وَغَشِيَتْهُمُ الرَّحْمَةُ، وَحَفَّتْهُمُ المَلَائِكَةُ، وَذَكَرَهُمُ اللَّهُ فِيمَنْ عِنْدَهُ، وَمَنْ بَطَّأَ بِهِ عَمَلُهُ لَمْ يُسْرِعْ بِهِ نَسَبُهُ».

رَوَاهُ مُسْلِمٌ بِهَذَا اللَّفْظِ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Hurayrah (may Allah be pleased with him), that the Prophet ﷺ said: **Whoever removes a worldly grief from a believer, Allah will remove from him one of the griefs of the Day of Resurrection. And whoever alleviates the need of a needy person, Allah will alleviate his needs in this world and the Hereafter. Whoever shields [or hides the misdeeds of] a Muslim, Allah will shield him in this world and the Hereafter. And Allah will aid His slave so long as he aids his brother. And whoever follows a path to seek knowledge therein, Allah will make easy for him a path to Paradise.**

No people gather together in one of the Houses of Allah, reciting the Book of Allah and studying it among themselves, except that sakeenah (tranquility) descends upon them, and mercy envelops them, and the angels surround them, and Allah mentions them amongst those who are with Him. And whoever is slowed down by his actions, will not be hastened forward by his lineage.

Related by [Muslim] in these words · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 36 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:36*

About the Narrator

Abū Hurayrah d. 57 AH

أَبُو هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Biography: see Hadith 9.

Explanatory Note

This hadith teaches that **the reward is of the same kind as the deed**. Whoever relieves a believer from a worldly distress, Allah relieves him from a distress of the Day of Judgement. Whoever makes things easy for someone in difficulty — such as giving a debtor more time or forgiving part of the debt — Allah makes things easy for him in both worlds. Whoever covers a Muslim's fault, Allah covers him in both worlds. Covering means not exposing a private mistake; it does not mean hiding harm that must be stopped or a crime against others.

"Allah helps His servant as long as the servant helps his brother." Then the hadith turns to **knowledge**: whoever walks a path seeking knowledge, Allah makes easy for him a path to Paradise. And whenever people gather in a house of Allah to recite and study the Qur'an, four gifts come: **tranquillity descends, mercy covers them, angels surround them, and Allah mentions them among those with Him**.

It ends with a powerful warning: **whoever is slowed by his deeds will not be hurried forward by his lineage**. Family, tribe or famous ancestors will not help on the Day of Judgement; only deeds

count.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. The reward matches the deed.
2. Helping people in difficulty brings Allah's help.
3. Giving time to a debtor, or forgiving debts, is greatly rewarded.
4. Covering the private faults of Muslims brings Allah's covering.
5. Seeking knowledge is a path to Paradise.
6. Gatherings for the Qur'an bring tranquillity, mercy, angels and Allah's mention.
7. Lineage is worthless without good deeds.

Step by Step

Getting the most from a Qur'an study circle

1. **Make intention**
   For Allah, to learn and act.
2. **Come early and clean**
   With wudu, and sit with good manners.
3. **Recite and listen**
   Follow the recitation attentively.
4. **Study the meanings**
   Ask questions and take notes.
5. **Act and share**
   Apply one lesson and teach it to someone.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **What is the reward for relieving a believer's distress?**

Q2 **How can you 'make things easy' for someone in difficulty?**

Q3 What does ‘covering a Muslim’ mean, and what does it not mean?

Q4 What reward is there for seeking knowledge?

Q5 List the four gifts given to those who gather for the Qur’an.

Q6 What does ‘lineage will not hurry him forward’ teach us?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the first sentence, about relieving distress.	☐
Sun	Help someone in difficulty with money, time or effort.	☐
Mon	If someone owes you, give them more time or forgive part of it.	☐
Tue	Keep a friend’s private mistake secret.	☐
Wed	Walk to a class, circle or lecture to seek knowledge.	☐
Thu	Sit in a Qur’an circle or recite with your family together.	☐
Fri	Do one good deed without relying on who your family is.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 37 OF 50

37

Allah Records Good and Bad Deeds

الحَدِيثُ السَّابِعُ وَالثَّلَاثُونَ

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/40hadith/37

The generosity of Allah in how deeds are written.

عَنِ ابْنِ عَبَّاسٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا عَنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ فِيمَا يَرْوِيهِ عَنْ رَبِّهِ تَبَارَكَ وَتَعَالَى قَالَ: «إِنَّ اللَّهَ كَتَبَ الحَسَنَاتِ وَالسَّيِّئَاتِ ثُمَّ بَيَّنَ ذَلِكَ: فَمَنْ هَمَّ بِحَسَنَةٍ فَلَمْ يَعْمَلْهَا كَتَبَهَا اللَّهُ عِنْدَهُ حَسَنَةً كَامِلَةً، وَإِنْ هَمَّ بِهَا فَعَمِلَهَا كَتَبَهَا اللَّهُ عِنْدَهُ عَشْرَ حَسَنَاتٍ إِلَى سَبْعِمِائَةِ ضِعْفٍ إِلَى أَضْعَافٍ كَثِيرَةٍ، وَإِنْ هَمَّ بِسَيِّئَةٍ فَلَمْ يَعْمَلْهَا كَتَبَهَا اللَّهُ عِنْدَهُ حَسَنَةً كَامِلَةً، وَإِنْ هَمَّ بِهَا فَعَمِلَهَا كَتَبَهَا اللَّهُ سَيِّئَةً وَاحِدَةً».

رَوَاهُ البُخَارِيُّ وَمُسْلِمٌ فِي صَحِيحَيْهِمَا بِهَذِهِ الحُرُوفِ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Ibn Abbas (may Allah be pleased with him), from the Messenger of Allah ﷺ, from what he has related from his Lord: **Verily Allah ta'ala has written down the good deeds and the evil deeds, and then explained it [by saying]: "Whosoever intended to perform a good deed, but did not do it, then Allah writes it down with Himself as a complete good deed. And if he intended to perform it and then did perform it, then Allah writes it down with Himself as from ten good deeds up to seven hundred times, up to many times multiplied. And if he intended to perform an evil deed, but did not do it, then Allah writes it down with Himself as a complete good deed. And if he intended it [i.e., the evil deed] and then performed it, then Allah writes it down as one evil deed."**

[Al-Bukhari] [Muslim] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 37 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:37*

About the Narrator

ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿAbbās d. 68 AH — عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ عَبَّاسٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا

Biography: see Hadith 19.

Explanatory Note

This *ḥadīth qudsī* shows the great generosity of Allah. **If you intend a good deed and do not do it**, it is written as one complete good deed. **If you intend it and do it**, it is written as ten good deeds up to seven hundred times, and up to many times more. The multiplication depends on sincerity, excellence and the need for the deed.

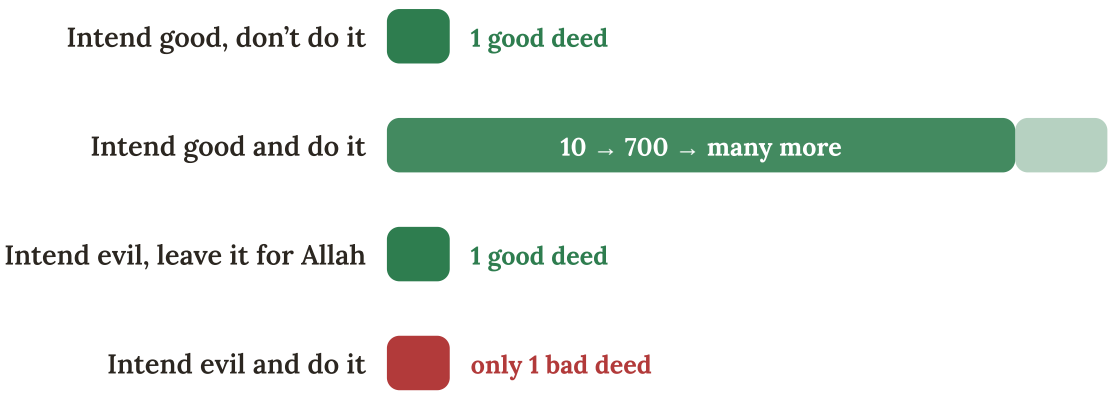
If you intend a bad deed and do not do it, it is written as one complete good deed — if you left it for the sake of Allah. If you left it only because you could not do it, while still trying, you are blamed for your intention. **If you intend it and do it**, it is written as only one bad deed, not multiplied.

Ibn Masʿūd said: 'Woe to the one whose ones overcome his tens.'[1] With such mercy, only the one who insists on destroying himself will be destroyed. This hadith should fill us with hope, make us eager to intend much good, and make us leave evil purely for Allah.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 37.

Picture

see and remember



How deeds are recorded: good is multiplied; evil is recorded only as it is.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Allah's mercy is vast in how He records deeds.
2. A sincere intention of good is rewarded even if not done.
3. Good deeds are multiplied ten to seven hundred times or more.

4 Leaving a sin for Allah's sake is itself a good deed.

5 A bad deed is recorded only once, not multiplied.

6 The intention is important in both good and bad deeds.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 How is an intended good deed that was not done recorded?

Q2 How much can a good deed be multiplied?

Q3 When is leaving a bad deed written as a good deed?

Q4 How is a bad deed that is done recorded?

Q5 Explain Ibn Masʿūd's saying: 'Woe to the one whose ones overcome his tens.'

Q6 How will this hadith change the way you make intentions?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Make many good intentions today (e.g. to give charity, to visit the sick).	☐
Mon	Do at least one of the good deeds you intended.	☐
Tue	Leave one sin purely for the sake of Allah.	☐
Wed	Count: how many good deeds did you do today? Thank Allah.	☐
Thu	Tell someone about Allah's generosity in this hadith.	☐
Fri	Say «لَا حَوْلَ وَلَا قُوَّةَ إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ» when you feel tempted.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 38 OF 50

38

Drawing Near to Allah: The Friends of Allah

الحَدِيثُ الثَّامِنُ وَالثَّلَاثُونَ

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/40hadith/38

Obligations first, then voluntary deeds — until Allah loves you.

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «إِنَّ اللَّهَ تَعَالَى قَالَ: مَنْ عَادَى لِي وَلِيًّا فَقَدْ آذَنْتُهُ بِالحَرْبِ، وَمَا تَقَرَّبَ إِلَيَّ عَبْدِي بِشَيْءٍ أَحَبَّ إِلَيَّ مِمَّا افْتَرَضْتُهُ عَلَيْهِ، وَلَا يَزَالُ عَبْدِي يَتَقَرَّبُ إِلَيَّ بِالنَّوَافِلِ حَتَّى أُحِبَّهُ، فَإِذَا أَحْبَبْتُهُ كُنْتُ سَمْعَهُ الَّذِي يَسْمَعُ بِهِ، وَبَصَرَهُ الَّذِي يُبْصِرُ بِهِ، وَيَدَهُ الَّتِي يَبْطِشُ بِهَا، وَرِجْلَهُ الَّتِي يَمْشِي بِهَا، وَلَئِنْ سَأَلَنِي لَأُعْطِيَنَّهُ، وَلَئِنِ اسْتَعَاذَنِي لَأُعِيذَنَّهُ».

رَوَاهُ البُخَارِيُّ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Hurayrah (may Allah be pleased with him) who said: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, “**Verily Allah ta’ala has said: ‘Whosoever shows enmity to a wali (friend) of Mine, then I have declared war against him. And My servant does not draw near to Me with anything more loved to Me than the religious duties I have obligated upon him. And My servant continues to draw near to me with nafil (supererogatory) deeds until I Love him. When I Love him, I am his hearing with which he hears, and his sight with which he sees, and his hand with which he strikes, and his foot with which he walks. Were he to ask [something] of Me, I would surely give it to him; and were he to seek refuge with Me, I would surely grant him refuge.**’ ”

[Al-Bukhari] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 38 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:38*

About the Narrator

Abū Hurayrah d. 57 AH

أَبُو هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Biography: see Hadith 9.

Explanatory Note

The *awliyā'* (friends) of Allah are "those who believe and have taqwā" (Yūnus 10:62-63)[1] — not people with special powers or strange appearances. Allah declares war on whoever shows enmity to them. Being a walī is open to every believer.

The way to become close to Allah is in two stages. **First, the obligations**: nothing is more beloved to Allah than what He made obligatory — prayer, fasting, zakah, kindness to parents, and avoiding the forbidden. **Then the voluntary deeds** (*nawāfil*): sunnah prayers, extra fasting, charity, Qur'an, dhikr — until Allah loves His servant.

When Allah loves someone, He guides his hearing, sight, hands and feet: he hears, sees, takes and walks only in what pleases Allah. And He answers his du'a and grants him refuge. This does not mean Allah becomes part of His creation — that is a false belief — but that He guides and protects every limb of the one He loves.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 38.

Picture

see and remember



The ladder of nearness: obligations are the base, voluntary deeds the rungs, and Allah's love the summit.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. The friends of Allah are the believers who have taqwā.

2 Harming the friends of Allah is a declaration of war against Allah.

3 The obligations are the most beloved deeds to Allah.

4 Voluntary deeds after the obligations bring Allah's love.

5 Allah protects and guides the limbs of the one He loves.

6 The du'a of the one Allah loves is answered.

Step by Step

Climbing the ladder of nearness

1 **Perfect the obligations**
Five prayers on time, with focus.

2 **Add the 12 sunnah prayers**
2 before Fajr, 4 before Ẓuhr and 2 after, 2 after Maghrib, 2 after ʿIshā'.

3 **Add voluntary fasting**
Mondays and Thursdays, or three days each month.

4 **Add Qur'an and dhikr**
A daily portion, however small.

5 **Be consistent**
Small and steady is beloved to Allah.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **Who are the friends (awliyā') of Allah according to the Qur'an?**

Q2 **What is the most beloved way to draw near to Allah?**

Q3 **What comes after the obligations?**

Q4 **What happens when Allah loves a servant?**

Q5 **Does ‘I am his hearing…’ mean Allah enters His creation? Explain the correct meaning.**

Q6 **Which voluntary deed will you add to your life this week?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise from «وَمَا تَقَرَّبَ إِلَيَّ عَبْدِي…» to «…حَتَّى أُحِبَّهُ».	☐
Sun	Pray all 12 sunnah prayers today.	☐
Mon	Fast on Monday or Thursday.	☐
Tue	Read a page of the Qur’an every day this week.	☐
Wed	Do not speak badly of any righteous person.	☐
Thu	Make du‘a: «اللَّهُمَّ إِنِّي أَسْأَلُكَ حُبَّكَ وَحُبَّ مَنْ يُحِبُّكَ».	☐
Fri	Choose one voluntary deed to keep for life.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 39 OF 50

39

Mistakes, Forgetfulness and Coercion Are Pardoned

الحَدِيثُ التَّاسِعُ وَالثَّلَاثُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/39

The mercy of Allah towards this Ummah.

عَنِ ابْنِ عَبَّاسٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَالَ: «إِنَّ اللَّهَ تَجَاوَزَ لِي عَنْ أُمَّتِي الخَطَأَ وَالنِّسْيَانَ وَمَا اسْتُكْرِهُوا عَلَيْهِ».

حَدِيثٌ حَسَنٌ، رَوَاهُ ابْنُ مَاجَهْ وَالبَيْهَقِيُّ وَغَيْرُهُمَا.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Ibn Abbas (may Allah be pleased with him), that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: **Verily Allah has pardoned [or been lenient with] for me my ummah: their mistakes, their forgetfulness, and that which they have been forced to do under duress.**

A hasan hadeeth related by Ibn Majah, and al-Bayhaqee and others · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 39 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:39*

About the Narrator

ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿAbbās d. 68 AH — عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ عَبَّاسٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا

Biography: see Hadith 19.

Explanatory Note

Allah has lifted from this Ummah the **sin** of three things: **mistakes** (*khaṭa'*), when a person intends one thing and something else happens; **forgetfulness** (*nisyān*), when a person forgets a command or prohibition; and **coercion** (*ikrāh*), when a person is forced by a real threat to do something. This is a special mercy, answering the du'a at the end of al-Baqarah: "Our Lord, do not take us to task if we forget or make a mistake" (2:286)[1].

Lifting the sin does not always lift the **consequences** in this world. If someone kills by mistake, there is no sin, but blood-money and expiation are due (an-Nisā' 4:92)[2]. If someone forgets a prayer,

he must pray it when he remembers. If someone damages property by mistake, he must replace it. But a person who eats forgetfully while fasting completes his fast, and it is valid.

Under coercion, a person may even say words of disbelief to save his life while his heart is at peace with faith (an-Naḥl 16:106)[3]. But coercion does not permit killing an innocent person to save oneself. The chain of this hadith has been discussed, but its meaning is confirmed by the Qur'an.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 39.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Allah has lifted the sin of mistakes, forgetfulness and coercion from this Ummah.
2. This is a special mercy for the followers of Muhammad ﷺ.
3. Worldly consequences such as compensation may still apply.
4. A forgotten prayer must be prayed when remembered.
5. Under real threat, a believer may say words against his belief while his heart is firm.
6. Coercion never permits killing an innocent person.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **What three things are pardoned in this hadith? Define each one.**

Q2 **Which verse of the Qur'an supports this hadith?**

Q3 **If someone forgets a prayer, what should he do?**

Q4 **Is someone who breaks something by mistake free from replacing it? Explain.**

Q5 **What does an-Naḥl 16:106 say about coercion?**

Q6 **How should knowing this hadith affect how we treat other people's mistakes?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Memorise the last verse of al-Baqarah (2:286).	☐
Mon	Be gentle with someone who made an honest mistake.	☐
Tue	If you forgot something important, make it up as soon as you remember.	☐
Wed	Replace or repair anything you broke by accident.	☐
Thu	Learn what to do if you eat by mistake while fasting.	☐
Fri	Thank Allah for His mercy to this Ummah.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

40

HADITH 40 OF 50

Be in This World as a Stranger

الحَدِيثُ الأَرْبَعُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/40

Live light, remember the journey, prepare for home.

عَنِ ابْنِ عُمَرَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا قَالَ: أَخَذَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ بِمَنْكِبِي فَقَالَ: «**كُنْ فِي الدُّنْيَا كَأَنَّكَ غَرِيبٌ أَوْ عَابِرُ سَبِيلٍ**».

وَكَانَ ابْنُ عُمَرَ يَقُولُ: إِذَا أَمْسَيْتَ فَلَا تَنْتَظِرِ الصَّبَاحَ، وَإِذَا أَصْبَحْتَ فَلَا تَنْتَظِرِ المَسَاءَ، وَخُذْ مِنْ صِحَّتِكَ لِمَرَضِكَ، وَمِنْ حَيَاتِكَ لِمَوْتِكَ.

رَوَاهُ البُخَارِيُّ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abdullah ibn Umar (may Allah be pleased with him), who said: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ took me by the shoulder and said, "**Be in this world as though you were a stranger or a wayfarer.**"

And Ibn Umar (may Allah be pleased with him) used to say, "In the evening do not expect [to live until] the morning, and in the morning do not expect [to live until] the evening. Take [advantage of] your health before times of sickness, and [take advantage of] your life before your death."

[Al-Bukhari] · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 40 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:40*

About the Narrator

ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿUmar d. 73 AH — عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ عُمَرَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا

Biography: see Hadith 3.

The Prophet ﷺ took Ibn ʿUmar by the shoulder to draw his full attention.

Explanatory Note

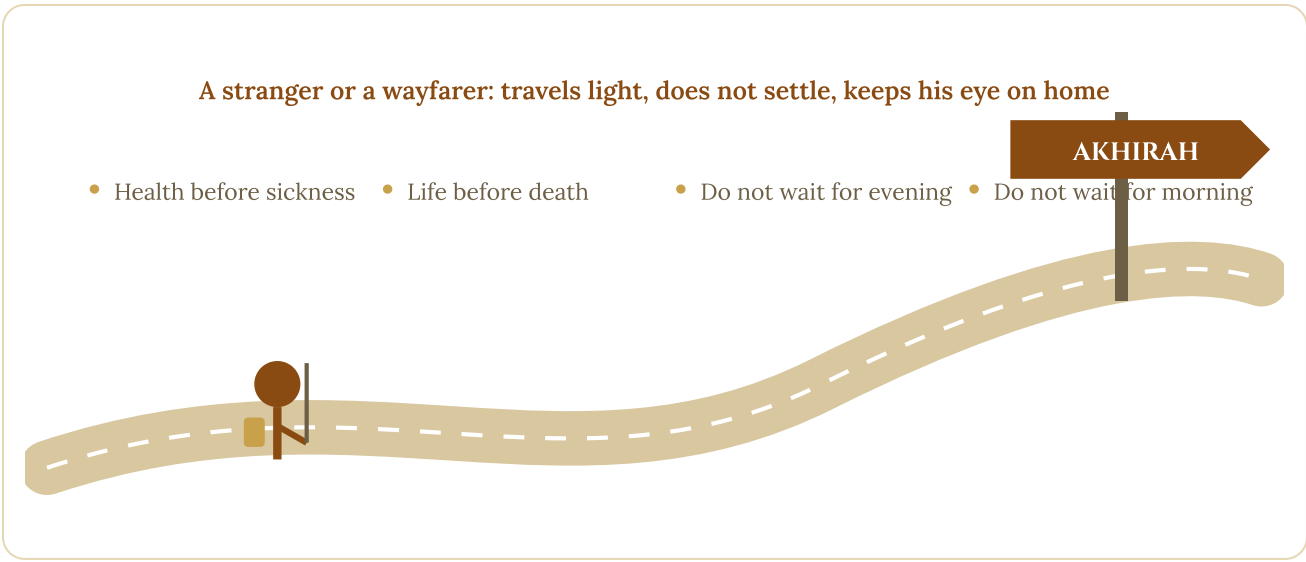
The Prophet ﷺ took Ibn ʿUmar by the shoulder — a sign of love and to get his full attention — and said: **Be in this world as if you were a stranger, or a traveller passing on a road.** A stranger does not settle in a foreign land or compete with its people; his heart is with his home. A traveller is even lighter: he takes only what he needs for the journey.

Our true home is Paradise, where our father Ādam lived. This world is a journey back to it. So we should not let the world fill our hearts, build our hopes on it, or forget the destination. This does not mean leaving work or family; it means using everything for the journey.

Ibn ʿUmar lived this advice and added his own: **in the evening, do not wait for the morning; in the morning, do not wait for the evening** — do not delay good deeds or repentance. **Take from your health for your sickness, and from your life for your death**: use your strength and time now, because they will not last.

Picture

see and remember



The stranger and the wayfarer: travelling light towards home.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. This world is a passing journey; the Hereafter is our home.
2. Do not let the world settle in your heart.
3. Take from this world only what helps your journey.
4. Do not delay good deeds and repentance.
5. Use health before sickness and life before death.
6. Teachers should use touch and attention to make advice reach the heart.

Step by Step

Living as a traveller

1. **Remember the destination**
   Think of death and the Hereafter daily.

2. **Travel light**
   Do not collect what you do not need.

3. **Do it now**
   Do not delay a good deed until tomorrow.

4. **Use your strength**
   Worship and help others while you are healthy.

5. **Write your will**
   Prepare as a traveller would.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 Why did the Prophet ﷺ take Ibn ʿUmar by the shoulder?

Q2 What is the difference between a stranger and a traveller?

Q3 Where is our true home?

Q4 Does this hadith mean we should leave work and family? Explain.

Q5 Explain Ibn ʿUmar's advice in your own words.

Q6 What good deed have you been delaying? When will you do it?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Do one good deed today that you have been delaying.	☐
Mon	Visit a graveyard or remember death for a few minutes.	☐
Tue	Give away something you have not used for a year.	☐
Wed	Use your health today: pray standing with long recitation.	☐
Thu	Make tawbah now, not later.	☐
Fri	Write down your debts and wishes (a simple will).	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

PART FOUR · HADITH 31–40

Review Test

اخْتِبَارُ المُرَاجَعَة

Take this test online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/test4

Name: ..... Date: ..... Score: ..... / 50

Answer from memory first, then check your answers with the chapters. The answer key is at the back of the book.

A Multiple Choice

Circle the correct answer · 25 marks

1. **According to Hadith 31, zuhd in the world brings...**
   - (A) the love of Allah
   - (B) the love of people
   - (C) fame
   - (D) more wealth

2. **Ibn Taymiyyah defined zuhd as leaving...**
   - (A) food
   - (B) all wealth
   - (C) your family
   - (D) what does not benefit you in the Hereafter

3. **Zuhd in what people have brings...**
   - (A) poverty
   - (B) anger
   - (C) the love of people
   - (D) loneliness

4. **"Lā ḍarar wa lā ḍirār" means...**
   - (A) no harm and no returning harm
   - (B) no prayer without wudu
   - (C) no trade without witnesses
   - (D) no fasting while travelling

5. **Which great legal rule comes from Hadith 32?**
   - (A) Certainty is not removed by doubt
   - (B) Harm is to be removed
   - (C) Hardship brings ease
   - (D) Custom is a judge

6. **In Hadith 33, the burden of proof is on...**
   - (A) the claimant
   - (B) the judge
   - (C) the one who denies
   - (D) the witnesses

7. **If the claimant has no proof, the one who denies must...**
   - (A) leave the city
   - (B) pay
   - (C) take an oath
   - (D) bring witnesses

8. **In Hadith 34, the weakest level of faith is changing evil...**
   - (A) with money
   - (B) with the tongue
   - (C) with the hand
   - (D) with the heart

9. **Who should change an evil with the hand?**
   - (A) Only children
   - (B) Anyone
   - (C) Strangers
   - (D) Those with authority over the matter

10. **Abū Saʿīd narrated Hadith 34 when Marwān...**
    - (A) went to Hajj
    - (B) gave the Eid sermon before the prayer
    - (C) delayed Ẓuhr
    - (D) built a mosque

11. **Najash (in Hadith 35) is...**

(A) bidding up a price with no intention to buy
(B) giving a gift
(C) praying fast
(D) travelling

12. **Where did the Prophet ﷺ point when he said 'Taqwā is here'?**

(A) To his head
(B) To his chest
(C) To the Kaʿbah
(D) To the sky

13. **Which three things of a Muslim are sacred to another Muslim?**

(A) Food, drink, clothes
(B) Blood, wealth, honour
(C) Name, tribe, city
(D) Car, house, phone

14. **Whoever relieves a believer of a worldly distress, Allah will relieve him of...**

(A) an illness
(B) a debt
(C) a journey
(D) a distress of the Day of Resurrection

15. **Whoever walks a path seeking knowledge, Allah makes easy for him...**

(A) wealth
(B) marriage
(C) fame
(D) a path to Paradise

16. **Which is NOT one of the gifts for those who gather to study the Qur'an?**

(A) They become rich
(B) Tranquillity descends
(C) Mercy covers them
(D) Angels surround them

17. **"Whoever is slowed down by his deeds will not be hurried forward by..."**

(A) his speed
(B) his strength
(C) his lineage
(D) his wealth

18. **A good deed that is intended but not done is written as...**

(A) nothing
(B) a bad deed
(C) one complete good deed
(D) ten good deeds

19. **A good deed that is done can be multiplied up to...**

(A) a hundred times only
(B) seven hundred times and more
(C) two times
(D) ten times only

20. **A bad deed that is done is written as...**

(A) ten bad deeds
(B) one bad deed
(C) seven hundred bad deeds
(D) nothing

21. **According to Hadith 38, the most beloved way to draw near to Allah is...**

(A) travel
(B) silence
(C) voluntary deeds
(D) the obligations

22. **The friends (awliyā') of Allah are...**

(A) the rich
(B) only the prophets
(C) the believers who have taqwā
(D) people with special powers

23. **Which three things are pardoned for this Ummah in Hadith 39?**

(A) Mistakes, forgetfulness and coercion
(B) Sleep, food, travel
(C) Laziness, anger, jealousy
(D) Lying, cheating, stealing

24. **If someone forgets a prayer, he must...**

(A) leave it
(B) give charity instead
(C) pray it when he remembers
(D) fast instead

25. **"Be in this world as if you were a stranger or..."**
   - (A) a wayfarer
   - (B) a scholar
   - (C) a king
   - (D) a merchant

B MATCHING

Write the letter of the English meaning next to each Arabic phrase · 10 marks

1	ازْهَدْ فِي الدُّنْيَا يُحِبَّكَ اللَّهُ	☐	A	Be in this world as though you are a stranger.
2	لَا ضَرَرَ وَلَا ضِرَارَ	☐	B	Allah writes it down with Himself as a complete good deed.
3	البَيِّنَةُ عَلَى المُدَّعِي	☐	C	Renounce the world and Allah will love you.
4	مَنْ رَأَى مِنْكُمْ مُنْكَرًا فَلْيُغَيِّرْهُ بِيَدِهِ	☐	D	My servant keeps drawing near to Me with voluntary deeds until I love him.
5	وَكُونُوا عِبَادَ اللَّهِ إِخْوَانًا	☐	E	No harm and no returning harm.
6	وَاللَّهُ فِي عَوْنِ العَبْدِ مَا كَانَ العَبْدُ فِي عَوْنِ أَخِيهِ	☐	F	The proof is upon the one who makes the claim.
7	كَتَبَهَا اللَّهُ عِنْدَهُ حَسَنَةً كَامِلَةً	☐	G	Mistakes, forgetfulness and what they are forced to do.
8	وَلَا يَزَالُ عَبْدِي يَتَقَرَّبُ إِلَيَّ بِالنَّوَافِلِ حَتَّى أُحِبَّهُ	☐	H	Allah helps His servant as long as the servant helps his brother.
9	الخَطَأَ وَالنِّسْيَانَ وَمَا اسْتُكْرِهُوا عَلَيْهِ	☐	I	Whoever of you sees an evil, let him change it with his hand.
10	كُنْ فِي الدُّنْيَا كَأَنَّكَ غَرِيبٌ	☐	J	And be, O servants of Allah, brothers.

C SHORT ANSWER

Answer in one or two sentences · 10 marks

1. **Does zuhd mean being poor? Explain.**

2. **What is the difference between ḍarar and ḍirār?**

3. Give two examples of rulings built on Hadith 32.

4. What counts as ‘proof’ (bayyinah) in Hadith 33?

5. Name three conditions before changing an evil.

6. List the five ‘do not’s at the start of Hadith 35.

7. What does ‘covering a Muslim’ mean, and what does it not mean?

8. When is leaving a bad deed written as a good deed?

9. What happens when Allah loves a servant (Hadith 38)?

10. Explain Ibn ʿUmar’s advice at the end of Hadith 40.

D Critical Thinking

Explain your thinking with evidence from the hadith · 5 marks

1. Zuhd (Hadith 31) and working hard to earn halal money can seem to clash. Explain how a Muslim can be both successful at work and a zāhid.

2. Using Hadith 33, explain why we should not believe or share rumours on social media. What would happen to a community that ignored this rule?

3. You see a friend doing something wrong. Using Hadith 34, decide which level applies to you and write exactly what you would say or do.

4. Hadith 37 shows how generous Allah is in recording deeds. How should this change the way you plan your week? Give examples of intentions you could make.

5. If you truly lived ‘as a stranger or a wayfarer’ (Hadith 40), what would you do differently with your time, money and belongings?



PART FIVE

Mercy, Hope and the Additions of Ibn Rajab

Hadith 41 – 50

41 Desires That Follow the Revelation

42 O Son of Adam, I Will Forgive You

43 Give the Inheritance Shares to Their People

44 Fosterage Forbids What Birth Forbids

45 Forbidden Trade: Wine, Carrion, Swine and Idols

46 Every Intoxicant Is Forbidden

47 The Worst Vessel: The Stomach

48 The Four Signs of Hypocrisy

49 True Reliance on Allah

50 Keep Your Tongue Moist with the Remembrance of Allah

HADITH 41 OF 50

41

Desires That Follow the Revelation

الحَدِيثُ الحَادِي وَالأَرْبَعُونَ

Listen & study online
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/40hadith/41

Complete faith: when your likes and dislikes follow what the Prophet ﷺ brought.

عَنْ أَبِي مُحَمَّدٍ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ عَمْرِو بْنِ العَاصِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «لَا يُؤْمِنُ أَحَدُكُمْ حَتَّى يَكُونَ هَوَاهُ تَبَعًا لِمَا جِئْتُ بِهِ».

حَدِيثٌ صَحِيحٌ، رُوِّينَاهُ فِي كِتَابِ «الحُجَّةِ» بِإِسْنَادٍ صَحِيحٍ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Abu Muhammad Abdullah bin 'Amr bin al-'Aas (may Allah be pleased with him) who said: The Messenger of Allah ﷺ said, "**None of you [truly] believes until his desires are subservient to that which I have brought.**"

[Imam an-Nawawi says:] We have related it in Kitab al-Hujjah with a saheeh chain of narrators · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 41 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:41*

About the Narrator

ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿAmr ibn al-ʿĀṣ d. 65 AH — عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ عَمْرٍو رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا

He accepted Islam before his father ʿAmr ibn al-ʿĀṣ. He could read and write, and with the Prophet's ﷺ permission wrote down hadith in a collection called aṣ-Ṣaḥīfah aṣ-Ṣādiqah. He was very devoted to worship, fasting every day and reciting the whole Qur'an every night, until the Prophet ﷺ told him to be moderate: "Your body has a right over you." He died in 65 AH.

Explanatory Note

Hawā is what a person's soul wants and inclines to. The hadith says that a person's faith is not complete until his desires **follow** what the Prophet ﷺ brought: he loves what Allah and His Messenger love, and dislikes what they dislike, not only in actions but even in feelings. Its meaning is confirmed by the Qur'an: "But no, by your Lord, they will not believe until they make you judge in their disputes, and then find no discomfort in their hearts with your judgement, and submit fully" (an-Nisā' 4:65)[1].

An-Nawawī graded this hadith authentic; Ibn Rajab and others discussed weakness in its chain. All agree its meaning is correct and supported by many texts, such as "None of you believes until I am more beloved to him than his father, his child and all people."[2]

Following desires against the Shariah is the root of every sin and every innovation. The cure is to know what the Prophet ﷺ brought, to love him, and to train the soul gradually until it finds its pleasure in obedience. Then worship becomes a joy, not a burden.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 41.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Complete faith means our desires follow the Shariah.
2. Accepting the Prophet's ﷺ judgement with a peaceful heart is part of faith.
3. Following desires against revelation is the root of sins and innovations.
4. We must learn the Sunnah to know what to love and what to dislike.
5. Loving the Prophet ﷺ more than anyone is a condition of complete faith.
6. The soul can be trained to love obedience.

Step by Step

Training your desires

1 Know
Learn what Allah and His Messenger love and dislike.

2 Choose
When desire and revelation clash, choose revelation — even if it is hard.

3 Repeat
Habits change the heart; do the right thing again and again.

4 Replace
Swap a haram pleasure with a halal one.

5 Ask Allah
«اللَّهُمَّ حَبِّبْ إِلَيْنَا الإِيمَانَ وَزَيِّنْهُ فِي قُلُوبِنَا».

Questions

think, then write

Q1 What does hawā mean?

Q2 What is the meaning of 'until his desires follow what I have brought'?

Q3 Which verse of the Qur'an supports the meaning of this hadith?

Q4 What did the scholars say about the chain of this hadith and its meaning?

Q5 Why is following desires dangerous?

Q6 Which desire do you find hardest to make follow the Sunnah? What will you do?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Read an-Nisā' 4:65 with its meaning.	☐
Mon	When you feel a desire for something haram, say no — once, today.	☐
Tue	Learn one thing the Prophet ﷺ loved (e.g. honey, the right side, beginning with Bismillah) and practise it.	☐
Wed	Send ṣalāh upon the Prophet 100 ﷺ times.	☐
Thu	Accept a ruling of the religion today without arguing.	☐
Fri	Make the du'a in the Steps box after a prayer.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 42 OF 50

42

O Son of Adam, I Will Forgive You

الحَدِيثُ الثَّانِي وَالأَرْبَعُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/42

The most hopeful hadith: three keys to Allah's forgiveness.

عَنْ أَنَسٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَقُولُ: «قَالَ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى: يَا ابْنَ آدَمَ، إِنَّكَ مَا دَعَوْتَنِي وَرَجَوْتَنِي غَفَرْتُ لَكَ عَلَى مَا كَانَ مِنْكَ وَلَا أُبَالِي.
يَا ابْنَ آدَمَ، لَوْ بَلَغَتْ ذُنُوبُكَ عَنَانَ السَّمَاءِ ثُمَّ اسْتَغْفَرْتَنِي غَفَرْتُ لَكَ.
يَا ابْنَ آدَمَ، إِنَّكَ لَوْ أَتَيْتَنِي بِقُرَابِ الأَرْضِ خَطَايَا ثُمَّ لَقِيتَنِي لَا تُشْرِكُ بِي شَيْئًا لَأَتَيْتُكَ بِقُرَابِهَا مَغْفِرَةً».

رَوَاهُ التِّرْمِذِيُّ وَقَالَ: حَدِيثٌ حَسَنٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

On the authority of Anas (may Allah be pleased with him) who said: I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ say, "**Allah the Almighty has said: 'O Son of Adam, as long as you invoke Me and ask of Me, I shall forgive you for what you have done, and I shall not mind.**

O Son of Adam, were your sins to reach the clouds of the sky and you then asked forgiveness from Me, I would forgive you.

O Son of Adam, were you to come to Me with sins nearly as great as the Earth, and were you then to face Me, ascribing no partner to Me, I would bring you forgiveness nearly as great as it [too].' "

It was related by at-Tirmidhi, who said that it was a hasan hadeeth · Forty Hadith of an-Nawawi 42 · *sunnah.com/nawawi40:42*

About the Narrator

Anas ibn Mālik d. 93 AH

أَنَس بْنُ مَالِكٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

Biography: see Hadith 13.

Explanatory Note

An-Nawawī ended his collection with this hadith of hope. In it Allah gives three means of forgiveness. **Du'a with hope**: as long as you call on Allah and hope in Him, He forgives you whatever you have done, and does not mind, because nothing is too great for His forgiveness. **Istighfār**: even if your sins reached the clouds of the sky, then you sought forgiveness, He would forgive you. **Tawḥīd**: if you came with sins nearly filling the earth, but met Allah without associating anything with Him, He would meet you with forgiveness nearly filling it.

This hadith must not be misunderstood as permission to sin. True hope comes with action and repentance; hope without action is only wishful thinking. Shirk is the one sin that is not forgiven if a person dies upon it (an-Nisā' 4:48)[1], which shows how great tawḥīd is.

The believer lives between **fear and hope**, like a bird with two wings. Fear keeps him away from sin; hope keeps him from despair. No one should ever say: 'My sins are too many to be forgiven.' Allah says: "Do not despair of the mercy of Allah; indeed Allah forgives all sins" (az-Zumar 39:53)[2].

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 42.

Picture

see and remember



Three doors to Allah's forgiveness: du'a with hope, seeking forgiveness, and tawḥīd.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Allah's forgiveness is greater than any sin.

2 Du'a with hope is a cause of forgiveness.

3 Seeking forgiveness wipes out sins, however many.

4 Tawḥīd is the greatest cause of forgiveness; shirk is the greatest barrier.

5 Hope must lead to action and repentance, not to more sin.

6 Never despair of Allah's mercy.

Step by Step

The master of seeking forgiveness (Sayyid al-Istighfār)

1 When
Say it in the morning and the evening.

2 Read
«اللَّهُمَّ أَنْتَ رَبِّي لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، خَلَقْتَنِي وَأَنَا عَبْدُكَ، وَأَنَا عَلَى عَهْدِكَ وَوَعْدِكَ مَا اسْتَطَعْتُ...».

3 Mean it
Admit your sins and Allah's blessings in your heart.

4 Reward
Whoever says it with certainty and dies that day or night enters Paradise (al-Bukhārī).

Questions

think, then write

Q1 Why did an-Nawawī end his collection with this hadith?

Q2 Name the three means of forgiveness in this hadith.

Q3 What does 'and I do not mind' mean here?

Q4 Which sin will not be forgiven if one dies upon it?

Q5 What is the difference between true hope and wishful thinking?

Q6 **How does this hadith help a person who feels his sins are too many?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the first section, up to «وَلَا أُبَالِي…».	☐
Sun	Memorise Sayyid al-Istighfār.	☐
Mon	Say Sayyid al-Istighfār every morning and evening this week.	☐
Tue	Say «أَسْتَغْفِرُ اللَّهَ» 100 times a day.	☐
Wed	Read az-Zumar 39:53 and reflect.	☐
Thu	Encourage someone who feels hopeless about their sins.	☐
Fri	Learn what shirk is and how to avoid it.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 43 OF 50

43

Give the Inheritance Shares to Their People

الحَدِيثُ الثَّالِثُ وَالأَرْبَعُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/43

The first of Ibn Rajab's additions: the foundation of the law of inheritance.

عَنِ ابْنِ عَبَّاسٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا قَالَ: قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ: «أَلْحِقُوا الفَرَائِضَ بِأَهْلِهَا، فَمَا أَبْقَتِ الفَرَائِضُ فَلِأَوْلَى رَجُلٍ ذَكَرٍ».

خَرَّجَهُ البُخَارِيُّ وَمُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

Narrated Ibn `Abbas: The Prophet ﷺ said, "**Give the Fara'id (the shares of the inheritance that are prescribed in the Qur'an) to those who are entitled to receive it. Then whatever remains, should be given to the closest male relative of the deceased.**"

Sahih Muslim 1615a (sunnah.com/muslim:1615a): Ibn Abbas (Allah be pleased with them) reported Allah's Messenger (ﷺ) as saying: "Give the shares to those who are entitled to them, and what remains over goes to the nearest male heir."

Sahih al-Bukhari 6732 · *sunnah.com/bukhari:6732*

About the Narrator

ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿAbbās d. 68 AH — عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ عَبَّاسٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا

Biography: see Hadith 19.

Explanatory Note

This hadith gathers the basis of the law of inheritance (*farā'iḍ*). Allah Himself fixed the shares of certain heirs in the Qur'an (an-Nisā' 4:11, 12, 176)[1]: halves, quarters, eighths, two-thirds, thirds and sixths, for spouses, parents, daughters, sisters and others. **"Give the shares to those entitled to them"**: these fixed-share heirs (*aṣḥāb al-furūḍ*) are given their portions first.

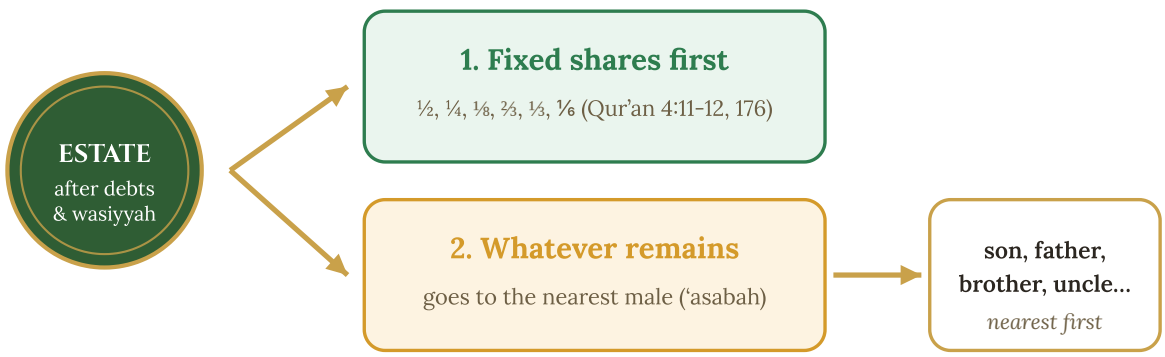
"Whatever is left goes to the nearest male relative": the remainder goes to the *ʿaṣabah*, the male relatives through the male line, the closest first: son, then son's son, then father, then grandfather, brothers, nephews, uncles, and so on. A nearer one blocks a farther one. In some cases daughters and sisters also inherit as ʿaṣabah together with their brothers, the male receiving twice the female, because he carries financial duties she does not (an-Nisāʾ 4:11).

Before inheritance is shared, the deceased's **funeral costs**, then his **debts**, then his **bequest** (*waṣiyyah*, at most one-third and not to an heir) are taken from the estate. Inheritance is a right Allah fixed; no one may change it or deprive an heir. Learning the farāʾiḍ is a collective duty, and the scholars have always encouraged it.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 43.

Picture

see and remember



How an estate is divided: fixed shares first, then the remainder to the nearest male relative.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Allah Himself fixed the shares of inheritance; they must not be changed.
2. Heirs with fixed shares are given first.
3. The remainder goes to the nearest male relative (ʿaṣabah).
4. A nearer relative blocks a farther one.
5. Funeral costs, debts and bequests come before inheritance.
6. A bequest may not exceed one-third, and may not be for an heir.
7. Learning the farāʾiḍ is a valued branch of knowledge.

Step by Step

Order of dealing with an estate

1. **Funeral costs**
   Washing, shrouding and burial, from the estate.

2. **Debts**
   Pay all debts to Allah (e.g. zakah) and to people.

3. **Bequest**
   Carry out the will, up to one-third, not to an heir.

4. **Fixed shares**
   Give the Qur'anic shares to their owners.

5. **Remainder**
   Give what is left to the nearest male relative(s).

6. **Ask an expert**
   Consult a scholar who knows farā'iḍ before dividing.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 What are the farā'iḍ?

Q2 Where in the Qur'an are the inheritance shares mentioned?

Q3 Who receives what remains after the fixed shares?

Q4 What three things are paid from the estate before inheritance?

Q5 What is the maximum amount of a bequest, and who may not receive one?

Q6 **Why is it a serious sin to deprive an heir of his or her share?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Read an-Nisā' 4:11-12 with its meaning.	☐
Mon	Learn the six fixed shares: ½, ¼, ⅛, ⅔, ⅓, ⅙.	☐
Tue	Write down any debts you owe so your family knows.	☐
Wed	Learn the order: funeral, debts, bequest, inheritance.	☐
Thu	Make du'a for deceased relatives.	☐
Fri	Ask a teacher to show you one simple inheritance example.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 44 OF 50

44

Fosterage Forbids What Birth Forbids

الحَدِيثُ الرَّابِعُ وَالأَرْبَعُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/44

Breast-feeding creates a family bond — with its own rulings.

عَنْ عَائِشَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا عَنِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ قَالَ: «الرَّضَاعَةُ تُحَرِّمُ مَا تُحَرِّمُ الوِلَادَةُ».

خَرَّجَهُ البُخَارِيُّ وَمُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

A'isha (Allah be pleased with her) reported that Allah's Messenger ﷺ was with her and she heard the voice of a person seeking permission to enter the house of Hafsa. 'A'isha (Allah be pleased with her) said: Allah's Messenger, he is the person who seeks permission to enter your house, whereupon Allah's Messenger ﷺ said: **I think he is so and so (uncle of Hafsa by reason of fosterage).**

'A'isha said: Messenger of Allah, if so and so (her uncle by reason of fosterage) were alive, could he enter my house? Allah's Messenger ﷺ said: **Yes. Fosterage makes unlawful what consanguinity makes unlawful.**

Ibn Rajab quotes the concluding words of this hadith. In Sahih al-Bukhari 2646 (sunnah.com/bukhari:2646) they are translated: "...as the foster relations are treated like blood relations (in marital affairs)."

Sahih Muslim 1444a · *sunnah.com/muslim:1444a*

About the Narrator

ʿĀ'ishah bint Abī Bakr — d. 57 AH

عَائِشَةُ أُمُّ المُؤْمِنِينَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا

Biography: see Hadith 5.

This was said when ʿĀ'ishah's foster-uncle Aflaḥ asked permission to enter her house.

Explanatory Note

When a woman breast-feeds a baby in the conditions the Shariah sets, she becomes the baby's **foster mother**, her husband (whose child led to the milk) becomes its **foster father**, and their children become its **foster brothers and sisters**. Everyone who would be forbidden to marry through birth is forbidden through fosterage: the foster mother, her mother, her sisters (aunts), her daughters, and so on. They become *maḥram*: marriage is forbidden, and they may see and sit with one another as close relatives do.

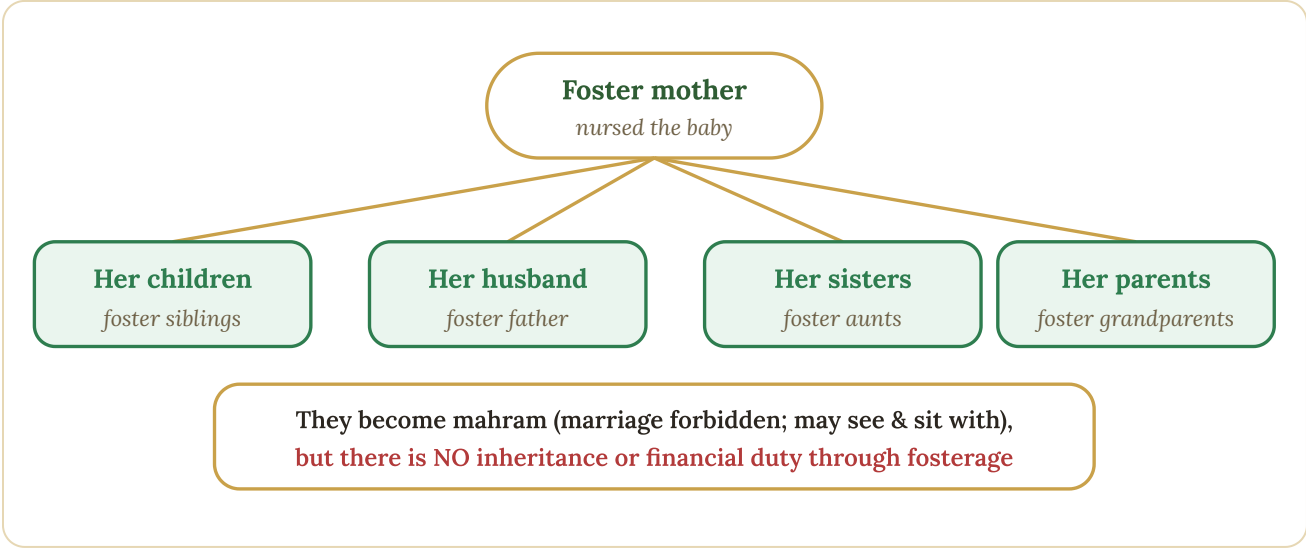
The scholars set conditions for fosterage to count. It must be **within the first two years** of the baby's life (al-Baqarah 2:233)[1]. On the **number** of feedings scholars differ: ash-Shāfiʿī and Aḥmad hold that it must be **five clear feeds**, based on a narration of ʿĀ'ishah in Muslim[2], while Abū Ḥanīfah and Mālik hold that any amount counts. In cases of doubt, people should ask a scholar.

Fosterage creates *maḥram* status only; it does **not** create inheritance, financial support or the other duties of blood relationship. This hadith is important today with donor milk and multi-family homes: families should record which children were fed by whom, so that foster siblings do not marry each other unknowingly.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 44.

Picture

see and remember



Who becomes mahram through fosterage.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Fosterage makes marriage forbidden in the same way as blood relationship.
2. The foster mother, her husband and their relatives become maḥram to the child.
3. Fosterage counts only within the first two years.
4. Scholars differ on the number of feeds; ask a scholar in real cases.

5 Fosterage does not bring inheritance or financial duties.

6 Families should record fosterage to prevent forbidden marriages.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **Who becomes the foster mother and foster father of a child?**

Q2 **Name four relatives who become maḥram through fosterage.**

Q3 **Within what age must breast-feeding happen to count?**

Q4 **What is the difference of opinion about the number of feeds?**

Q5 **What rights of blood relatives are not given to foster relatives?**

Q6 **Why is it important for families to record fosterage?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Read al-Baqarah 2:233 about the period of nursing.	☐
Mon	Ask your parents whether you have any foster siblings.	☐
Tue	Draw a foster family tree using the picture as a model.	☐
Wed	Learn the list of women forbidden in marriage (an-Nisā' 4:23).	☐
Thu	Thank your mother for nursing and caring for you.	☐
Fri	Make du'a for your parents: «رَبِّ ارْحَمْهُمَا كَمَا رَبَّيَانِي صَغِيرًا».	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 45 OF 50

45

Forbidden Trade: Wine, Carrion, Swine and Idols

الحَدِيثُ الخَامِسُ وَالأَرْبَعُونَ

Listen & study online
diinislaam.com
/40hadith/45

What is forbidden to use is forbidden to sell — and tricks do not change the ruling.

عَنْ جَابِرٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ أَنَّهُ سَمِعَ النَّبِيَّ ﷺ عَامَ الفَتْحِ - وَهُوَ بِمَكَّةَ - يَقُولُ: «إِنَّ اللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُ حَرَّمَ بَيْعَ الخَمْرِ، وَالمَيْتَةِ، وَالخِنْزِيرِ، وَالأَصْنَامِ».

فَقِيلَ: يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ، أَرَأَيْتَ شُحُومَ المَيْتَةِ، فَإِنَّهُ يُطْلَى بِهَا السُّفُنُ، وَيُدْهَنُ بِهَا الجُلُودُ، وَيَسْتَصْبِحُ بِهَا النَّاسُ؟ قَالَ: «لَا، هُوَ حَرَامٌ».

ثُمَّ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ عِنْدَ ذَلِكَ: «قَاتَلَ اللَّهُ اليَهُودَ، إِنَّ اللَّهَ حَرَّمَ عَلَيْهِمُ الشُّحُومَ، فَأَجْمَلُوهُ، ثُمَّ بَاعُوهُ، فَأَكَلُوا ثَمَنَهُ».

خَرَّجَهُ البُخَارِيُّ وَمُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

Narrated Jabir bin `Abdullah: I heard Allah's Messenger ﷺ, in the year of the Conquest of Mecca, saying, "**Allah and His Apostle made illegal the trade of alcohol, dead animals, pigs and idols.**"

The people asked, "O Allah's Messenger ﷺ! What about the fat of dead animals, for it was used for greasing the boats and the hides; and people use it for lights?" He said, "**No, it is illegal.**"

Allah's Messenger ﷺ further said, "**May Allah curse the Jews, for Allah made the fat (of animals) illegal for them, yet they melted the fat and sold it and ate its price.**"

Sahih al-Bukhari 2236 · *sunnah.com/bukhari:2236*

About the Narrator

Jābir ibn ʿAbdullāh d. 78 AH — جَابِرُ بْنُ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا

Biography: see Hadith 22.

Explanatory Note

In the year Makkah was conquered, the Prophet ﷺ announced that Allah and His Messenger forbade the sale of **wine** (and every intoxicant), **carrion** (animals that died without proper slaughter), **swine** and **idols**. Scholars derived a rule: **when Allah forbids something to be used, He forbids its price**. So selling what is forbidden — drugs, pork, alcohol, gambling tools, idols and statues for worship — is haram, and so is the money earned from it.

The people asked about the fat of carrion, which was useful for greasing ships and leather and for lamps. The Prophet ﷺ said: "No, it is haram." Scholars differ whether 'it' refers to the sale or to the use; the majority say the **sale** is forbidden.

Then he warned against **tricks** (*ḥiyal*): the Jews were forbidden the fat of animals, so they melted it, sold it and ate its price, as if changing its form changed the ruling. This is a warning to Muslims not to use tricks to make the haram look halal, like calling interest a 'fee' or alcohol a 'drink'. Changing the name does not change the reality.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Selling wine, carrion, pork and idols is forbidden.
2. What is forbidden to use is forbidden to sell, and its price is haram.
3. Islam protects religion (no idols), mind (no intoxicants) and health.
4. Tricks to make the haram halal are forbidden.
5. Changing the name or form of a haram thing does not change its ruling.
6. A Muslim must check that his business and income are halal.

Step by Step

Checking whether a business is halal

1. **What is sold?**
   Is the product or service itself halal?

2. **How is it sold?**
   No deception, interest, gambling or hidden defects.

3. **Where does it lead?**
   Does it help people sin?

4 **Any tricks?**
Is a haram thing renamed or disguised?

5 **Ask**
Consult a scholar of Islamic finance if unsure.

QUESTIONS

think, then write

Q1 When and where did the Prophet ﷺ say this hadith?

Q2 Name the four things whose sale was forbidden.

Q3 What general rule did the scholars take from this hadith?

Q4 What did the people ask about the fat of dead animals, and what was the answer?

Q5 What trick did the Jews use, and what is the lesson for us?

Q6 Give a modern example of trying to make the haram look halal.

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the first sentence of the hadith.	☐
Sun	Check that a product you buy or sell is halal.	☐
Mon	Avoid any job or app that earns money from haram.	☐
Tue	Learn what interest (ribā) is and why it is forbidden.	☐
Wed	Do not call a haram thing by a ‘nicer’ name.	☐
Thu	Thank Allah for halal provision.	☐
Fri	Read al-Mā’idah 5:90 about intoxicants and idols.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

46

HADITH 46 OF 50

Every Intoxicant Is Forbidden

الحَدِيثُ السَّادِسُ وَالأَرْبَعُونَ

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diinislaam.com
/40hadith/46

A rule of jawāmiʿ al-kalim: one sentence covers every intoxicant until the end of time.

عَنْ أَبِي بُرْدَةَ، عَنْ أَبِيهِ - أَبِي مُوسَى الأَشْعَرِيِّ - رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ: أَنَّ النَّبِيَّ ﷺ بَعَثَهُ إِلَى اليَمَنِ، فَسَأَلَهُ عَنْ أَشْرِبَةٍ تُصْنَعُ بِهَا، فَقَالَ: «وَمَا هِيَ؟» قَالَ: البِتْعُ وَالمِزْرُ. فَقِيلَ لِأَبِي بُرْدَةَ: مَا البِتْعُ؟ قَالَ: نَبِيذُ العَسَلِ، وَالمِزْرُ: نَبِيذُ الشَّعِيرِ - فَقَالَ: «كُلُّ مُسْكِرٍ حَرَامٌ». خَرَّجَهُ البُخَارِيُّ.

وَخَرَّجَهُ مُسْلِمٌ وَلَفْظُهُ: قَالَ: بَعَثَنِي رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ أَنَا وَمُعَاذٌ إِلَى اليَمَنِ، فَقُلْتُ: يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ، إِنَّ شَرَابًا يُصْنَعُ بِأَرْضِنَا يُقَالُ لَهُ: المِزْرُ مِنَ الشَّعِيرِ، وَشَرَابٌ يُقَالُ لَهُ: البِتْعُ مِنَ العَسَلِ، فَقَالَ: «كُلُّ مُسْكِرٍ حَرَامٌ».

وَفِي رِوَايَةٍ لِمُسْلِمٍ: فَقَالَ: «كُلُّ مَا أَسْكَرَ عَنِ الصَّلَاةِ فَهُوَ حَرَامٌ».

وَفِي رِوَايَةٍ لَهُ: وَكَانَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ قَدْ أُعْطِيَ جَوَامِعَ الكَلِمِ بِخَوَاتِمِهِ، فَقَالَ: «أَنْهَى عَنْ كُلِّ مُسْكِرٍ أَسْكَرَ عَنِ الصَّلَاةِ».

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

Narrated Abi Burda: That Abu Musa Al-Ash`ari said that the Prophet ﷺ had sent him to Yemen and he asked the Prophet ﷺ about certain (alcoholic) drink which used to be prepared there The Prophet ﷺ said, "**What are they?**" Abu Musa said, "Al-Bit' and Al-Mizr?" He said, "Al-Bit is an alcoholic drink made from honey; and Al-Mizr is an alcoholic drink made from barley." The Prophet ﷺ said, "**All intoxicants are prohibited.**"

Sahih Muslim 1733g (sunnah.com/muslim:1733g): ...I (Burda) said: Allah's Messenger, give us a religious verdict about two kinds of drinks which we prepare in Yemen. One is Bit' which is prepared from honey; it is a fermented Nabidh and is strong and turns into wine, and (the second is) Mizr which is prepared from millet and barley. Thereupon, Allah's Messenger (ﷺ), who had been gifted with the most eloquent and pithy expressions, said: "I forbid you from every intoxicant that keeps you away from prayer."

Sahih al-Bukhari 4343 · *sunnah.com/bukhari:4343*

About the Narrator

Abū Mūsā al-Ashʿarī d. c. 44 AH

أَبُو مُوسَى الأَشْعَرِيُّ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

ʿAbdullāh ibn Qays of the Ashʿarīs of Yemen. His recitation was so beautiful that the Prophet ﷺ said he had been given ‘one of the flutes of the family of Dāwūd’. The Prophet ﷺ sent him with Muʿādh to teach Yemen, and ʿUmar made him governor of Basra and Kūfah, where he taught the Qur’an and fiqh. He died around 44 AH.

Abū Burdah, who narrates it from his father, was a Successor and later a judge of Kūfah.

Explanatory Note

When the Prophet ﷺ sent Abū Mūsā and Muʿādh to Yemen, he was asked about two local drinks: *bitʿ* made from honey and *mizr* made from barley. Instead of ruling on each one, he gave a **comprehensive rule**: “Every intoxicant is forbidden.” This is an example of *jawāmiʿ al-kalim*, which Ibn Rajab mentions: one sentence that covers every drink, food or drug that intoxicates, from any source, in any age.

In the narrations of Muslim: “Everything that intoxicates so as to keep you from the prayer is forbidden,” showing the reason (*ʿillah*) of the ruling: covering the mind. Another hadith says: “Whatever intoxicates in a large amount, a small amount of it is also forbidden” (Abū Dāwūd, at-Tirmidhī)[1]. So a little alcohol is forbidden even if it does not make one drunk, and so are modern drugs that cloud the mind.

The mind is one of the five necessities Islam protects (Hadith 14). Intoxicants destroy health, families and wealth, lead to crime and keep people from the remembrance of Allah and the prayer (al-

Mā'idah 5:90-91)[2]. The Prophet ﷺ cursed ten people involved with wine[3]: the one who makes it, carries it, sells it, serves it, drinks it and more.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 46.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Every intoxicant, whatever its name or source, is forbidden.
2. A small amount of what intoxicates in large amounts is also forbidden.
3. The reason is protecting the mind and the prayer.
4. Modern drugs that intoxicate are included.
5. The Prophet ﷺ was given comprehensive speech that applies in all times.
6. Scholars and judges should give general rules that cover similar cases.

Step by Step

Staying safe from intoxicants

1. **Know the rule**
   Anything that intoxicates is haram, in any amount.
2. **Check labels**
   Avoid foods and drinks containing alcohol.
3. **Avoid the places**
   Do not sit where alcohol or drugs are served.
4. **Choose friends**
   Keep away from those who use intoxicants.
5. **Help others**
   Support anyone struggling with addiction to get help.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **What two drinks was the Prophet ﷺ asked about?**

Q2 **What general rule did he give, and why is it called jawāmiʿ al-kalim?**

Q3 What is the reason (ʿillah) for forbidding intoxicants?

Q4 Is a small amount of alcohol allowed if it does not make one drunk? Give the evidence.

Q5 Are modern drugs included? Why?

Q6 How can a young Muslim stay safe from intoxicants and peer pressure?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise «كُلُّ مُسْكِرٍ حَرَامٌ».	☐
Sun	Read al-Mā'idah 5:90-91 with its meaning.	☐
Mon	Check the ingredients of two products for alcohol.	☐
Tue	Learn the harms of drugs and share them with someone.	☐
Wed	Avoid any gathering where intoxicants are present.	☐
Thu	Praise Allah for the gift of a sound mind.	☐
Fri	Make duʿa for anyone suffering from addiction.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

47

HADITH 47 OF 50

The Worst Vessel: The Stomach

الحَدِيثُ السَّابِعُ وَالأَرْبَعُونَ

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/40hadith/47

One-third food, one-third drink, one-third breath.

عَنِ المِقْدَامِ بْنِ مَعْدِي كَرِبَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَقُولُ: «مَا مَلَأَ آدَمِيٌّ وِعَاءً شَرًّا مِنْ بَطْنٍ، بِحَسْبِ ابْنِ آدَمَ أُكُلَاتٌ يُقِمْنَ صُلْبَهُ، فَإِنْ كَانَ لَا مَحَالَةَ، فَثُلُثٌ لِطَعَامِهِ، وَثُلُثٌ لِشَرَابِهِ، وَثُلُثٌ لِنَفَسِهِ».

رَوَاهُ الإِمَامُ أَحْمَدُ، وَالتِّرْمِذِيُّ، وَالنَّسَائِيُّ، وَابْنُ مَاجَهْ، وَقَالَ التِّرْمِذِيُّ: «حَسَنٌ».

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

Miqdam bin Ma'dikarib said: "I heard the Messenger of Allah ﷺ saying: **'The human does not fill any container that is worse than his stomach. It is sufficient for the son of Adam to eat what will support his back. If this is not possible, then a third for food, a third for drink, and third for his breath.'"**

Jami` at-Tirmidhi 2380 · *sunnah.com/tirmidhi:2380*

About the Narrator

Al-Miqdām ibn Maʿdī Karib d. 87 AH — المِقْدَامُ بْنُ مَعْدِي كَرِبَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

From the tribe of Kindah in Yemen, he came with its delegation in 10 AH. He settled in Ḥimṣ in Shām, where the scholars of the Successors learned from him, and he died there in 87 AH.

Explanatory Note

Ibn Rajab said this hadith is a foundation for all of medicine[1]. The **stomach** is the worst container a person can fill, because overeating harms the body, makes one lazy for worship, hardens the heart and opens the door to desires. The best is to eat **a few bites that keep the back straight**: enough for strength.

If one must eat more, then the stomach is divided: **a third for food, a third for drink and a third for breathing**. A doctor once said that if people followed this, they would be safe from many diseases. Overeating is linked to many illnesses of the body, and the righteous noticed it also dulls the heart: 'Whoever eats much, drinks much, sleeps much and loses much.'

This does not mean starving oneself. Eating enough is needed for health and strength. The Sunnah also teaches the manners of eating: saying Bismillah, eating with the right hand, eating from what is in front of you, not criticising food, sharing, and praising Allah at the end.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 47.

Picture

see and remember



1. Best: a few morsels to keep your back straight
2. If you must eat more — stop at one-third
3. Say Bismillah; eat with the right hand
4. Eat from what is in front of you
5. Finish with Alhamdulillah

The Prophetic measure of eating, and the manners of the meal.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Overeating harms the body, the mind and the heart.
2. The Sunnah is to eat little, enough to keep one strong.
3. The measure: one-third food, one-third drink, one-third air.
4. Islam cares about physical health.
5. Moderation makes worship easier.
6. The manners of eating are part of the Sunnah.

Step by Step

The Sunnah of eating

1. **Wash and say Bismillah**
   If you forget, say «بِسْمِ اللَّهِ أَوَّلَهُ وَآخِرَهُ».

2 **Right hand, from in front of you**
Do not reach across.

3 **Sit humbly and eat slowly**
Do not criticise the food.

4 **Stop before you are full**
Leave room for drink and breath.

5 **Praise Allah**
«الحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ الَّذِي أَطْعَمَنِي هَذَا وَرَزَقَنِيهِ مِنْ غَيْرِ حَوْلٍ مِنِّي وَلَا قُوَّةٍ».

QUESTIONS

think, then write

Q1 Why is the stomach called the worst vessel to fill?

Q2 What is best according to the hadith?

Q3 How should the stomach be divided if one eats more?

Q4 What harms does overeating cause to body and heart?

Q5 List four manners of eating from the Sunnah.

Q6 What changes will you make to your eating habits this week?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Stop eating before you are full at every meal today.	☐
Mon	Say Bismillah and Alhamdulillah at every meal.	☐
Tue	Eat with your right hand and from what is in front of you.	☐
Wed	Skip one snack and drink water instead.	☐
Thu	Share your food with someone.	☐
Fri	Learn and say the du'a after eating.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

48

HADITH 48 OF 50

The Four Signs of Hypocrisy

الحَدِيثُ الثَّامِنُ وَالأَرْبَعُونَ

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diinislaam.com
/40hadith/48

Lying, breaking promises, foul disputing and betrayal — check yourself.

عَنْ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ عَمْرٍو رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا عَنِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ قَالَ: «أَرْبَعٌ مَنْ كُنَّ فِيهِ كَانَ مُنَافِقًا، وَإِنْ كَانَتْ خَصْلَةٌ مِنْهُنَّ فِيهِ كَانَتْ فِيهِ خَصْلَةٌ مِنَ النِّفَاقِ حَتَّى يَدَعَهَا: مَنْ إِذَا حَدَّثَ كَذَبَ، وَإِذَا وَعَدَ أَخْلَفَ، وَإِذَا خَاصَمَ فَجَرَ، وَإِذَا عَاهَدَ غَدَرَ».

خَرَّجَهُ البُخَارِيُّ وَمُسْلِمٌ.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

It is narrated on the authority of Abdullah b. 'Amr that the Prophet observed: "**There are four characteristics, whoever has them all is a pure hypocrite, and whoever has one of its characteristics, he has one of the characteristics of hypocrisy, until he gives it up: When he speaks he lies, when he makes a covenant he betrays it, when he makes a promise he breaks it, and when he disputes he resorts to obscene speech.**"

Sahih Muslim 58a · *sunnah.com/muslim:58a*

About the Narrator

ʿAbdullāh ibn ʿAmr ibn al-ʿĀṣ d. 65 AH — عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ عَمْرٍو رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا

Biography: see Hadith 41.

Explanatory Note

Hypocrisy (*nifāq*) is of two kinds. **Major hypocrisy** in belief: showing Islam while hiding disbelief in the heart; its people are in the lowest level of the Fire (an-Nisā' 4:145)[1]. **Minor hypocrisy** in actions: a Muslim who has some of the characteristics of the hypocrites. This hadith is about the second kind, as Ibn Rajab explains: these are qualities of the hypocrites which a believer must avoid.

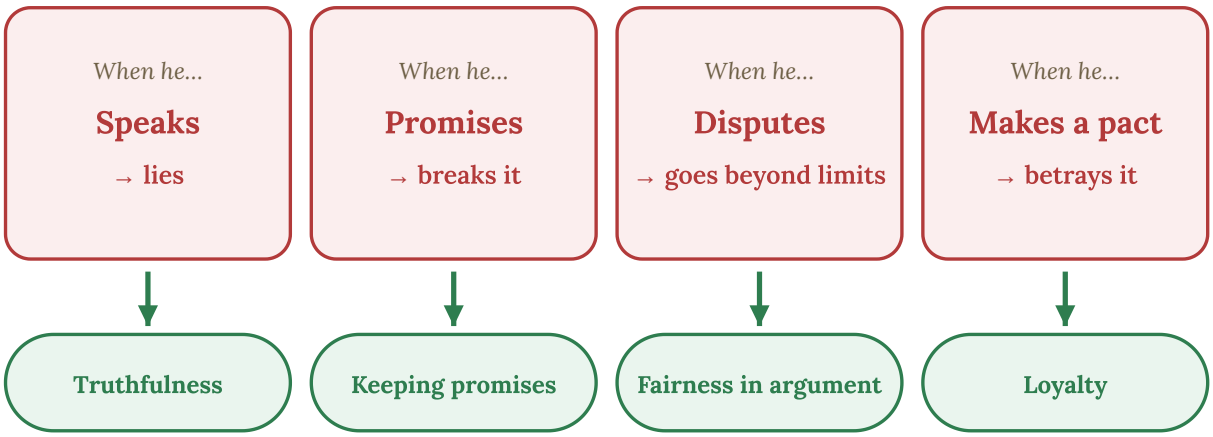
The four signs: **when he speaks, he lies**; **when he promises, he breaks it** (intending at the time not to keep it, or breaking it without excuse); **when he argues, he goes beyond limits**, twisting the truth and using foul words; **when he makes a pact, he betrays it**. In another narration: **when he is trusted, he betrays**. Whoever has all of them is a complete hypocrite in practice; whoever has one has a part of hypocrisy, until he leaves it.

The Companions feared hypocrisy for themselves. ʿUmar asked Ḥudhayfah whether he was named among the hypocrites. Al-Ḥasan al-Baṣrī said: ‘Only a believer fears it, and only a hypocrite feels safe from it.’[2] The cure is truthfulness, keeping promises, fairness in disputes and loyalty.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see “Notes and References”, Hadith 48.

Picture

see and remember



Four signs of hypocrisy — and the four virtues that cure them.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Hypocrisy has two kinds: in belief (major) and in actions (minor).
2. Lying, breaking promises, foul disputing and betrayal are signs of hypocrisy.
3. One sign gives a person a share of hypocrisy until he leaves it.
4. The believer fears hypocrisy for himself and examines his own heart.
5. Truthfulness, trustworthiness and keeping promises are signs of faith.
6. Disagree with fairness and good manners.

Step by Step

Cleaning yourself of the four signs

1. **Truth**
   Do not lie, even as a joke.

2 **Promises**
Promise only what you can do; say ‘in shā’ Allāh’ and mean it.

3 **Disputes**
Argue with facts, politely; admit when you are wrong.

4 **Pacts and trusts**
Keep secrets, return what was lent, honour agreements.

5 **Check daily**
Before sleeping, review: did any of the four happen today?

Questions

think, then write

Q1 What are the two kinds of hypocrisy?

Q2 List the four signs in this hadith.

Q3 What does ‘when he argues, he goes beyond limits’ mean?

Q4 What happens if a person has only one of these signs?

Q5 What did al-Ḥasan al-Baṣrī say about fearing hypocrisy?

Q6 Which sign do you need to watch most in yourself? What is your plan?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Do not tell a single lie today, not even a joke.	☐
Mon	Keep every promise you make this week — or don't make it.	☐
Tue	In an argument, stay calm and use only respectful words.	☐
Wed	Return something you borrowed.	☐
Thu	Keep a secret someone trusted you with.	☐
Fri	Make du'a: «اللَّهُمَّ طَهِّرْ قَلْبِي مِنَ النِّفَاقِ».	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

49

HADITH 49 OF 50

True Reliance on Allah

الحَدِيثُ التَّاسِعُ وَالأَرْبَعُونَ

Listen & study online
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/40hadith/49

Like the birds: they go out hungry and return full.

عَنْ عُمَرَ بْنِ الخَطَّابِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ عَنِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ قَالَ: «لَوْ أَنَّكُمْ كُنْتُمْ تَوَكَّلُونَ عَلَى اللَّهِ حَقَّ تَوَكُّلِهِ، لَرَزَقَكُمْ كَمَا يَرْزُقُ الطَّيْرَ، تَغْدُو خِمَاصًا، وَتَرُوحُ بِطَانًا».

رَوَاهُ الإِمَامُ أَحْمَدُ، وَالتِّرْمِذِيُّ، وَالنَّسَائِيُّ، وَابْنُ مَاجَهْ، وَابْنُ حِبَّانَ فِي «صَحِيحِهِ»، وَالحَاكِمُ، وَقَالَ التِّرْمِذِيُّ: «حَسَنٌ صَحِيحٌ».

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

Umar bin Al-Khattab narrated that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ said: "**If you were to rely upon Allah with the required reliance, then He would provide for you just as a bird is provided for, it goes out in the morning empty, and returns full.**"

Jami` at-Tirmidhi 2344 · *sunnah.com/tirmidhi:2344*

About the Narrator

عُمَرُ بْنُ الخَطَّابِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

ʿUmar ibn al-Khaṭṭāb d. 23 AH

Biography: see Hadith 1.

Explanatory Note

Tawakkul is the heart's true reliance on Allah to bring good and keep away harm, while taking the means. If we relied on Allah as He deserves, He would provide for us as He provides for the birds: they **go out** in the morning hungry and **return** full. Notice: the birds do not stay in their nests waiting; they go out. Tawakkul is not laziness.

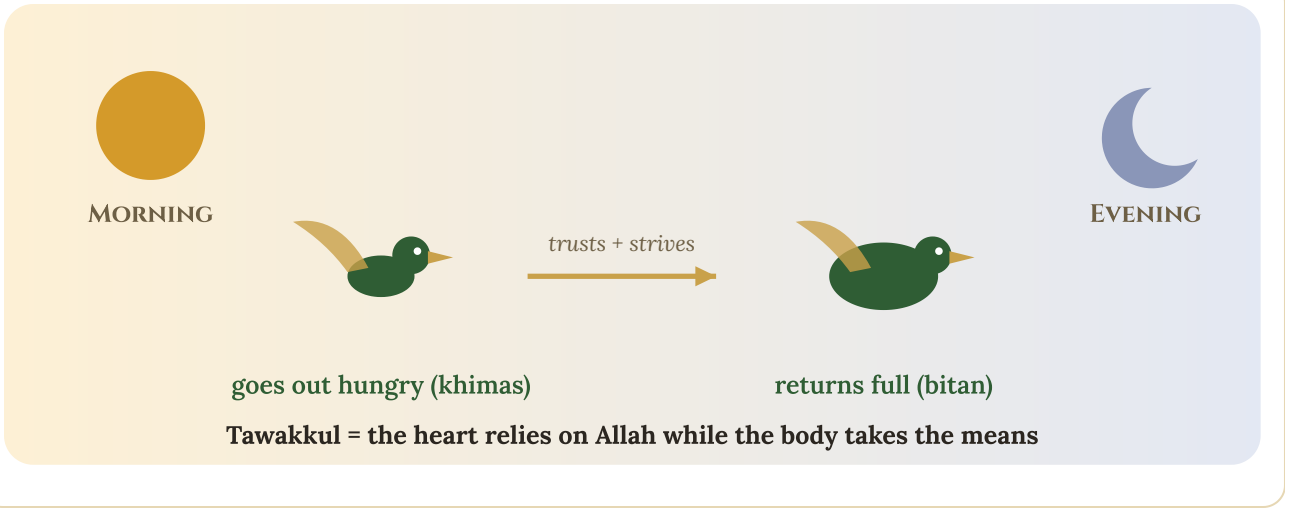
A man asked the Prophet ﷺ: 'Should I tie my camel and rely on Allah, or leave it untied and rely on Allah?' He said: "Tie it and rely on Allah."[1] Taking the means is obedience to Allah; relying on Him is faith. The body works, the heart trusts. Imam Aḥmad said[2] that whoever stays at home waiting for provision has misunderstood the hadith, because the birds go out to seek it.

Tawakkul brings peace: the believer does his best, then is content with whatever Allah decrees, knowing that his provision is written (Hadith 4) and will not go to anyone else. “Whoever relies on Allah, He is sufficient for him” (aṭ-Ṭalāq 65:3)[3].

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see “Notes and References”, Hadith 49.

Picture

see and remember



The birds leave their nests hungry in the morning and return full in the evening.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Tawakkul is the heart relying on Allah while the body takes the means.
2. True tawakkul brings provision from Allah.
3. Taking the means is part of tawakkul, not against it.
4. Laziness is not tawakkul.
5. Allah provides for all His creatures, including the birds.
6. Tawakkul brings peace and contentment with Allah’s decree.

Step by Step

Practising true tawakkul

1. **Plan and prepare**
   Study, work and take every halal means.

2. **Make du‘a**
   Ask Allah for success before starting.

3. **Rely with the heart**
   Know that results are in Allah’s hands alone.

4 **Leaving home**
Say «بِسْمِ اللَّهِ، تَوَكَّلْتُ عَلَى اللَّهِ، وَلَا حَوْلَ وَلَا قُوَّةَ إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ».

5 **Accept the result**
Be content, and try again if needed.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 Define tawakkul in your own words.

Q2 What do the birds do in the morning and evening? What does this teach?

Q3 What did the Prophet ﷺ say to the man about his camel?

Q4 Is staying at home waiting for provision tawakkul? Why not?

Q5 What does aṭ-Ṭalāq 65:3 promise?

Q6 Describe something you are worried about. How will you apply tawakkul to it?

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Say the du'a for leaving home every time you go out.	☐
Mon	Do your best in one task, then leave the result to Allah.	☐
Tue	Watch birds for a few minutes and reflect on this hadith.	☐
Wed	Read aṭ-Ṭalāq 65:2-3.	☐
Thu	Stop one worry by saying «حَسْبِيَ اللَّهُ وَنِعْمَ الوَكِيلُ».	☐
Fri	Work hard on your studies or job today as an act of worship.	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

HADITH 50 OF 50

50

Keep Your Tongue Moist with the Remembrance of Allah

الحَدِيثُ الخَمْسُونَ

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/40hadith/50

The final hadith: an easy deed that gathers all goodness.

عَنْ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ بُسْرٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: أَتَى النَّبِيَّ ﷺ رَجُلٌ فَقَالَ: يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ، إِنَّ شَرَائِعَ الإِسْلَامِ قَدْ كَثُرَتْ عَلَيْنَا، فَبَابٌ نَتَمَسَّكُ بِهِ جَامِعٌ؟ قَالَ: «**لَا يَزَالُ لِسَانُكَ رَطْبًا مِنْ ذِكْرِ اللَّهِ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ**». خَرَّجَهُ الإِمَامُ أَحْمَدُ بِهَذَا اللَّفْظِ.

وَخَرَّجَهُ التِّرْمِذِيُّ وَابْنُ مَاجَهْ وَابْنُ حِبَّانَ فِي «صَحِيحِهِ» بِمَعْنَاهُ، وَقَالَ التِّرْمِذِيُّ: «حَسَنٌ غَرِيبٌ». وَكُلُّهُمْ خَرَّجَهُ مِنْ رِوَايَةِ عَمْرِو بْنِ قَيْسٍ الكِنْدِيِّ، عَنْ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ بُسْرٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ.

وَخَرَّجَهُ ابْنُ حِبَّانَ فِي «صَحِيحِهِ» وَغَيْرُهُ مِنْ حَدِيثِ مُعَاذِ بْنِ جَبَلٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: آخِرُ مَا فَارَقْتُ عَلَيْهِ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ أَنْ قُلْتُ لَهُ: أَيُّ الأَعْمَالِ خَيْرٌ وَأَقْرَبُ إِلَى اللَّهِ؟ قَالَ: «**أَنْ تَمُوتَ وَلِسَانُكَ رَطْبٌ مِنْ ذِكْرِ اللَّهِ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ**».

ENGLISH TRANSLATION | *sunnah.com*

Abdullah bin Busr (ra) narrated that: A man said: "O Messenger of Allah ﷺ, indeed, the legislated acts of Islam have become too much for me, so inform me of a thing that I should stick to." He ﷺ said: "**Let not your tongue cease to be moist with the remembrance of Allah.**"

The narration of Mu'adh ibn Jabal (Ibn Hibban) is not on sunnah.com; this book's own translation: "The last thing I parted from the Messenger of Allah (ﷺ) upon was that I said to him: Which deed is best and closest to Allah? He said: 'That you die while your tongue is moist with the remembrance of Allah, the Mighty and Majestic.'"

Jamiʿ at-Tirmidhi 3375 · *sunnah.com/tirmidhi:3375*

About the Narrators

ʿAbdullāh ibn Busr al-Māzinī — عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ بُسْرٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

d. 88 AH

He and his family were young Companions; the Prophet ﷺ visited their home, ate there and made duʿa for them. The Prophet ﷺ placed his hand on his head and said he would live a century, and he did. He settled in Ḥimṣ and was among the last Companions to die in Shām, in 88 AH.

Muʿādh ibn Jabal — مُعَاذُ بْنُ جَبَلٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ

d. 18 AH

Biography: see Hadith 18.

Explanatory Note

A man said the laws of Islam — its many voluntary deeds — had become too many for him, so he asked for one comprehensive deed to hold on to. The Prophet ﷺ said: “Let your tongue remain moist with the remembrance of Allah.” Ibn Rajab ended his collection of fifty with this hadith, and Muʿādh reported that the last thing he asked the Prophet ﷺ was about the best deed, and the answer was: to die while your tongue is moist with the remembrance of Allah.

Dhikr is easy: it needs no money, place or special time, and it can be done standing, sitting or lying down (Āl ʿImrān 3:191)[1]. Yet its reward is huge. It gives life to the heart: “Verily in the remembrance of Allah do hearts find rest” (ar-Raʿd 13:28)[2]. The Prophet ﷺ said the difference between the one who remembers Allah and the one who does not is like the living and the dead[3].

The best dhikr is the Qur’an, then *lā ilāha illā Allāh*, *subḥān Allāh*, *al-ḥamdu lillāh*, *Allāhu akbar*, *lā ḥawla wa lā quwwata illā billāh* and *istighfār*, as well as the adhkār of the morning, evening, after prayer and before sleep. The best dhikr is when heart and tongue agree. So the book ends where every life should end: with the remembrance of Allah.

Sources for the footnotes in this chapter: see "Notes and References", Hadith 50.

Picture

see and remember



a moist tongue all day

- **SubḥānAllāh** — *light on the tongue, heavy on the scale*
- **Al-ḥamdu lillāh** — *fills the scale*
- **Lā ilāha illallāh** — *the best dhikr*
- **Allāhu akbar** — *greater than everything*
- **Astaghfirullāh** — *100× a day, as the Prophet ﷺ did*

Dhikr throughout the day keeps the tongue moist.

Lessons from the Hadith

1. Dhikr is an easy deed that gathers much goodness.
2. The Prophet ﷺ gave a simple, comprehensive answer to the one who felt overwhelmed.
3. Dhikr gives life and peace to the heart.
4. It can be done in every situation, without cost.
5. The best dhikr is with heart and tongue together.
6. The best ending is to die while remembering Allah.

Step by Step

Building a daily dhikr routine

1. **Morning**
   After Fajr, read the morning adhkār.
2. **After each prayer**
   Astaghfirullāh ×3, then subḥān Allāh, al-ḥamdu lillāh, Allāhu akbar ×33 each.
3. **During the day**
   Fill waiting time and travel with dhikr.

4 **Evening**
After ʿAṣr or Maghrib, read the evening adhkār.

5 **Before sleep**
Āyat al-Kursī, the last three sūrahs, and tasbīḥ ×33, taḥmīd ×33, takbīr ×34.

Questions

think, then write

Q1 **What did the man complain about, and what was the answer?**

Q2 **What did Muʿādh say was the last thing he asked the Prophet ﷺ?**

Q3 **Why is dhikr an easy deed?**

Q4 **What does ar-Raʿd 13:28 say about dhikr?**

Q5 **List five words of dhikr.**

Q6 **When during your day can you add more dhikr?**

Q7 **How has studying these fifty hadith changed you?**

To-Do List for the Week

tick each day

Sat	Memorise the hadith.	☐
Sun	Read the morning and evening adhkār every day this week.	☐
Mon	Say the tasbīḥ after every prayer.	☐
Tue	Replace music or idle talk while travelling with dhikr.	☐
Wed	Say «سُبْحَانَ اللهِ وَبِحَمْدِهِ» 100 times.	☐
Thu	Read Āyat al-Kursī and the last three sūrahs before sleeping.	☐
Fri	Revise all fifty hadith titles and celebrate completing the book!	☐

Memorised the Arabic? ☐ Date: ..... Teacher / parent: .....

My Notes

what I learned · questions to ask

PART FIVE · HADITH 41–50

Review Test

اخْتِبَارُ المُرَاجَعَة

Take this test online
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/40hadith/test5

Name: ..... Date: ..... Score: ..... / 50

Answer from memory first, then check your answers with the chapters. The answer key is at the back of the book.

A Multiple Choice

Circle the correct answer · 25 marks

1. **In Hadith 41, faith is complete when a person's desires...**
   - (A) are written down
   - (B) are hidden
   - (C) follow what the Prophet ﷺ brought
   - (D) are satisfied

2. **Which verse supports the meaning of Hadith 41?**
   - (A) al-Baqarah 2:255
   - (B) al-Ikhlāṣ 112:1
   - (C) al-Kawthar 108:1
   - (D) an-Nisā' 4:65

3. **Hadith 42 is the last hadith of...**
   - (A) Ibn Rajab's additions
   - (B) an-Nawawī's original collection
   - (C) Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī
   - (D) the Qur'an

4. **Which is NOT one of the three means of forgiveness in Hadith 42?**
   - (A) Tawḥīd
   - (B) Travelling to Makkah
   - (C) Istighfār
   - (D) Du'a with hope

5. **Which sin will not be forgiven if a person dies upon it?**
   - (A) Lying
   - (B) Laziness
   - (C) Anger
   - (D) Shirk

6. **Hadith 43 is about...**
   - (A) fasting
   - (B) trade
   - (C) the shares of inheritance
   - (D) prayer times

7. **What remains after the fixed shares goes to...**
   - (A) the nearest male relative
   - (B) the government
   - (C) the eldest daughter
   - (D) the poor

8. **Which is paid FIRST from a person's estate?**
   - (A) Gifts
   - (B) Funeral costs
   - (C) The bequest
   - (D) The heirs' shares

9. **A bequest (waṣiyyah) may be at most...**
   - (A) one-third
   - (B) one-quarter
   - (C) all of the wealth
   - (D) one-half

10. **Hadith 44 teaches that fosterage forbids...**
    - (A) what birth (blood relationship) forbids
    - (B) nothing
    - (C) only marriage to the foster mother
    - (D) inheritance

11. **Fosterage counts only if it happens within...**

(A) the first week
(B) the first ten years
(C) the first two years
(D) any age

12. **Does fosterage give a right of inheritance?**

(A) Only for sons
(B) No
(C) Yes, always
(D) Only for daughters

13. **In Hadith 45, which of these did the Prophet ﷺ forbid to be sold?**

(A) Wool
(B) Wheat
(C) Wine
(D) Dates

14. **Melting the fat and selling it was a trick that teaches...**

(A) changing a thing's form does not change its ruling
(B) trade is forbidden
(C) selling is always allowed
(D) fat is halal

15. **Hadith 45 was said in the year of...**

(A) the Trench
(B) the Conquest of Makkah
(C) Tabūk
(D) Badr

16. **"Every intoxicant is..."**

(A) forbidden
(B) disliked
(C) allowed for medicine
(D) allowed in small amounts

17. **Bitʿ was a drink made from...**

(A) dates
(B) barley
(C) grapes
(D) honey

18. **"Whatever intoxicates in a large amount, a small amount of it is..."**

(A) allowed
(B) forbidden
(C) disliked
(D) recommended

19. **According to Hadith 47, the worst vessel a person fills is...**

(A) his stomach
(B) his bag
(C) his house
(D) a bucket

20. **If one must eat more, the stomach is divided into...**

(A) quarters
(B) fifths
(C) halves
(D) thirds

21. **Which is NOT one of the four signs of hypocrisy in Hadith 48?**

(A) When he speaks, he lies
(B) When he makes a pact, he betrays
(C) When he prays, he is late
(D) When he promises, he breaks it

22. **Al-Ḥasan al-Baṣrī said that only a believer...**

(A) is rich
(B) is never sad
(C) knows the future
(D) fears hypocrisy

23. **In Hadith 49, the birds go out in the morning...**

(A) hungry
(B) sleeping
(C) full
(D) singing

24. **"Tie your camel and..."**

(A) leave it
(B) sell it
(C) rely on Allah
(D) ride it

25. **In Hadith 50, the man was told to keep his tongue moist with...**

(A) water
(B) poetry
(C) honey
(D) the remembrance of Allah

B MATCHING

Write the letter of the English meaning next to each Arabic phrase · 10 marks

1	حَتَّى يَكُونَ هَوَاهُ تَبَعًا لِمَا جِئْتُ بِهِ	☐	A	When he speaks he lies, and when he promises he breaks it.
2	إِنَّكَ مَا دَعَوْتَنِي وَرَجَوْتَنِي غَفَرْتُ لَكَ	☐	B	Allah and His Messenger have forbidden the sale of wine.
3	أَلْحِقُوا الفَرَائِضَ بِأَهْلِهَا	☐	C	They go out hungry in the morning and return full in the evening.
4	الرَّضَاعَةُ تُحَرِّمُ مَا تُحَرِّمُ الوِلَادَةُ	☐	D	Every intoxicant is forbidden.
5	إِنَّ اللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُ حَرَّمَ بَيْعَ الخَمْرِ	☐	E	Breast-feeding makes unlawful what birth makes unlawful.
6	كُلُّ مُسْكِرٍ حَرَامٌ	☐	F	Give the fixed shares to those entitled to them.
7	فَثُلُثٌ لِطَعَامِهِ، وَثُلُثٌ لِشَرَابِهِ، وَثُلُثٌ لِنَفَسِهِ	☐	G	Until his desires follow what I have brought.
8	إِذَا حَدَّثَ كَذَبَ، وَإِذَا وَعَدَ أَخْلَفَ	☐	H	As long as you call on Me and hope in Me, I will forgive you.
9	تَغْدُو خِمَاصًا وَتَرُوحُ بِطَانًا	☐	I	Let your tongue remain moist with the remembrance of Allah.
10	لَا يَزَالُ لِسَانُكَ رَطْبًا مِنْ ذِكْرِ اللَّهِ	☐	J	A third for his food, a third for his drink and a third for his breath.

C SHORT ANSWER

Answer in one or two sentences · 10 marks

1. **What does hawā mean, and why is following it against the Shariah dangerous?**

2. Name the three means of forgiveness in Hadith 42.

3. Put these in order: bequest, funeral costs, inheritance shares, debts.

4. Name four relatives who become maḥram through fosterage.

5. What general rule did scholars take from Hadith 45?

6. Why is Hadith 46 an example of jawāmiʿ al-kalim?

7. List four manners of eating from the Sunnah.

8. What are the two kinds of hypocrisy?

9. Explain the difference between tawakkul and laziness.

10. Why is dhikr called an easy deed?

D Critical Thinking

Explain your thinking with evidence from the hadith · 5 marks

1. Hadith 42 gives great hope. How would you use it to help a friend who feels his sins are too many — without making him careless about sin?

2. A Muslim company calls interest a ‘service fee’. Using Hadith 45 and the story of the melted fat, explain why the name does not change the ruling.

3. Plan one week of meals for yourself or your family that follows Hadith 47. What changes would you make, and what benefits do you expect?

4. Which of the four signs of hypocrisy (Hadith 48) is most common in school or work today? Suggest a practical way to fight it.

5. You have finished the fifty hadith. Choose the three that changed you the most and explain why, ending with how Hadith 50 can keep you steadfast.

Memorisation Tracker

جَدْوَلُ الحِفْظ

Tick the box when you can recite the Arabic of the hadith from memory. Colours show the five parts of the book.

1 Intentions ☐	2 Islam, Iman, Ihsan ☐	3 Five pillars ☐	4 Creation & destiny ☐	5 No innovation ☐
6 Halal, haram, doubtful ☐	7 Naseehah ☐	8 Sanctity of a Muslim ☐	9 Do what you can ☐	10 Only the good ☐
11 Leave doubt ☐	12 Leave the useless ☐	13 Love for your brother ☐	14 Sanctity of life ☐	15 Good words, neighbour, guest ☐
16 Do not get angry ☐	17 Ihsan in all things ☐	18 Taqwa & character ☐	19 Guard Allah's limits ☐	20 Hayaa' ☐
21 Istiqamah ☐	22 Obligations to Paradise ☐	23 Purity & good deeds ☐	24 O My servants ☐	25 Charity for all ☐
26 Daily charities ☐	27 Birr and ithm ☐	28 Hold to the Sunnah ☐	29 Doors of good ☐	30 Do not neglect, transgress, violate ☐
31 Zuhd ☐	32 No harm ☐	33 Proof & oath ☐	34 Change evil ☐	35 Brotherhood ☐
36 Help, cover, learn ☐	37 Multiplied rewards ☐	38 Awliya' of Allah ☐	39 Mistakes forgiven ☐	40 Stranger or traveller ☐
41 Desires follow revelation ☐	42 Forgiveness ☐	43 Inheritance ☐	44 Fosterage ☐	45 Forbidden trade ☐
46 Intoxicants ☐	47 Moderation in eating ☐	48 Signs of hypocrisy ☐	49 Tawakkul ☐	50 Dhikr ☐

Glossary of Terms

مُصْطَلَحَات

ʿAqīdah — Creed; the beliefs of a Muslim.

Bidʿah — An innovation in the religion: a practice of worship with no basis in the Qur'an and Sunnah.

Duʿā' — Supplication; calling upon Allah.

Dhikr — Remembrance of Allah with the heart and tongue.

Farḍ / Farīḍah — An obligation; also the fixed shares of inheritance (farā'iḍ).

Fiṭrah — The natural disposition Allah created people upon.

Ḥadīth — A report of what the Prophet ﷺ said, did or approved.

Ḥadīth qudsī — A hadith in which the Prophet ﷺ relates words from his Lord.

Ḥalāl / Ḥarām — Lawful / forbidden.

Ḥimā — A protected pasture or sanctuary; Allah's ḥimā is what He has forbidden.

Iḥsān — Excellence: worshipping Allah as though you see Him.

Ikhlāṣ — Sincerity: doing a deed for Allah alone.

Īmān — Faith: belief in the heart, statement of the tongue and action of the limbs.

Istighfār — Seeking Allah's forgiveness.

Istiqāmah — Steadfastness: keeping to the straight path.

Mahram — A close relative whom one may never marry.

Makrūh — Disliked: better to leave, but not sinful.

Mubāḥ — Permissible: neither rewarded nor punished in itself.

Munkar — Evil; what the Shariah condemns.

Maʿrūf — Good; what the Shariah approves.

Nafl / Nawāfil — Voluntary acts of worship beyond the obligations.

Naṣīḥah — Sincere goodwill and advice.

Niyyah — Intention.

Qadar — Allah's decree and measuring out of all things.

Riyā' — Showing off: doing good so that people see it.

Ṣadaqah — Charity, in wealth or in good deeds.

Shubuhāt — Doubtful matters, between the clearly lawful and the clearly forbidden.

Sunnah — The way of the Prophet ﷺ: his words, deeds and approvals.

Taqwā — Mindfulness of Allah: placing a shield between yourself and His punishment.

Tawakkul — Reliance on Allah while taking the means.

Tawbah — Repentance: returning to Allah from sin.

Waraʿ — Scrupulousness: leaving what may harm your religion.

Walī — A friend of Allah: a believer with taqwā.

Zuhd — Detachment from the world: leaving what will not benefit you in the Hereafter.

Answer Key

مَفَاتِيحُ الإِجَابَات

For teachers and parents. Short answers are a guide: accept any answer with the same meaning. Critical-thinking answers will vary; give marks for clear reasoning that uses the hadith.

Part One · Hadith 1–10

A. Multiple choice

1 **B** 2 **A** 3 **B** 4 **C** 5 **B** 6 **A** 7 **A** 8 **D** 9 **C** 10 **A** 11 **B** 12 **D** 13 **D** 14 **C** 15 **A** 16 **C**
17 **B** 18 **D** 19 **D** 20 **A** 21 **C** 22 **D** 23 **C** 24 **B** 25 **A**

B. Matching

1 **E** 2 **F** 3 **B** 4 **A** 5 **C** 6 **H** 7 **D** 8 **I** 9 **J** 10 **G**

C. Short answer

1. An action is valid only with an intention, and its reward depends on what was intended.
2. The two testimonies, prayer, zakah, fasting Ramadan, Hajj.
3. Belief in Allah, His angels, His books, His messengers, the Last Day, and qadar (good and bad).
4. Nuṭfah (drop), ʿalaqah (clinging clot), muḍghah (lump of flesh).
5. Sincerity for Allah (ikhlāṣ) and following the Sunnah.
6. His religion and his honour.
7. Allah, His Book, His Messenger, the leaders of the Muslims, and the common Muslims.
8. We judge by what people show outwardly; their hearts are for Allah to judge.
9. Prohibitions are left completely; commands are done as much as we are able.
10. e.g. eating halal, travelling, humility, raising the hands, calling ‘Yā Rabb’.

Part Two · Hadith 11–20

A. Multiple choice

1 **D** 2 **B** 3 **D** 4 **A** 5 **A** 6 **B** 7 **A** 8 **D** 9 **B** 10 **C** 11 **C** 12 **D** 13 **C** 14 **C** 15 **A** 16 **B** 17 **B** 18 **D** 19 **A** 20 **B** 21 **D** 22 **A** 23 **A** 24 **C** 25 **C**

B. Matching

1 **C** 2 **E** 3 **G** 4 **B** 5 **H** 6 **D** 7 **I** 8 **A** 9 **J** 10 **F**

C. Short answer

1. A real doubt has a reason; waswās is a whisper against something one is already certain of.
2. e.g. gossip, prying into private lives, useless arguing, endless scrolling.
3. It makes you want the same good for others that you want for yourself.
4. The married adulterer, a life for a life, and the one who leaves the religion and separates from the community.
5. Special care for a day and a night; hospitality up to three days.
6. Seek refuge with Allah, stay silent, change position, make wudu (also: remember the reward of restraint).
7. Sharp knife, not sharpening it in front of the animal, gentleness, quick cut, not slaughtering in front of another animal.
8. Fear Allah wherever you are, follow a bad deed with a good one, treat people with good character.
9. Stop the sin, regret it, resolve not to return, return any rights to people.
10. A warning (do it and face the consequence), and a permission (if it is not shameful, you may do it).

Part Three · Hadith 21–30

A. Multiple choice

1 **A** 2 **D** 3 **B** 4 **C** 5 **B** 6 **D** 7 **C** 8 **A** 9 **A** 10 **B** 11 **C** 12 **A** 13 **A** 14 **C** 15 **D** 16 **A** 17 **C** 18 **D** 19 **B** 20 **D** 21 **A** 22 **D** 23 **C** 24 **B** 25 **B**

B. Matching

1 **D** 2 **G** 3 **I** 4 **H** 5 **A** 6 **E** 7 **J** 8 **B** 9 **C** 10 **F**

C. Short answer

1. Being steadfast in obedience, and not slipping away like foxes.
2. They may not yet have been obligatory, or the man was not able; other hadith complete the picture.
3. Prayer is light; charity is a proof; patience is radiance.
4. Guidance, food, clothing and forgiveness.
5. Intimacy with one's spouse; doing it in the haram is a sin, so doing it in the halal earns reward.
6. Judging fairly, helping someone with his mount or luggage, a good word, steps to the prayer, removing harm from the road.
7. Check the texts, ask a scholar, and leave what disturbs the heart.
8. Taqwā; listening and obeying; holding to the Sunnah and the rightly guided caliphs; avoiding newly invented matters.
9. Fasting is a shield; charity puts out sin; prayer in the depths of the night.
10. Obligations, limits, prohibitions, and things left unmentioned out of mercy.

Part Four · Hadith 31–40

A. Multiple choice

1 **A** 2 **D** 3 **C** 4 **A** 5 **B** 6 **A** 7 **C** 8 **D** 9 **D** 10 **B** 11 **A** 12 **B** 13 **B** 14 **D** 15 **D** 16 **A** 17 **C** 18 **C** 19 **B** 20 **B** 21 **D** 22 **C** 23 **A** 24 **C** 25 **A**

B. Matching

1 **C** 2 **E** 3 **F** 4 **I** 5 **J** 6 **H** 7 **B** 8 **D** 9 **G** 10 **A**

C. Short answer

1. No. It means the world is in your hand, not your heart; you leave what does not benefit the Hereafter.
2. Ḍarar is harming someone at all; ḍirār is harming in return, beyond what is just.
3. e.g. a neighbour may not build what seriously harms his neighbour; a will may not be made to harm the heirs.
4. Witnesses or clear evidence.
5. Knowledge that it is an evil, ability/authority, gentleness, and that it does not lead to a greater evil.
6. Do not envy, inflate prices, hate, turn your backs, or undercut each other's sales.
7. Not exposing a private mistake; it does not mean hiding harm or crimes against others.
8. When it is left for the sake of Allah.
9. He guides his hearing, sight, hands and feet, answers his du'a and grants him refuge.
10. Do not delay good deeds from evening to morning; use health before sickness and life before death.

Part Five · Hadith 41–50

A. Multiple choice

1 **C** 2 **D** 3 **B** 4 **B** 5 **D** 6 **C** 7 **A** 8 **B** 9 **A** 10 **A** 11 **C** 12 **B** 13 **C** 14 **A** 15 **B** 16 **A** 17 **D** 18 **B** 19 **A** 20 **D** 21 **C** 22 **D** 23 **A** 24 **C** 25 **D**

B. Matching

1 **G** 2 **H** 3 **F** 4 **E** 5 **B** 6 **D** 7 **J** 8 **A** 9 **C** 10 **I**

C. Short answer

1. What the soul desires; following it against revelation is the root of sins and innovations.
2. Du'a with hope, seeking forgiveness (istighfār), and meeting Allah with tawḥīd.
3. Funeral costs, debts, bequest, inheritance shares.
4. The foster mother, foster father (her husband), foster siblings, foster aunts, foster grandparents.
5. When Allah forbids something to be used, He forbids its price.
6. One short sentence gives a rule that covers every intoxicant in every age.
7. Bismillah, right hand, eat from what is in front of you, do not criticise food, praise Allah after.
8. Major (in belief) and minor (in actions).
9. Tawakkul is relying on Allah while taking the means; laziness abandons the means.
10. It needs no money, place or special time and can be done in any position.

Notes and References

المَصادِرُ والمَراجِع

The small numbers in the chapters refer to these notes. Hadith numbers follow sunnah.com, where every hadith can be read online (for example sunnah.com/bukhari:1). Qur'an references are given as sūrah:verse.

Hadith 1 · Actions Are Judged by Intentions

1 Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 1; Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 6689.

سَمِعْتُ عُمَرَ بْنَ الْخَطَّابِ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ عَلَى الْمِنْبَرِ، قَالَ: سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ، يَقُولُ: «إِنَّمَا الْأَعْمَالُ بِالنِّيَّاتِ، وَإِنَّمَا لِكُلِّ امْرِئٍ مَا نَوَى، فَمَنْ كَانَتْ هِجْرَتُهُ إِلَى دُنْيَا يُصِيبُهَا أَوْ إِلَى امْرَأَةٍ يَنْكِحُهَا، فَهِجْرَتُهُ إِلَى مَا هَاجَرَ إِلَيْهِ»

2 aṭ-Ṭabarānī, al-Muʿjam al-Kabīr, from Ibn Masʿūd. Ibn Ḥajar said in Fatḥ al-Bārī that its chain is authentic by the standards of al-Bukhārī and Muslim.

عَنْ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ مَسْعُودٍ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ قَالَ: كَانَ فِينَا رَجُلٌ خَطَبَ امْرَأَةً يُقَالُ لَهَا أُمُّ قَيْسٍ، فَأَبَتْ أَنْ تَتَزَوَّجَهُ حَتَّى يُهَاجِرَ، فَهَاجَرَ فَتَزَوَّجَهَا، قَالَ: فَكُنَّا نُسَمِّيهِ مُهَاجِرَ أُمِّ قَيْسٍ.

3 Ibn Rajab, Jāmiʿ al-ʿUlūm wa-l-Ḥikam, Hadith 1.

قَالَ ابْنُ رَجَبٍ: «وَقَدِ اشْتَهَرَ أَنَّ قِصَّةَ مُهَاجِرِ أُمِّ قَيْسٍ هِيَ كَانَتْ سَبَبَ قَوْلِ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ: مَنْ كَانَتْ هِجْرَتُهُ إِلَى دُنْيَا يُصِيبُهَا أَوِ امْرَأَةٍ يَنْكِحُهَا، وَذَكَرَ ذَلِكَ كَثِيرٌ مِنَ الْمُتَأَخِّرِينَ فِي كُتُبِهِمْ، وَلَمْ نَرَ لِذَلِكَ أَصْلًا بِإِسْنَادٍ يَصِحُّ».

4 Ibn Ḥajar, Fatḥ al-Bārī (commentary on Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī), on this hadith.

5 Ibn Rajab, Jāmiʿ al-ʿUlūm wa-l-Ḥikam, commentary on this hadith.

Hadith 2 · Islam, Iman and Ihsan: The Hadith of Jibril

1 Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 8a.

كَانَ أَوَّلَ مَنْ قَالَ فِي الْقَدَرِ بِالْبَصْرَةِ مَعْبَدٌ الْجُهَنِيُّ فَانْطَلَقْتُ أَنَا وَحُمَيْدُ بْنُ عَبْدِ الرَّحْمَنِ الْحِمْيَرِيُّ حَاجَّيْنِ أَوْ مُعْتَمِرَيْنِ فَقُلْنَا لَوْ لَقِينَا أَحَدًا مِنْ أَصْحَابِ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ فَسَأَلْنَاهُ عَمَّا يَقُولُ هَؤُلاَءِ فِي الْقَدَرِ فَوُفِّقَ لَنَا عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ عُمَرَ بْنِ الْخَطَّابِ دَاخِلاً الْمَسْجِدَ فَاكْتَنَفْتُهُ أَنَا وَصَاحِبِي أَحَدُنَا عَنْ يَمِينِهِ وَالآخَرُ عَنْ شِمَالِهِ فَظَنَنْتُ أَنَّ صَاحِبِي سَيَكِلُ الْكَلاَمَ إِلَىَّ فَقُلْتُ أَبَا عَبْدِ الرَّحْمَنِ إِنَّهُ قَدْ ظَهَرَ قِبَلَنَا نَاسٌ يَقْرَءُونَ الْقُرْآنَ وَيَتَقَفَّرُونَ الْعِلْمَ - وَذَكَرَ مِنْ شَأْنِهِمْ - وَأَنَّهُمْ يَزْعُمُونَ أَنْ لاَ قَدَرَ وَأَنَّ الأَمْرَ أُنُفٌ. قَالَ فَإِذَا لَقِيتَ أُولَئِكَ فَأَخْبِرْهُمْ أَنِّي بَرِيءٌ مِنْهُمْ وَأَنَّهُمْ بُرَآءُ مِنِّي وَالَّذِي يَحْلِفُ بِهِ عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ عُمَرَ لَوْ أَنَّ لأَحَدِهِمْ مِثْلَ أُحُدٍ ذَهَبًا فَأَنْفَقَهُ مَا قَبِلَ اللَّهُ مِنْهُ حَتَّى يُؤْمِنَ بِالْقَدَرِ ثُمَّ قَالَ حَدَّثَنِي أَبِي عُمَرُ بْنُ الْخَطَّابِ قَالَ ...

Hadith 3 · Islam Is Built on Five

1 Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 4514.

أَنَّ رَجُلاً، أَتَى ابْنَ عُمَرَ فَقَالَ يَا أَبَا عَبْدِ الرَّحْمَنِ مَا حَمَلَكَ عَلَى أَنْ تَحُجَّ عَامًا وَتَعْتَمِرَ عَامًا، وَتَتْرُكَ الْجِهَادَ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ، وَقَدْ عَلِمْتَ مَا رَغَّبَ اللَّهُ فِيهِ قَالَ يَا ابْنَ أَخِي بُنِيَ الإِسْلاَمُ عَلَى خَمْسٍ إِيمَانٍ بِاللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ، وَالصَّلاَةِ الْخَمْسِ، وَصِيَامِ رَمَضَانَ، وَأَدَاءِ الزَّكَاةِ، وَحَجِّ الْبَيْتِ

2 Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 16a.

بُنِيَ الإِسْلاَمُ عَلَى خَمْسَةٍ عَلَى أَنْ يُوَحَّدَ اللَّهُ وَإِقَامِ الصَّلاَةِ وَإِيتَاءِ الزَّكَاةِ وَصِيَامِ رَمَضَانَ وَالْحَجِّ «. فَقَالَ رَجُلٌ الْحَجِّ وَصِيَامِ رَمَضَانَ قَالَ لاَ. صِيَامِ رَمَضَانَ وَالْحَجِّ. هَكَذَا سَمِعْتُهُ مِنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ»

3 Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 82a.

Hadith 4 · The Creation of Man and the Writing of Destiny

1 Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 4949; Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 2647a.

2 Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 2898; Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 112a.

Hadith 5 · Rejecting Innovations in the Religion

1 Qur'an, al-Mā'idah 5:3.

2 Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 2155; Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 1504a.

Hadith 8 · The Sanctity of a Muslim

1 Qur'an, al-Baqarah 2:256.

2 Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 1399; Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 20.

Hadith 9 · Do What You Are Able

1 Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 1337.

خَطَبَنَا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ فَقَالَ «أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ قَدْ فَرَضَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْكُمُ الْحَجَّ فَحُجُّوا». فَقَالَ رَجُلٌ أَكُلَّ عَامٍ يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ فَسَكَتَ حَتَّى قَالَهَا ثَلاَثًا فَقَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ ﷺ «لَوْ قُلْتُ نَعَمْ لَوَجَبَتْ وَلَمَا اسْتَطَعْتُمْ - ثُمَّ قَالَ - ذَرُونِي مَا تَرَكْتُكُمْ فَإِنَّمَا هَلَكَ مَنْ كَانَ قَبْلَكُمْ بِكَثْرَةِ سُؤَالِهِمْ وَاخْتِلاَفِهِمْ عَلَى أَنْبِيَائِهِمْ فَإِذَا أَمَرْتُكُمْ بِشَىْءٍ فَأْتُوا مِنْهُ مَا اسْتَطَعْتُمْ وَإِذَا نَهَيْتُكُمْ عَنْ شَىْءٍ فَدَعُوهُ»

2 Sunan Abī Dāwūd 1721.

3 Qur'an, al-Baqarah 2:286.

4 Qur'an, al-Baqarah 2:67-71.

Hadith 11 · Leave What Makes You Doubt

1 Jāmiʿ at-Tirmidhī 2518.

Hadith 13 · Love for Your Brother What You Love for Yourself

1 Sunan an-Nasā'ī 5017.

Hadith 14 · The Sanctity of Muslim Blood

1. Qur'an, al-Baqarah 2:178.
2. Qur'an, al-Mā'idah 5:32.

Hadith 15 · Speak Good or Stay Silent

1. Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 6014.
2. Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 6019.

Hadith 16 · Do Not Become Angry

1. Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 6114; Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 2609a.
2. Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 3282.
3. Musnad Aḥmad, from Ibn ʿAbbās: "If one of you becomes angry, let him be silent."
4. Sunan Abī Dāwūd 4782.
5. Qur'an, Āl ʿImrān 3:134.

Hadith 17 · Excellence in Everything

1. Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 3482.
2. Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 2363.
3. al-Bayhaqī, Shuʿab al-Īmān, from ʿĀ'ishah; graded ḥasan by al-Albānī (as-Silsilah aṣ-Ṣaḥīḥah 1113).

Hadith 18 · Taqwa, Repentance and Good Character

1. Qur'an, Hūd 11:114.
2. Jāmiʿ at-Tirmidhī 2002.
3. Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 3559.

Hadith 19 · Be Mindful of Allah, He Will Protect You

1. Musnad Aḥmad, the longer narration of Ibn ʿAbbās ("…Know Allah in ease…").

Hadith 20 · Modesty: If You Feel No Shame…

1. Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 9; Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 35a.
2. Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 6117; Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 37a.
3. Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 332a.

Hadith 21 · Say: I Believe in Allah, Then Be Steadfast

1. Qur'an, Fuṣṣilat 41:30.
2. Qur'an, Hūd 11:112.
3. Sunan Ibn Mājah 277.
4. Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 6463.

Hadith 24 · O My Servants, I Have Forbidden Oppression

1. Ibn Rajab, Jāmiʿ al-ʿUlūm wa-l-Ḥikam, commentary on this hadith.

Hadith 25 · Every Tasbih Is a Charity

1. Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 595a.

Hadith 26 · A Charity for Every Joint

1. Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 1007a.
2. Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 720.

Hadith 29 · The Deed That Leads to Paradise

1. Jāmiʿ at-Tirmidhī 2616.

كُنْتُ مَعَ النَّبِيِّ ﷺ فِي سَفَرٍ فَأَصْبَحْتُ يَوْمًا قَرِيبًا مِنْهُ وَنَحْنُ نَسِيرُ فَقُلْتُ يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ أَخْبِرْنِي بِعَمَلٍ يُدْخِلُنِي الْجَنَّةَ وَيُبَاعِدُنِي مِنَ النَّارِ

Hadith 30 · Obligations, Limits and Things Left Unmentioned

1. Qur'an, Maryam 19:64.

Hadith 31 · Renounce the World and Allah Will Love You

1. Ibn al-Qayyim, Madārij as-Sālikīn, quoting Ibn Taymiyyah's definition of zuhd.
2. Qur'an, al-Ḥadīd 57:23.

Hadith 32 · No Harm and No Reciprocating Harm

1. Qur'an, al-Baqarah 2:231.
2. Qur'an, an-Nisā' 4:12.

Hadith 33 · The Burden of Proof Is on the Claimant

1. Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 2669; Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 138a; Qur'an, Āl ʿImrān 3:77.

ثُمَّ إِنَّ الأَشْعَثَ بْنَ قَيْسٍ خَرَجَ إِلَيْنَا فَقَالَ مَا يُحَدِّثُكُمْ أَبُو عَبْدِ الرَّحْمَنِ فَحَدَّثْنَاهُ بِمَا، قَالَ، فَقَالَ صَدَقَ لَفِيَّ أُنْزِلَتْ، كَانَ بَيْنِي وَبَيْنَ رَجُلٍ خُصُومَةٌ فِي شَىْءٍ، فَاخْتَصَمْنَا إِلَى رَسُولِ اللَّهِ ﷺ فَقَالَ «شَاهِدَاكَ أَوْ يَمِينُهُ». فَقُلْتُ لَهُ إِنَّهُ إِذًا يَحْلِفُ وَلاَ يُبَالِي. فَقَالَ النَّبِيُّ ﷺ «مَنْ حَلَفَ عَلَى يَمِينٍ يَسْتَحِقُّ بِهَا مَالاً وَهْوَ فِيهَا فَاجِرٌ لَقِيَ اللَّهَ وَهْوَ عَلَيْهِ غَضْبَانُ»

2. Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 137a.

Hadith 34 · Changing an Evil

1. Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 49a.

أَوَّلُ مَنْ بَدَأَ بِالْخُطْبَةِ يَوْمَ الْعِيدِ قَبْلَ الصَّلاَةِ مَرْوَانُ فَقَامَ إِلَيْهِ رَجُلٌ فَقَالَ الصَّلاَةُ قَبْلَ الْخُطْبَةِ. فَقَالَ قَدْ تُرِكَ مَا هُنَالِكَ. فَقَالَ أَبُو سَعِيدٍ أَمَّا هَذَا فَقَدْ قَضَى مَا عَلَيْهِ سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ﷺ يَقُولُ «مَنْ رَأَى مِنْكُمْ مُنْكَرًا فَلْيُغَيِّرْهُ بِيَدِهِ فَإِنْ لَمْ يَسْتَطِعْ فَبِلِسَانِهِ فَإِنْ لَمْ يَسْتَطِعْ فَبِقَلْبِهِ وَذَلِكَ أَضْعَفُ الإِيمَانِ»

2. Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 2594a.

Hadith 35 · Be Brothers, O Servants of Allah

1. Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 67; Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 1679a.

Hadith 37 · Allah Records Good and Bad Deeds

1. Ibn Rajab, Jāmiʿ al-ʿUlūm wa-l-Ḥikam, commentary on this hadith.

Hadith 38 · Drawing Near to Allah: The Friends of Allah

1. Qur'an, Yūnus 10:62-63.

Hadith 39 · Mistakes, Forgetfulness and Coercion Are Pardoned

1. Qur'an, al-Baqarah 2:286.
2. Qur'an, an-Nisā' 4:92.
3. Qur'an, an-Naḥl 16:106.

Hadith 41 · Desires That Follow the Revelation

1. Qur'an, an-Nisā' 4:65.
2. Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 15; Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 44a.

Hadith 42 · O Son of Adam, I Will Forgive You

1. Qur'an, an-Nisā' 4:48.
2. Qur'an, az-Zumar 39:53.

Hadith 43 · Give the Inheritance Shares to Their People

1. Qur'an, an-Nisā' 4:11-12; Qur'an, an-Nisā' 4:176.

Hadith 44 · Fosterage Forbids What Birth Forbids

1. Qur'an, al-Baqarah 2:233.
2. Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim 1452a.

Hadith 46 · Every Intoxicant Is Forbidden

1. Sunan Abī Dāwūd 3681; Jāmiʿ at-Tirmidhī 1865.
2. Qur'an, al-Mā'idah 5:90-91.
3. Jāmiʿ at-Tirmidhī 1295.

Hadith 47 · The Worst Vessel: The Stomach

1. Ibn Rajab, Jāmiʿ al-ʿUlūm wa-l-Ḥikam, commentary on this hadith.

Hadith 48 · The Four Signs of Hypocrisy

1. Qur'an, an-Nisā' 4:145.
2. Reported by al-Bukhārī without a chain in the Book of Faith (chapter: the believer's fear that his deeds may be lost), and with a chain by al-Firyābī.

Hadith 49 · True Reliance on Allah

1. Jāmiʿ at-Tirmidhī 2517.
2. Ibn Rajab, Jāmiʿ al-ʿUlūm wa-l-Ḥikam, commentary on this hadith.
3. Qur'an, aṭ-Ṭalāq 65:3.

Hadith 50 · Keep Your Tongue Moist with the Remembrance of Allah

1. Qur'an, Āl ʿImrān 3:191.
2. Qur'an, ar-Raʿd 13:28.
3. Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 6407.

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- Ibn Daqīq al-ʿĪd, Sharḥ al-Arbaʿīn an-Nawawiyyah.
- Muḥammad ibn Ṣāliḥ al-ʿUthaymīn, Sharḥ al-Arbaʿīn an-Nawawiyyah.
- Ibn Ḥajar al-ʿAsqalānī, Fatḥ al-Bārī bi-Sharḥ Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī; and al-Iṣābah fī Tamyīz aṣ-Ṣaḥābah.
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- The hadith collections: Ṣaḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim, Sunan Abī Dāwūd, Jāmiʿ at-Tirmidhī, Sunan an-Nasā'ī, Sunan Ibn Mājah, Musnad Aḥmad.
- English translations of the hadith: sunnah.com. Qur'an references: quran.com.

Closing Supplication

دُعَاءُ الخِتَام

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

"Glory and praise be to You, O Allah. I bear witness that there is no god but You. I seek Your forgiveness and turn to You in repentance." (The supplication for the end of a gathering, at-Tirmidhī)

اللَّهُمَّ انْفَعْنِي بِمَا عَلَّمْتَنِي، وَعَلِّمْنِي مَا يَنْفَعُنِي، وَزِدْنِي عِلْمًا

"O Allah, benefit me with what You have taught me, teach me what will benefit me, and increase me in knowledge." (Ibn Mājah, at-Tirmidhī)

وَصَلَّى اللَّهُ وَسَلَّمَ عَلَى نَبِيِّنَا مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَصَحْبِهِ أَجْمَعِينَ